

Whistleblower warns against mail-ballot system

Claims it would threaten process

By **Nicholas Riccardi**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

The US Postal Service is poised to launch a hastily built, error-riddled computer system that could jeopardize the process of mail voting relied upon by one-third of all voters, according to a whistleblower statement released Tuesday by Democratic Senator Richard Blumenthal.

The effort is part of the implementation of President Trump's executive order limiting mail voting and has been temporarily halted by a federal judge. The ruling is being appealed by the administration and the directive may ultimately end up back before the Supreme Court.

The disclosure from the unidentified whistleblower contends that the Postal Service has been scrambling to try to build a complex system that would normally take a year or more in only three months, sometimes in defiance of the judge's orders halting work. The goal is to have it ready for use in the midterm elections.

The disclosure contends that, due to the new procedures, a single scanning error in a batch of tens of thousands of ballot envelopes could prevent any from reaching voters. It details a system that election officials have already warned could not be implemented before the first mail ballots begin going out Friday in North Carolina.

"The Postal Service has designed a system to disenfran-

chise millions of Americans," Blumenthal told reporters in advance of releasing the whistleblower information. "This administration seems hell-bent on changing the framework on casting ballots in this country clearly for political reasons."

Trump's executive order, signed in March, directed US Citizenship and Immigration Services and the commissioner of the Social Security Administration to develop state citizenship lists and then required the Postal Service to send mail ballots only to voters who are on such a list. Ballot envelopes would have to comply with new Postal Service rules and include barcodes.

The online portal that is the subject of the whistleblower complaint is intended for states to deliver their lists of verified voters to the Postal Service.

The White House said the software buildout process is "neither complex nor unique" for the Postal Service because it already uses bulk mailing and intelligent mail barcodes for large customers. "Under President Trump, the federal government is working to ensure safe, transparent, and honest elections," spokesperson Lauren Bis said.

Trump has long opposed voting by mail, even though he has repeatedly used the method to cast his own ballot. He falsely blamed mail voting for his 2020 election loss and has spent years spreading conspiracy theories about it. A report by the Brookings Institution published in 2025 found that mail voting



ANNA MONEYMAKER/GETTY IMAGES
Senator Richard Blumenthal, Democrat from Connecticut, released the unidentified whistleblower's statement.

fraud occurred in only about four cases out of every 10 million mail ballots cast.

Since returning to office, Trump has said Republicans should be "taking over" vote counting in Democratic areas and launched a sweeping attempt to reinvestigate the 2020 election, despite a mountain of evidence that he lost fairly to Democrat Joe Biden.

Until Trump came out against mail voting in 2020, the system was used equally by both parties. Since then, it has become more common among Democratic voters. More than 29 percent of all voters in 2024 cast their ballots through the mail.

After Trump issued his executive order, Democrats and civil rights groups sued and won a ruling from US District Court Judge Indira Talwani in Boston barring implementation of the system before the November midterms. But without ruling on the legality of Trump's order, the Supreme Court's conservative majority last week found that was premature and overruled Talwani, momentarily clearing the way for its implementation.

On the night of Aug. 21, the Postal Service released a final rule outlining how it would im-

plement the order.

It said it would only send mail ballots for states that got approval for the design of their envelopes and submitted a list of voters receiving them through the still-not-active online portal. That rule gave plaintiffs a chance to sue again, and Talwani on Thursday night issued a 14-day restraining order against implementation of the measure.

The letter from Blumenthal and an accompanying summary of the whistleblower's statements says the Postal Service began work on the portal on June 15 and stopped on June 25 after Talwani's initial order. Then on July 29, the Postal Service restarted the work. That was when the administration appealed the judge's order to the Supreme Court. The high court did not strike Talwani's injunction down until Aug. 24.

Talwani last week found the Postal Service violated her order by continuing to work on the final rule, but she imposed no sanctions on the government. On Monday, she issued a ruling refusing to lift the restraining order that also said the Postal Service could continue work on its portal, as long as it wasn't forcing states to use it.

Mullins announces 2,000 ICE arrests in New York state

By **Dionne Searcey and Madeleine Ngo**
NEW YORK TIMES

Homeland Security Secretary Markwayne Mullin announced Tuesday that immigration officials had arrested 2,197 people in New York state in about a monthlong operation, suggesting an uptick in arrests compared with recent months.

Speaking at a news conference, Mullin described the enforcement push as a response to the lack of cooperation from Governor Kathy Hochul and Mayor Zohran Mamdani on the federal government's crackdown on unlawful immigration, which it has named "Operation Rotten Apple."

"Operation Rotten Apple was an operation we decided to take on because you have a very liberal-slash-socialist mayor here in New York City," he said. "You have a governor that refuses to work with us."

The New York operation, which took place between July 27 and Aug. 29, is part of a broader surge in ICE arrests nationwide as homeland security officials face pressure from the White House to ramp up enforcement. In July, immigration arrests reached a record high of 49,000, nearing the Trump administration's recent goal of 2,000 daily arrests.

In New York state, immigration arrests have been climbing after dropping to about 860 in April, according to federal data obtained by the Deportation Data Project, an academic group. More than 1,550 people were arrested in July, according to that data.

Homeland security officials on Tuesday emphasized that the operation was "not random enforcement" and that they were catching the "worst of the worst" criminals. But as arrests by Immigration and Customs Enforcement have climbed in recent months, the agency's operations have increasingly swept up immigrants without criminal records. A majority of the immigrants arrested in July were accused of violating civil immigration laws but had not been charged with or convicted of a crime, a New York Times analysis of federal data found.

At the news conference, Mullin was flanked by what appeared to be large mug shots with phrases such as "rape" and "kidnapping, murder," and a Homeland security news release said that those arrested in the operation included "murderers, rapists, pedophiles, drug traffickers and violent assailants." But Mullin also indicated that some of those arrested in the past month may not have had criminal records.

"Regardless if you're a criminal or not, if you entered this country and you cheated, you didn't come in the legal way, because there are people entering this country every single day legally," he said.

In response to a follow-up message from the Times, the department did not offer further clarity. Hochul, speaking at an unrelated news conference Tuesday, cast doubt on whether the more than 2,000 people arrested in the operation had criminal records.

DAILY BRIEFING

Two shot to death at Ariz. gay bar

Police in Arizona say a shooting at a Tucson gay bar that left three people dead, including the shooter, is being investigated as a possible hate crime.

Vincent Anthony Siqueiros, 42, and Cameron Davis Capara, 33, were shot in the parking lot of Venture-N shortly after midnight Monday, and both died at the scene, the Tucson Police Department said.

The suspect, Ousman Ceesay, 44, also suffered a gunshot wound and was pronounced dead at a hospital, according to the department.

Ceesay was carrying a note that listed several LGBTQ-IA+-associated businesses, according to a police news release, and initial evidence suggested he confronted the two victims in the parking lot before shooting them.

The investigation is ongoing, but there is no known active threat to the community, police said. Still, the department has increased its police presence around other gay-friendly businesses in the region.

"Bias-based crimes are especially heinous and have no place

in our community," Chief of Police Monica Prieto said. "Our investigators are thoroughly examining the evidence and pursuing all available leads as they work to establish the full circumstances surrounding this tragic incident."

The Police Department released few details about the shooting and did not say whether Ceesay knew the victims. The department also declined to immediately release details about Ceesay's manner of death beyond saying he had a gunshot wound.

The department's public information officer, James Horton, said investigators were awaiting details from the medical examiner to confirm Ceesay's injuries.

Flowers, candles, and photos marked a growing memorial to Siqueiros and Capara outside the bar Tuesday, and several community groups, including Tucson Queerstory, Southern Arizona Senior Pride, and the Southern Arizona AIDS Foundation, were planning a candlelight vigil for Wednesday night at a local park.

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REBECCA NOBLE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Flowers, candles, and photos were placed outside the Venture-N bar Tuesday in Tucson, Ariz.

Coroner to probe Pa. measles case

The Lancaster County coroner's office in Pennsylvania is investigating the death of a child who tested positive for measles, the county coroner said Tuesday.

Dr. Stephen Diamantoni said his office is still working to determine the cause of death. It was not clear whether this case was one of the two deaths announced by Pennsylvania state health officials last week or whether it represented an additional death.

The development comes amid a growing controversy over whether the two deaths reported by the state health department last week, one identified as an infant, were a result of measles or merely coincided with the infection — especially in the case of the infant, whose immediate cause of death was a lacerated spleen. State health officials have not released any

details about the second death.

The announcement of those deaths was followed by back and forth among federal, state, and local officials, including Diamantoni, who said last week his office had been notified of only one death. (In Pennsylvania, not all deaths must be reported to a coroner's office.)

The conflict escalated as Dr. Erica Schwartz, the new director of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, instructed staff not to include the two deaths in the agency's national measles count, breaking with the CDC's normal procedure of accepting the data reported by states. That move came after Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. said on social media that the deaths "may even have been altogether fabricated" by the office of Josh Shapiro, the Democratic governor.

NEW YORK TIMES

NYC stab victim recently gave birth

NEW YORK — On the last day of August, the sidewalks around Times Square were the usual tangle of tourists gawking at the huge electronic billboards and commuters rushing to catch subways and trains.

One of those commuters, Erin Piacenti, a young vice president at Bank of America who had just returned from five months of maternity leave, was headed home to New Jersey, to her baby girl.

As she walked near a street vendor selling sunglasses, a woman carrying two kitchen knives attacked her.

"She didn't say nothing," Aliou Dieye, the vendor, said of the assailant. "She walked up to her. She stabbed her in the stomach."

Piacenti, 32, was pronounced dead at a Manhattan hospital.

The attack was shocking for

the public way it played out in daylight on some of the busiest sidewalks in America, crowded with summer visitors.

And it ended in an equally public way: The attacker, Pamela Cisneros, 49, was surrounded by police officers and, after refusing to drop her knives and moving toward them, was shot dead just feet away from rush-hour traffic passing by.

Police said Cisneros attacked a second person as well.

Around 4:30 p.m., less than half a minute before fatally stabbing Piacenti, Cisneros was seen removing two knives from a Target bag and stabbing Tak Kam, 68, who was waiting to cross the street at West 41st Street and Seventh Avenue.

Kam, a Rhode Islander who was visiting his son in New York City, was in stable condition at Bellevue Hospital.

NEW YORK TIMES

Officer charged in Pa. shooting death

NORRISTOWN, Pa. — A Pennsylvania police officer who fatally shot a 22-year-old college student who had ended up at the wrong house late at night and was waiting for friends to pick him up, has been charged with voluntary manslaughter, a prosecutor said Tuesday.

Montgomery District Attorney Kevin Steele said Upper Pottsgrove Police Corporal Sean Farrell, 58, has been charged in the Aug. 23 death of Glenwood Earl Pysher IV.

The prosecutor said the officer had less-than-lethal options and did not need to resort to shooting Pysher during the en-

counter.

The Montgomery County Detective Bureau investigated the shooting and reviewed footage from Farrell's body-worn camera, the district attorney's office said in a news release.

"At the time of the shooting, the officer was a safe distance from Pysher behind a car, and the victim had his hands in the air and did not possess any type of weapon. Mr. Pysher was not a threat," Steele said in a news release.

An attorney for Pysher's family issued a statement thanking the prosecutor.

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Reporting corrections

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The World

DAILY BRIEFING

Husband, 12 men face rape charges

A trial began Tuesday of a British man accused of drug-ging and raping his unconscious wife over two decades, alongside a dozen men accused of conspiring with him.

The man, in his 60s and from Stockport in northern England, is being tried on dozens of charges including rape, sexual assault, and drugging his wife without her consent. They cover a period between 2004 and 2025, according to prosecutors, who have withheld the man's identity to protect the anonymity of his wife.

British police arrested the man in 2025. Since then, he pleaded guilty to 15 charges, including five counts of rape and one count of sharing intimate photos or video. Another 33 charges will be decided at

the trial.

Also on trial are 12 men who were accused of offenses between 2023 and 2025. Nine of them were charged with the woman's rape or sexual assault, and all of them with taking part in a conspiracy to abuse or rape her. The men have a variety of jobs, are ages 28 to 73, and come from across Britain.

In a news release in June, Greater Manchester Police described its investigation as one of "alleged drug-facilitated sexual abuse."

Prosecutors said that a 13th man, Keith Fotheringham, 59, from Dundee, Scotland, had pleaded guilty to conspiring to rape and drug the woman without her consent.

NEW YORK TIMES

Tractors clog Danish roads in protest

COPENHAGEN — Commuters heading into Denmark's capital Tuesday morning encountered an unusual traffic snarl: a 3-kilometer column of tractors crawling toward Copenhagen, carrying farmers protesting a proposed fertilizer law they say could upend their livelihoods.

One of them was Vagn Lundsteen, 69, who grows rapeseed, barley, wheat, corn, and peas west of the capital. "We're not just going to walk up to the guillotine and have our heads chopped off," he said from his tractor as he chugged toward the Danish parliament.

Hundreds of farmers and tractors gathered outside the parliament building as lawmakers discussed the fertilizer bill, which has broad cross-party approval and is widely expected to

pass in a vote Thursday.

The new rules would impose stricter limits on how much nitrogen farmers can send into nearby waters. To meet water quality targets, farmers in some areas would have to use less fertilizer, change crops, or farm some land less intensively. The rules would start taking effect next year.

The proposed rules are meant to limit water pollution, but farmers say they could cut yields and make some farms impossible to run profitably.

"If this is passed on Thursday as it stands now, I can't justify farming anymore," said Jens-Ole Dilling, a seventh-generation grain grower. Dilling said his family had worked the same land northwest of Copenhagen for 220 years.

NEW YORK TIMES

Israel captures Hamas official in Gaza

The Israeli government said Tuesday Israel had captured a senior Hamas official in the Gaza Strip, in an operation that Palestinian officials said had killed at least four people in the enclave, including two children.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the captured individual was the head of Hamas's internal security force, though he did not name the person. It was a rare daytime Israeli raid inside Hamas-controlled territory in Gaza, despite a nominal cease-fire there.

Hamas condemned the operation as the latest Israeli breach of the truce that began in October. In a statement, the Palestinian armed group said it had lodged a protest with Niko-

lay Mladenov, a senior official in President Trump's Board of Peace, which was established to oversee the cease-fire.

Many details of the raid remained unclear, but the Israeli military said "special forces" affiliated with the Shin Bet, Israel's domestic intelligence agency, had raided a building in Gaza to seize the Hamas official. The military declined to comment on reports that children had been killed.

The Hamas-run government said in a statement that Israel had sent covert operatives into Gaza City but that they were subsequently discovered, leading Israeli forces to bombard the area so as to escape.

NEW YORK TIMES



JAAFAR ASHTIYEH/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

People inspected a mosque that was reportedly attacked by Israeli settlers in the Palestinian village of Bazzaryah.

UN slashes food aid to West Bank

ROME — The United Nations' food agency said Tuesday it is halving food assistance in the Israeli-occupied West Bank because of severe funding shortages and warned it may be forced to make further cuts in Gaza, where it supports 1.5 million people.

The UN World Food Program said it will reduce assistance in the West Bank from 400,000 people to 200,000 beginning this month. In Gaza, it reduced the value of cash assistance by 40 percent for 375,000 people in July and said additional cuts will be unavoidable unless it secures new funding.

"In Gaza we've already had to start reducing the amount of cash that we're giving to around

75,000 families," Claire Nevill, WFP spokesperson for the Palestinian territories, said. "Now, the same is happening for WFP's West Bank operation."

WFP said it urgently needs an additional \$386 million over the next six months to assist an estimated 2 million food-insecure people across Gaza and the West Bank.

"All of this pressure has been building in terms of the economic downturn coupled with increasing settler violence and incursions on land, people sort of losing access to their livestock and agricultural land, which has also now had an impact on people's food security," Nevill said.

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PADDY PATTERNS



ANUPAM NATH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A farmer weeded a field on the outskirts in Guwahati, India, on Tuesday.

US launches airstrikes on Iran

Exchanges attacks for 2nd time in 3 days

By Pranav Baskar and Farnaz Fassihi
NEW YORK TIMES

The US military said Tuesday that it had struck military targets in Iran in retaliation for Iranian attacks on ships and US forces in the region, raising the risk of the conflict escalating once again.

Hours later, Iran's Revolutionary Guard announced that the country had launched a "regretful response" to the United States' strikes, though the group did not say how it was retaliating or where. It also accused the United States of bombing sites on the southern coast of Iran, including several civilian locations.

The exchange of strikes came after the two countries traded attacks Sunday, puncturing a monthlong calm since President Trump pulled back after concerns over dwindling US munition stockpiles and unveiled a campaign to strangle Iran's economy. The hostilities underscore that the conflict, which began six months ago, appears far from a durable solution.

US Central Command did not specify where it was striking in Iran, but it said the attacks were targeting the Revolutionary Guard. Iranian state media said projectiles had hit sites in Chabahar and Konarak, two southern port cities east of the Strait of Hormuz.

In a social media post, Trump said the US attacks were "large and powerful, and in retaliation for the Iranians' failed attempt at adding sea mines to the Strait." He added, "If the failed Nation of

Aircraft carrier close to Thai R&R spot

By Richard C. Paddock and Phuriphat Dejsuphong
NEW YORK TIMES

PATTAYA, Thailand — A strenuous nine months at sea. No days off. Enduring repeated missile and drone attacks. Reports of supply shortages and deteriorating mental health among the crew.

Now the 5,000 or so sailors and Marines aboard a beleaguered aircraft carrier, the USS Abraham Lincoln, will have a few days off. The warship will dock Wednesday in Thailand, local officials said, near Pattaya, a beach town notorious for its free-wheeling atmosphere and red-light districts.

The crew is expected to have shore leave until Sunday, when the carrier is set to depart for its home port of San Diego, the mayor of Pattaya, Poramet Ngampichet, said after meeting with US officials. He welcomed the port call and said the area

Iran retaliates for this very justified attack, they will be hit again at a much harder and higher level."

Two Iranian officials, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss the US attacks, said the strikes hit several sites across Iran's southern shores, including a military base in Bandar Abbas, the perimeter of the commercial airport on Qeshm Island, and targets in Sirik and Jask. The officials said the attacks caused significant damage.

The deputy governor of the Hormozgan province, Ahmad Nafisi, told state television that a

was well prepared for the influx of visitors, noting that Chonburi province, which includes Pattaya, receives 28 million visitors a year.

"Handling 4,000 to 5,000 people is actually routine for Pattaya," Poramet said. "We are not worrying."

The stopover comes after a long Middle East deployment for the Lincoln, which has become an emblem of how the war in Iran has strained the US military. The nuclear-powered ship left San Diego on Nov. 21, briefly docking in Guam in December and later picking up supplies in Oman. Resupplying the carrier became a problem after Iran destroyed a vital US Navy base in Bahrain early in the fighting.

In recent weeks, Democratic senators have raised concerns about the carrier's lengthy deployment, including reports of poor living conditions and a lack of downtime for the crew.

wedding ceremony and a residential home were struck in the city of Kuhestak. Nafisi said two people were killed and at least 20 people were wounded. Central Command did not immediately comment.

Oil prices jumped and were up about 4 percent after the US military said it had retaliated over Iranian strikes on commercial ships. Two ships were attacked within minutes of each other on Monday, according to Marisks, a risk consulting firm.

The US military said Sunday that its forces had bombarded Iranian troops on Larak Island that were preparing to launch

rockets armed with mines into the Strait of Hormuz, the vital shipping corridor for oil and gas. Such an artillery weapon would be unusual, and it was not possible to independently confirm the military's report.

The Iranian Foreign Ministry said several people were killed and wounded in Sunday's strikes but did not provide specifics.

The Revolutionary Guard said it retaliated by firing at bases in Jordan and the United Arab Emirates that host US military personnel. The Jordanian authorities said they had intercepted eight missiles in their airspace, while the UAE military said it had "responded to" a drone from Iran. There were no reports of damage or casualties.

Even as the fighting slowed in recent weeks, there had been few signs of resolution to the issues at the heart of the war that Trump began in late February alongside Israel. A "memorandum of understanding" between Iran and the United States quickly broke down after it was signed in late June.

Since then, Iran has fired on ships passing through the Strait of Hormuz, severely curbing the ability of US allies to export oil and gas, and gaining significant leverage. Iranian officials have demanded steep and immediate concessions in exchange for reopening the strait, which US officials have rejected.

The Trump administration has sought to squeeze Iran economically by enforcing a naval blockade on Iranian ports and increasing sanctions on Iran. But thoroughly enforcing sanctions is notoriously hard, and Iran's case would require messy run-ins with allies and powerful rivals capable of retaliation, most notably China.

Sanctions cut off Iranians from study abroad tests

By Erika Solomon and Sanam Mahoozi
NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump's latest sanctions against Iran have forced the cancellation of English proficiency and graduate exams that Iranians rely on to qualify for studying abroad, students and testing services say, penalizing Iranians who are eager to foster relationships with the outside world.

Among those organizations that canceled exams is the Educational Testing Service, which runs the Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL) and the Graduate Record Examination (GRE). They are two of the most widely used exams for students seeking admission to English-language graduate programs worldwide.

The Duolingo English Test, an online standardized exam in-

creasingly used by students applying for undergraduate programs, has also suspended testing for anyone who is Iranian and cannot register as a citizen of another country.

Iranian students whose exams were canceled described a growing sense of despair. They said the sanctions were hurting the people who most want to pursue relations with an outside world so often closed off to them by Iran's clerical rulers and decades of economic isolation.

"I feel like the right to strive for a better life, even the right to dream of one, has been taken away from me," said Shahrzad, a 28-year-old who was notified this week of her TOEFL cancellation. Like other Iranian students interviewed for this article, she spoke on the condition that her last name be withheld for fear of government retaliation for

speaking to foreign media.

For 43 nights, Shahrzad said, she and her husband stayed up late after putting their small daughter to bed to prepare for their TOEFL exams. They hoped to study in Europe and start a new life out of reach of Iran's authoritarian rulers. She said she planned to get a higher degree in education, while her husband would continue his studies as a mechanical engineer.

"Isn't America known by everyone as the land of dreams?" she asked. "Why is this country taking our dreams away from us?"

The Trump administration last week announced expanded sanctions, which aim to further isolate Iran at a time when its economy is already in free-fall amid rapid depreciation of its currency and a fuel crisis, as well as soaring inflation and unem-

ployment. More and more Iranians, worn down by war, are sinking into poverty.

Previous rounds of US sanctions offered exemptions to allow educational exchange and exams to continue, but the new measures suspended General License G, which had permitted educational services to be offered to Iranians.

Kristen Mitchell, a spokesperson for the Educational Testing Service, confirmed that the TOEFL and GRE test offerings in Iran were canceled but said Iranians could travel abroad for testing. "We are actively working to understand the scope and duration of this change and pursue any available paths to resume service," she said.

A spokesperson for Duolingo confirmed the cancellation of its testing services because of the new US measures.

On Ireland’s coast, questions of war ties surround factory

Critics say plant supplies Russian weapons makers

By Megan Specia and Jeanna Smialek
NEW YORK TIMES

AUGHINISH, Ireland — The industrial plant rises over a flat stretch of the Shannon estuary in County Limerick, Ireland, a harsh silhouette against an otherwise picturesque landscape. Tall chimneys jut skyward, puffing plumes of white smoke.

Much of the ground is stained a rusty red, the residue of bauxite ore that is refined into alumina here before being shipped off to be smelted into aluminum.

The Aughinish Alumina plant, currently owned by the Russian company Rusal, has stood here for more than four decades and employs hundreds of local people. It is Europe’s largest alumina refinery. But it has come under scrutiny after The Irish Times and an investigative consortium reported that a large quantity of the alumina processed here was being

shipped to Russian smelters, which sell finished aluminum to a company that supplies Russian weapons manufacturers.

The findings ignited a heated debate in Europe, casting this small place on Ireland’s west coast into the center of a dispute over how member states could avoid feeding Russia’s war in Ukraine. Some European lawmakers questioned whether the alumina produced here should be sold to Russia at all, even if that would come at a cost to local industry and to the European supply chain of an essential raw material.

The Ukrainian Embassy in Ireland said in June it had “serious concern regarding the continued export of alumina from Ireland to the Russian Federation.” And President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine made a veiled reference to the plant during a visit to Dublin the following month, saying “raw material that ends in Russia is used against us” and should be halted.

In Ireland, a country with a tradition of military neutrality, the accusations struck a nerve. Kirsty Griffin lives on a hillside

overlooking the plant, and its chimneys are visible from her upstairs windows.

“We are a neutral nation, so it’s a bone of contention,” she said, standing in her garden, where wildflowers blossomed. She added that there were other issues with the plant, saying locals didn’t know how big it would become when it was first proposed and had raised concerns in recent years about the bauxite residue pools.

“It did bring a lot of jobs, but we are trying to mind this place, and we have all this just over the hill,” she said, gesturing to the landscape. “If the Russians have to leave there in the morning, what happens to the mud pools?”

For others, the sudden focus on the plant’s links to Russia has felt like an unwelcome spotlight on their quiet corner of the country.

Michael Keane, who owns an organic dairy farm nearby, was hesitant to discuss the situation, he said, partly because the site had been a boon to the local economy and created employment. He recalled how, in the decades before the plant’s arrival, there had been few opportunities for work



PAULO NUNES DOS SANTOS/NEW YORK TIMES

Kirsty Griffin, who lives on a hillside overlooking the plant, cited concerns about the factory’s impact on the landscape.

and many locals had emigrated. Then construction began.

“It was like a gold rush — they came from everywhere, all over Ireland and around the world, as well,” Keane said of the workers taking part in the construction. “And they just plopped it in the middle of this green island.”

After The Irish Times published its report in March, the Irish government conducted a formal investigation, which it

has shared with EU officials and has briefed Ukraine on but has not made public. Irish Prime Minister Micheál Martin said on a visit to Kyiv that the government “has not found concrete or definitive evidence linking the alumina to a weapons manufacturer in Russia.”

But he added, “That said, neither has it found definitive evidence that alumina may not be going to weapons manufacturers.”

In a statement, Aughinish Alumina said it took the accusations “with the utmost seriousness” and had cooperated fully with the government’s investigation. It said that the plant and its parent company “have developed a framework to provide further enhanced traceability of Aughinish’s alumina” that would provide “verifiable evidence” that its alumina had no link to Russia’s military.

Some 52 percent of Aughinish alumina goes to Russia and 34 percent to France, Sweden, and the Netherlands combined, according to The Financial Times. Potential trade restrictions on the plant could be consequential for Ireland and Europe. Aughinish supplies two of Western Europe’s largest aluminum smelters, which get the majority of their raw material from the Irish plant.

Ricardo Cardoso, an EU spokesperson, said that the European Commission, the executive arm of the bloc, was reviewing the Irish government’s report and that “we will continue our close engagement with the Irish authorities on the appropriate follow-up.”

Germany condemns Moscow for failed drone attack at Leipzig airport

By Christopher F. Schuetze
NEW YORK TIMES

BERLIN — Weeks after an explosive-laden drone was found at a German airport near a Ukrainian cargo plane, the German government blamed Russia for the incident and announced significant consequences for Moscow including the closure of a Russian consulate.

Alexander Dobrindt, Germany’s interior minister, said Tuesday that investigators had proof that the drone was controlled by agents who were working “on behalf of Russian state entities.”

“Taken together, police investigations, patterns of operation, and intelligence findings prove Russian responsibility for the attempted attack,” Dobrindt said at a news conference. “The federal government therefore concludes that Russia is responsible for the hybrid attack.”

The spokesperson for the Kremlin, Dmitry Peskov, said Germany had not provided proof of Russian involvement. “When such serious accusations are made, they must be backed by something,” he told reporters. “Unless I am mistaken, no evidence has been presented. It is obvious that Germany is proceeding down a path of further escalation.”

That echoed remarks by the Russian Foreign Ministry spokesperson, Maria Zakharova, who vowed Russia would take an unspecified response, according to Tass, a Russian state news agency. Germany’s countermeasures against Moscow were being taken “under an absolutely contrived and far-fetched pretext,” she added, according to the agency.

Germany’s accusation is among the gravest recent claims of Russian subterfuge in Europe, where leaders have been locked in a standoff with Moscow over its invasion of Ukraine in 2022.

It follows warnings from European officials that Moscow is increasingly launching small-scale

clandestine attacks at countries that support Ukraine, including by jamming aviation-navigation networks over the Baltic Sea, sending drones into Belgian airspace, and planting explosives on train lines in Poland that are used to ship military aid to Ukraine.

To punish Russia, the German government said Tuesday it would shut down the Russian diplomatic mission in Bonn; cancel a contract for a Russian cultural center in Berlin; tighten restrictions on Russians traveling to Germany; and ask EU officials to place more Russians under Europe-wide sanctions.

German Foreign Minister Johann Wadepful joined Dobrindt at the briefing to criticize Russia for refusing efforts to deescalate tensions between the two countries. “The Russian leadership has made a conscious decision to further significantly damage our already heavily strained bilateral relations,” Wadepful said.

Several European leaders quickly expressed support for Germany. British Prime Minister Andy Burnham said in a statement that Britain “stands in full solidarity with Germany following Russia’s egregious and reckless attack,” while Ursula von der Leyen, the head of the European Union’s executive branch, used similar language to back Berlin.

The drone was found at Leipzig/Halle Airport in eastern Germany in the early hours of Aug. 4 by an airport worker, who stepped on it to prevent it from flying away and then called security. The drone was equipped with military-grade explosives, investigators found, and with what appeared to be a faulty detonator.

Airport security footage later showed the drone had crashed into a wing of a Ukrainian cargo plane stationed there. Investigators said the drone would have caused significant damage and possibly killed people if it had exploded because the plane’s fuel tanks are in that wing.



VLADYSLAV MUSHENKO/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Two boys looked up at a heavily damaged residential building following a sustained Russian aerial assault in Kyiv on Tuesday.

Russian strikes batter Kyiv for 6th straight day

At least 12 killed in aerial attacks

By Samya Kullab
ASSOCIATED PRESS

KYIV — Russia bombarded the Ukrainian capital for more than 12 hours overnight and into Tuesday, killing at least a dozen people in another aerial onslaught that authorities said was aimed at menacing civilians.

The strikes marked an unprecedented sixth straight day of heavy Russian attacks on Kyiv since Russia launched the full-scale invasion of its neighbor more than 4½ years ago. The consecutive aerial assaults are designed to grind down civilians by disrupting daily life, Ukrainian officials have said.

The cruise and ballistic missiles, jet-powered drones, glide bombs, and artillery salvos target-

ed Kyiv as well as eight other regions. The strikes wounded more than a dozen people, including three children, just as millions of Ukrainian children returned to classes Tuesday to start their fifth school year since the invasion.

The European Union’s top diplomat said Russia’s army is struggling to make progress on the front line and wants to scare off Ukraine’s Western backers with its air campaign.

“Russia’s war is becoming more ruthless and destructive, but it’s unfortunately not closer to ending,” EU foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas said at a meeting of the bloc’s defense ministers in Ireland. “Russia’s army is bogged down on the ground, and that is why they are killing civilians from the skies.”

The latest attack struck civilian infrastructure and residential buildings in several districts of Kyiv, authorities said, with

eight people killed in the city itself and four others in the surrounding region.

Six employees of state-owned railway company Ukrzaliznytsia were among those killed in Kyiv when a ballistic missile hit a depot and other property, company chairman Oleksandr Pertsovskiy said in a social media post.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said the dead included an Indian citizen.

Nearly 350 emergency workers were deployed in Kyiv and the surrounding region, Zelensky said.

The Russian Defense Ministry said its forces carried out a “massive strike” on Ukraine with “precision-guided weapons” and long-range drones. The assault targeted facilities that manufacture and store weapons as well as military-related infrastructure, it said.

Ukraine’s air force said the at-

tack began at 6 p.m. Monday, using ballistic, cruise and anti-radar missiles, as well as 218 drones and decoys. About a third of the drones were jet-powered, making them much harder to intercept than propeller-driven versions.

The main Russian targets were in the Kyiv and southern Odesa regions, the air force said in a statement.

The attack on the Odesa region on the Black Sea damaged civilian infrastructure and wounded one person, regional head Oleh Kiper said.

Two residential buildings were damaged, while a fire broke out at a textile factory. Russian forces also struck the Orlivka international ferry crossing on the border with Romania, he said.

Russia also shelled the northern Zhytomyr region, starting fires at an industrial facility and a warehouse, Ukraine’s Emergency Service said.

China censors online videos of deadly flash floods in Tibet

By Alexandra Stevenson
NEW YORK TIMES

Rescue workers were only just starting to assess the scope of loss and destruction from deadly Himalayan floods last week when Chinese authorities turned to another challenge: unapproved narratives of the devastation.

Censors quickly deleted videos and eyewitness accounts from social media. Journalists working for state media and social media influencers were warned not to report on casualties or missing people unless their reports aligned with official announcements. People who questioned the official death toll were given “administrative penalties,” punishment that typically involves either a fine of up to

\$150 or up to 10 days in prison.

When some foreign news outlets noted the contrast in coverage between Tibet, where no foreign journalist is allowed to report, and Nepal, where international media have been able to travel freely, the Chinese government called the reporting “malicious speculation.”

The immediate and widespread crackdown on speech reflects two challenges facing China’s ruling Communist Party, which tightly controls information across the country.

The crisis has focused attention on Tibet, a region with a history of unrest and protest centered around demands for more autonomy that are sensitive to Beijing. And it has hit both China and its neighbor, Ne-

pal, where just across the border dozens of journalists have arrived to report witness accounts and talk to families and local residents. That difference has raised questions about what is happening in China.

“With this one, even if the Chinese side has information control, on the Nepal side there is a lot of information coming out,” said Xiao Qiang, the editor-in-chief of China Digital Times, a nonprofit that collects data on censorship and archives work that has been censored on China’s internet. “It makes the Chinese government feel that controlling information around this event is harder.”

Tibet, which was annexed by Beijing in the 1950s, is rigidly governed and has been a place of

protest, including self-immolations by Tibetans. Foreign journalists are not allowed to travel there unless invited on heavily monitored and choreographed official tours. Tibetans risk detention for speaking to reporters.

When official memorials were held Tuesday in Gyirong County, Tibet, as workers continued to clear roads and search for bodies, China’s state media showed images of doctors, police officers, emergency workers, and officials standing in mourning.

“Throughout the rescue efforts, cadres and party members stood on the front lines, stepping up to take full responsibility,” the state-controlled People’s Daily wrote in a front-page article last

week. “United as one, braving all perils,” the article went on.

Largely absent from the reporting have been images of the injured, the dead, and their families.

The flooding killed at least 987 people in Nepal and 16 in Tibet, according to official tallies. Nearly 4,000 people were missing in Nepal as of Tuesday, according to the country’s disaster agency. In Tibet, 546 people were still missing, according to Chinese state media, which did not publish any names. China’s most recent figures are from Aug. 29.

“Search and rescue and emergency relief work in the disaster area are being carried out in an intense and orderly manner,” said Guo Jiakun, a spokes-

person for China’s Foreign Ministry. “Our release of information is public, transparent and timely.”

One day after flood waters ravaged villages around the Himalayas, government censors were already removing videos from social media platforms. The cybersecurity department of China’s Ministry of Public Security quickly tracked down people posting specific numbers of dead and missing and accused them of spreading false information online. The department announced 10 cases in five different provinces. In one case, a user was penalized for posting that the disaster was “not that severe, probably around 500 people, and the missing might all be dead.”

Suspect in Kirk killing has case sent to trial

Faces aggravated murder charge

By Hannah Schoenbaum and Matthew Brown
ASSOCIATED PRESS

PROVO, Utah — The murder case against the Utah man accused of assassinating conservative activist Charlie Kirk last year is headed for trial, and the defendant could face the death penalty if he's convicted.

Utah District Judge Tony Graf on Tuesday sided with prosecutors who said they had “overwhelming” evidence that suspect Tyler Robinson shot Kirk once in the neck as the ally of President Trump spoke to a crowd of thousands last September in Orem, Utah. One of Robinson’s attorneys entered a not-guilty plea on his behalf following Graf’s decision.

Robinson’s lawyers tried to block a trial or at least take the death penalty off the table, arguing that prosecutors failed to show Kirk’s shooting placed others around him at risk of death. That’s an aggravating factor under the law that makes Robinson eligible for capital punishment.

Kirk’s family called the ruling “an important step in our family’s pursuit of justice.”

“Every step in this process carries the weight of all that Charlie’s murder has taken from his family, especially his children who will grow up without their father,” the statement said. “We are grateful to all who have continued to pray for us, support us, and stand with us through a year of unimaginable grief.”

Prosecutors said Robinson shot Kirk from a rooftop more than 400 feet away, knowing that he could have easily missed, injuring or killing other



PHOTOS BY FRANCISCO KJOLSETH-POOL/GETTY IMAGES

Deputy Utah County Attorney Ryan McBride pointed to suspect Tyler Robinson during a preliminary hearing Tuesday. Robinson is accused of fatally shooting Charlie Kirk. District Judge Tony Graf (right) decided Robinson could face aggravated murder charges.

people.

Graf had the option to send the case to trial on a lesser charge of murder, which carries a minimum sentence of 15 years and a maximum of life in prison. The judge said his decision to approve the aggravated murder charge was based on “the documented position of several individuals in and around the canopy area” where Kirk was speaking, among other factors.

“Tyler James Robinson shot and killed Charlie Kirk because he disagreed with him, and he did it by firing a high-powered rifle into a crowd of over 3,000 people, which created a great risk of death that anyone would know about,” Ryan McBride, a prosecutor, told the court.

The hearing Tuesday in state court came after prosecutors in July spent five days presenting evidence.

The 23-year-old defendant



turned himself in a day after the shooting at Utah Valley University. Robinson’s lawyers have not offered alternative theories for Kirk’s death.

Kirk’s parents, Robert and Kathryn Kirk, entered the heavily secured facility arm in arm before the hearing at the Fourth Judicial District Courthouse in Provo. Erika Kirk was seated beside them. The family stepped out during part of a prosecutor’s argument that described the shooting.

A few local members of Kirk’s organization, Turning Point USA, arrived with signs expressing their support for Erika Kirk but were told by security that they could not have them on the court property.

Before his death, Kirk and

Turning Point USA galvanized the conservative youth vote to help Trump win a second presidential term.

Prosecutors have argued that an engraved bullet found in the suspected murder weapon shows that Kirk was targeted for how the defendant perceived his politics. The inscription “Hey Facist! CATCH!” is an “overt political reference,” they argued in court documents.

A handwritten note that prosecutors allege Robinson left for his romantic partner read in part, “I had the opportunity to take out Charlie Kirk, and I took it.” They also allege Robinson wrote in a text message about Kirk: “I had enough of his hatred. Some hate can’t be negotiated out.”

Editors revise ethics code for journalists

Reflects rise of AI, evolving media landscape

By Jocelyn Noveck
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Walk into a corner of a newsroom somewhere and you can often find it affixed to a bulletin board, perhaps peeking out from behind the coffee pot: the Society of Professional Journalists’s Code of Ethics. It’s less than a thousand words, fitting neatly on a poster.

But those words — organized around four key journalistic principles — are important enough, asserts Dan Axelrod, that they just might save our democracy.

“I’m going to just say it,” said Axelrod, chair of the SPJ Ethics Committee and former longtime Gannett business reporter. “This is the way to protect democracy. This is to protect society. There but for the grace of God goes a society without journalists.”

Axelrod is talking not only about the existence of the code but the need, every so often, to update it. It’s a laborious process, taking about a year and countless hours of meetings and feedback, virtual and in person.

Yet as the media landscape seems to shift daily and new technologies emerge, SPJ has decided that the time is at hand — for the first time in 12 years, and only the sixth in the code’s century-long history.

The seriousness of the undertaking brought the committee and other media ethics experts to Indianapolis in June, after lots of virtual meetings. Seems it wasn’t the most relaxing way to spend a weekend.

“Passions definitely got heated,” Axelrod said.

“Well, there were no fist-fights,” quipped his colleague, Chris Roberts, vice chair of the committee and a journalism professor at the University of Alabama. He explained there was “a lot of smithing of the words.”

US judges reveal panic buttons, private security in threat report

By Sudhin Thanawala
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Federal judges have varied their commutes, hired private security, and fortified their homes, including with panic buttons, amid a barrage of threats and harassment in recent months that has left many of them anxious about their safety, according to two new studies.

In an astonishing admission, one judge acknowledged considering an alternative ruling to avoid vitriol that could endanger the judge’s family. The federal judge, like some of the others interviewed for the studies, spoke to the authors on condition of anonymity.

The reports follow a spike in threats against federal judges. “Security incidents of significant concern” increased 57 percent in the year that ended in September 2025 and were on pace to rise again this year, according to a March report by the agency that administers the US court system.

While some US judges have spoken publicly about threats, the new studies by legal scholars at New York University, the University of California Berkeley, and the Brennan Center for Justice are based on detailed testimony from dozens of judges. Together, they present a chilling portrait of a judicial branch under extreme stress.

“We are in a different era,” said Amrit Singh, director of the Rule of Law Lab at New York University and lead author of one of the studies. “The volume, intensity, character, and modalities of the threats that we are witnessing today are new.”

Judges told Singh they felt overwhelmed, had trouble sleeping, and had installed security cameras and panic buttons. Many were worried about their families.

Singh declined to reveal more information about the judge who considered an alternative ruling, but the judge recalled feeling gripped by fear and agonizing for nearly an

hour before sticking with the decision the law required.

In the second study, one judge reported having home floor plans leaked and building a safe room. The judge, who asked to remain anonymous, received more than 700 threatening phone calls after hearing a Trump administration immi-

‘We are in a different era. The volume, intensity, character, and modalities of the threats ... are new.’

AMRIT SINGH, *director of the Rule of Law Lab at NYU*

gration case.

“Long term, there really is a danger to the rule of law from these threats,” said Gowri Ramachandran, director of elections and security at the Brennan Center and coauthor of the second report on judicial threats.

The NYU-Berkeley report is based on interviews with 32 active US district and appellate judges — half nominated by Democrats and the other half by Republicans — as well as two active magistrate judges. The Brennan Center interviewed 35 sitting and retired federal judges, eight of whom were nominated by Republican presidents.

The reports recommend adequate funding for judicial security and additional efforts to protect judges’ personal information. The NYU-Berkeley report also calls for more prosecutions of people making threats, noting that there have been few cases.

US District Judge Esther Salas participated in interviews for both studies. She said Tuesday that repeated attacks on judges by President Trump and

his administration have made her more worried about judicial safety today than she was immediately after her son, Daniel Anderl, was shot and killed by a litigant posing as a deliveryman in 2020. The attack at her home also left her husband, Mark, wounded.

Since then, scores of judges have been threatened by unsolicited pizzas delivered to their homes, sometimes in Anderl’s name.

Trump has called a district judge who ruled against one of his immigration moves “crooked” and suggested without evidence that US Supreme Court justices who struck down his tariffs were motivated by foreign interests.

Salas fears people will become desensitized to harmful rhetoric against the judicial branch, which she said was “under assault.”

“What Mark has been through and what our family has endured, I can’t describe with mere words,” she said in a phone interview. “But what I can say is this: We know what is at stake.”

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PRIMARY 2026

Markey turns back challenge from Moulton

►SENATE
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ment and calling for a new generation of leadership isn’t easy, but it is necessary,” he said. “We started conversations that needed to happen, and I will never stop pushing the Democratic Party and our country to look toward the future.”

With a win in November, Markey would return to Washington for a third full six-year term as the junior senator and extend his time in Washington into a sixth decade.

Markey’s primary victory tells the story of a race in which, despite Moulton’s attempts, age appears to have played little role in many voters’ decisions about whether to back an incumbent who will be 86 by the time his next term would end.

The dynamic complicates the emerging national narrative of Democratic politics in this year’s midterm elections, during which a historic number of incumbent lawmakers have lost primary challenges due to perceptions they had been in office too long, were insufficiently progressive — or both.

Markey ran well to the left of his 47-year old rival, embracing staunch progressive policies — Medicare for All being his most common talking point — as national left-wing figures like Vermont Senator Bernie Sanders and New York Representative Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez embraced him. Markey said shortly before their first debate in July that, should he win, his next term would be his last, saying he needed “to finish this progressive agenda, and then I will step down.”

Moulton repeatedly hammered his argument that Markey’s age was a liability and that new leaders were needed to tackle contemporary problems. Still, many voters said they were skeptical of his liberal bona fides.

This contest did not come close to attracting the national or statewide energy, fund-raising, or media attention that Markey’s battle with Joseph Kennedy III did six years ago. Amid general voter indifference and relative lack of enthusiasm for the candidates, Markey’s ability to rally the progressive faithful was enough to hand him another term this time around in what was expected to be a low-turnout contest.

Much of the race involved both Markey and Moulton vying to prove their progressive credi-

bility to primary voters, as well as their desire to stand out in a race where both candidates often landed on the same side of national issues.

With few genuine policy differences between them, the race was contentious and, sometimes bitter. In their second debate, Moulton unveiled a narrative that Markey was somehow implicated in the Epstein files, a claim that the congressman pushed with little to no evidence and that Markey called “reprehensible” and “character assassination.”

Markey, meanwhile, criticized Moulton as beholden to his financial supporters in the private equity sector. The senator’s supporters went harsher, with Representative Ayanna Pressley in the final weekend calling Moulton’s past comments on trans youth in sports “disqualifying” and saying that Democrats cannot afford “mediocre” representatives.

Moulton had suggested in 2024 that identity politics were to blame for the party’s electoral losses, saying he would not want his two young daughters “getting run over on a playing field by a male or formerly male athlete.”

Moulton has since, and repeatedly this campaign, apologized to the trans community for his comments, saying “he was sorry if my comments hurt you.”

“We don’t accept a younger politician with older politics,” transgender activist Tyler Hack, who founded a political action committee to elect pro-trans candidates to federal office, said at Markey’s election night party. “Throwing trans kids under the bus is . . . a dealbreaker.”

Even as the snipes became sharper, public opinion polls showed a largely consistent race, with Markey often in the lead by double digits. After a Suffolk/Globe poll showed Markey with a double-digit lead last month, Moulton dismissed polling in this election cycle as being “wildly off.”

But the factors that contributed to polling misses elsewhere — like significant consolidation for one candidate or onslaughts of outside spending — weren’t present in Massachusetts. Markey enjoyed far more support from the party establishment and key groups throughout the entire campaign. Moulton also had comparatively few backers in local offices around the state, and zero public supporters among his Massachusetts col-



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Representative Seth Moulton hugged a supporter after conceding defeat Tuesday night.

leagues in Washington.

While Moulton was the beneficiary of the lion’s share of outside spending in the race, largely through a super PAC funded by his supporters, it was not enough to make the contest closer.

Moulton, a six-term congressman, swept into office 12 years ago by topping a longtime incumbent. But Markey’s ability to cast himself as the ideological choice among a primary electorate that disproportionately leans left paid off.

Doug Rubin, a senior adviser to Moulton’s campaign, told the Globe that “we had a theory of the case that voters were looking for change,” but that “clearly voters in Massachusetts were looking for the future that Markey provided.”

“So credit to them. They ran a very effective campaign,” Rubin said. “The senator has already obviously had a very long and good career, and people really like him.”

Speaking to reporters on Tuesday night in Medford, Deaton, who ran unopposed in the GOP primary, indicated he would put up a spirited fight in the general election. Deaton ran for the Senate two years ago, losing to Senator Elizabeth Warren.

“I want people to get past labels and look at who’s the best



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Sara Collina of Washington, D.C., watched the news of Senator Ed Markey’s victory with her daughter Natalie and husband, Tom, in Boston.

candidate in each race,” he said. “In the race between me versus Ed Markey, I’m the better candidate, not because of age, not because of how long he’s been in office, because I have real solutions to the problems that people face.”

As Moulton supporters and staff continued to mingle at the Plumbers Local 12 union hall after he conceded the race, several expressed hope he would remain in politics.

“I hope he would” run for office again, said Lei Huang, 59, a consultant whose teenage

daughter volunteered for Moulton. “He has good clarity on what he wants to achieve.”

Melissa Woods, 39, voted for Markey in Allston Tuesday, citing her perspective that he is “just the more seriously progressive candidate.”

Markey’s age, however, was also top of mind for voters, regardless of who they ultimately supported. Betty Ellis, 76, said her decision to vote for Markey was a tough one.

“I really do feel like after 80, you know, age is really a factor,” Ellis, of Cambridge, said. “But I

wasn’t thrilled with Moulton, and I thought, ‘Well, I feel like Markey has done a great job.’ I feel like he’s a man of integrity, and if he’s feeling too old, he will step down.”

Norah Burch, 53, said in Allston that she voted for Markey because he’s “doing a great job for however long he’s been doing it.”

“People are like, ‘Oh, he’s so old.’ But I don’t think Moulton’s got what it takes. I don’t care how old he is,” Burch said.

Some older voters were turned off by Moulton’s closing attack on Markey: hammering him for stumbling over details about artificial intelligence programs in their final debate. Moulton’s TV ads highlighting the flub blanketed the airwaves in the closing weeks of the campaign — which Cheryl Hassan, a retired chiropractor from Lynnfield, said she “personally hated.”

“I don’t know either what [AI programs] I use,” Hassan said. “And I’m not stupid.”

Globe correspondent Audrey Tomlin and Kelly Garrity of the Globe staff contributed to this report. Samantha J. Gross can be reached at samantha.gross@globe.com. Follow her @samanthajgross. Sam Brodey can be reached at sam.brodey@globe.com.

Lynch, Neal turn back challenges

►HOUSE
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party in Springfield flanked by his grandchildren, to roaring applause from about 100 supporters.

“I’m going to say this firmly: There is not a family in Western or Central Massachusetts that has not benefited from my work or been impacted by my influence in Congress,” Neal told the crowd, touting some of his accomplishments when he was chair of the House Ways and Means Committee from 2021 to 2024.

There were no Republicans on the primary ballot for the First Congressional District.

In his remarks, Neal reminded the crowd of the high stakes in the upcoming midterm elections in November, in which Democrats hope to win the majority and the committee gavels that go with it.

“We intend to stand up to Donald Trump on the cost of living and on the tariff issue as well, and what it’s doing to the American family,” Neal said of the Democratic agenda.

Lynch, too, appeared headed for a comfortable win over his younger challenger.

“This is the honor of my life to represent the people of the Eighth Congressional District,” he said at his campaign party. After thanking his family, staff, and supporters, Lynch turned his focus to November.

“We want to try to take back the House of Representative for the Democrats,” Lynch said. “I don’t know about you, but I want my country back. . . . We are done with the craziness of

Donald Trump. We are done with him eroding the rights of all of our people.”

Election night parties for the Eighth District candidates had different atmospheres. At first subdued, Lynch’s gathering in the back room of hip Southie bar The Playwright, picked up as the results began to accumulate in his favor, with a cheer erupting as local news flashed an update on the race that showed him pulling away.

Meanwhile in Jamaica Plain, about 100 Roath supporters crammed into the Jeanie Johnston pub. They cheered when their candidate showed an early lead in returns coming from the city of Boston, talking excitedly while intently following results that scrolled across several TV screens.

A South Boston native, Lynch was first elected to Congress in 2001 after the death of former representative Joe Moakley. Before ascending to Washington, Lynch served in the state House and Senate.

In Congress, Lynch isn’t a household name. The biggest piece of legislation he has carried was a measure enacting federal leave for disabled veterans. He has long served on two high-profile committees — the Financial Services Committee and Oversight and Government Reform Committee — and has been chair of a subcommittee.

In recent years Lynch has tried three times to become the lead Democrat within the House on the Oversight committee but fell short.

The committee race became emblematic of a push from

members of the party to put younger, more media-savvy, and more aggressive lawmakers in leadership roles, especially in the aftermath of octogenarian Joe Biden’s failed presidential campaign in 2024.

Roath portrayed Lynch as a back-bencher and leaned into his own more progressive platform during the primary campaign. Roath argued that Lynch has made little use of his seniority in Congress and was not the energetic leader the changing district needed.

Lynch has used congressional earmarking to bring federal dollars to his district. But in the process, he has also directed those earmarks numerous times to organizations where his wife works and is a board member, a practice ethics experts questioned.

On the other side of the state, Neal has been a political institution for more than four decades, serving as Springfield mayor before being elected to the US House in 1988. He’s seventh in overall seniority among the 435 members and is poised for a second stint as the powerful chair of the tax-writing House Ways and Means Committee if Democrats win the majority in November.

Neal was able to withstand a push among House Democrats in 2024 for generational change and keep his coveted perch as the top Democrat on the committee by pointing to a slew of legislative accomplishments. They include helping to write the Affordable Care Act and the \$1.9 trillion pandemic relief American Rescue Plan, as well



MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Representative Stephen F. Lynch gave out an award in the shape of a football to Nicholas Zaferakis, congressional office district director, calling him one of the “stars of the game.”

as winning a long but successful Supreme Court battle for President Trump’s tax returns in 2022.

“As I’ve said many, many times, I’d put my record up against anybody in the House of Representatives, with the exception of Nancy Pelosi — and she was speaker,” Neal told the Globe recently.

But he faced a spirited challenge from a progressive political newcomer.

Whalen didn’t argue that Neal is too old for the job. Rather, he simply said Neal was out of touch with his district, branding him as more interested in raising money from corporate political action committees than engaging with his constituents.

Whalen sought to draw a vivid contrast, driving around the district in a bright yellow van.

He visited all 83 municipalities at least twice, showing up at every community event he could and chronicling it all on social media to try to offset a large fund-raising disadvantage.

“From the get-go, this has been: can organized people beat corporate money?” Whalen said as he waved to voters in a light rain outside the Greenleaf Community Center polling place in Springfield early Tuesday night. “And this is the referendum that we have today.”

The two differed on policy as well. Whalen has run to the left of Neal, calling for Medicare for All and the abolition of the US Immigration and Customs Enforcement agency. Whalen’s omnipresence in the district led Neal to step up his campaigning the past few weeks, including traveling around the region

to tout some of the billions of dollars in federal money he’s brought back from Washington.

For supporter Brian Ahern, 73, of Springfield, Neal’s seniority counted for a lot

“I was saying to somebody I know who was with Whalen, ‘If everything goes according to plan, Richie’s going to be head of Ways and Means and it’s a two-year term,’” said Ahern, sipping a beer at the party and wearing a Neal T-shirt. “It’s going to take your guy one year to find the men’s room in the Capitol.”

Tal Kopan can be reached at tal.kopan@globe.com. Jim Puzzanghera can be reached at jim.puzzanghera@globe.com. Brian MacQuarrie can be reached at brian.macquarrie@globe.com.

PRIMARY 2026

Healey will take on GOP nominee Minogue in November

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is straining household budgets across the economic spectrum.

Healey is running for a second term alongside Lieutenant Governor Kim Driscoll, a former mayor of Salem who was also unopposed in the primary.

The results on Tuesday are expected to kick into high gear what has already become an expensive gubernatorial election. Minogue has poured more than \$15 million of his own money into his gubernatorial bid while Healey had \$6.6 million in her campaign account as of the end of July.

At his primary night party in Medford, Minogue did not name Healey in his victory speech, but said “our opponents will choose division” in the race for governor.

“They will choose to dishonestly attack me with political ads, and in fact, they already have begun,” the Hamilton Republican said. “Well, we’re choosing something different. We’re going to go down a different path. Our opponents know what happens when we stand united. They know when we put aside our differences and join together, we will defeat the one-party system.”

The general election battle over the next several months is likely to generate intensified attacks from Democrats on Minogue for his ties to Trump and congressional Republicans.

Unlike in the 2022 election, in which the Republican nominee openly embraced Trump, both Minogue and Shortsleeve



DANIEL SARCH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Michael Minogue campaigned in Hamilton before casting his vote on Tuesday. He ran far ahead of his Republican primary opponent, Brian Shortsleeve.

had sought to distance themselves from the White House in an apparent bid to make themselves more appealing to unenrolled voters who make up a majority of Massachusetts’ voter rolls.

Trump had not endorsed either candidate in the GOP primary.

Still, Healey and the state Democratic Party have attempted to paint Minogue as “MAGA Mike,” pointing to the hundreds of thousands of dollars he donated to national Republican causes and a super PAC that backed Trump’s successful 2024 bid for the White House.

“In this election, we’re going to send a message that if you

support Donald Trump, if you funded him, if you endorse the bad things he’s done to our state, then you cannot be governor of Massachusetts,” Healey said Tuesday night.

Minogue, 59, is a businessman making his first overture into politics after earning a fortune in the medical device industry, where he oversaw the sale of the Danvers-based heart-pump maker Abiomed to Johnson & Johnson in 2022 for \$16.6 billion.

He was little known outside the medical field before entering the political fray last year, but has since spent millions of his own dollars to boost his name recognition and catapult

himself to the top of the GOP ticket.

He is a “pro-life” Catholic who has said he would “uphold” reproductive rights laws in Massachusetts if elected governor. And he has promised to help deport “illegal immigrants” in the state and reform safety-net benefits for migrants who arrive in the state.

Laureen Goodhue, 64, said she voted for Minogue on Tuesday in Allston because she “aligned with everything that he believed.”

“I feel that he’s more Republican than Shortsleeve,” she said. “Plus, I think he’s pro-life.”

Minogue has also largely pitched himself as a “new kind

of governor,” or a political outsider intent on using his business acumen to run the state. He drew heavily on his experience in the military and health care field in his pitch to voters Tuesday night, and labeled himself an “outsider.”

“I am beholden to no special group. I go into this role knowing I will work for you,” he said.

But Minogue faces a steep uphill battle in his campaign to unseat Healey. Polls have shown that Healey led by double digits in a hypothetical head-to-head matchup with Minogue, including in a Suffolk University/Boston Globe survey from June.

Shortsleeve, 54, was also making his first foray into elected politics. But he is best known for leaving venture capital more than a decade ago to serve as acting general manager and chief administrator of the MBTA after a series of major snowstorms in 2015 crushed the transit system.

Shortsleeve conceded the Republican primary to Minogue shortly after 9 p.m. and endorsed his opponent.

“I have been a fighter my entire life, and we fought hard throughout this campaign for the future we believe Massachusetts deserves. Mike Minogue is a fighter, too, and I know he will bring that same fight on behalf of the taxpayers to Beacon Hill,” Shortsleeve said in a statement.

Shawn Oliver, a New Bedford city councilor and Shortsleeve’s running mate, locked up the Republican nomination for lieutenant governor after two other candidates were forced out of the race amid a

signature fraud controversy earlier this summer.

That means Oliver would pair with Minogue after months of his and Shortsleeve’s campaigns criticizing him as unelectable in a head-to-head matchup with Healey.

Healey, 55, swept into office four years ago as the state’s first woman and first openly LGBTQ elected governor, riding a progressive reputation built over eight years as attorney general when she emerged as one of the state’s most notable Trump antagonists, filing nearly 100 lawsuits against the Republican’s administration during his first term in office.

But since succeeding Baker, Healey has cut a more moderate tone. Healey has regularly touted a \$1 billion-a-year tax package she signed in 2023 as one of her signature achievements and has sought to firm up her public safety credentials this year.

She has also leaned into Democratic calls to counter Trump on immigration. In her speech Tuesday, Healey pointed to her past work as attorney general.

“I’m the only one in this race who’s actually prosecuted and put away bad guys, drug traffickers, human traffickers. We can agree that we want violent criminals off the streets and deported. What we can also agree on is that none of what ICE is doing is making us safe,” she said.

Chris Van Buskirk can be reached at chris.vanb@globe.com. Follow him on X @byChrisVan

Hayden declares win over Rollins

►DISTRICT ATTORNEY
Continued from Page A1

US post the following year after two bombshell federal reports documented a multitude of “egregious” and “blatant” ethics violations in her behind-the-scenes support of Arroyo. The investigation found Rollins broke multiple rules and then lied to investigators.

The third candidate, Champion, has tried to position herself as an alternative to Hayden and Rollins, neither of whom, she has suggested, have the proper temperament for the DA position.

The campaign was not without its bumps for Hayden, who ruffled feathers among former supporters in the law enforcement community with his decision to charge a Boston police officer earlier this year with manslaughter just days after the officer shot a man to death during a traffic stop.

That move set off a political firestorm for Hayden, with the Boston Police Patrolmen’s Association, the largest police union in Boston, abandoning its support of him.

He did, however, earn the support of progressive stalwarts like Boston Mayor Michelle Wu, whom he thanked during his victory speech.

“I’m humbled and overwhelmed by all of this,” he said.

In the Middlesex race, incumbent DA Marian Ryan also declared victory over challenger David Solet, a former prosecutor and longtime colleague who had been endorsed by dozens of police unions in the district.

“I am deeply grateful to the people of Middlesex County for once again placing their trust in me to serve as their District Attorney,” Ryan said in a statement Tuesday night.

Solet called to concede a little before 10:30 p.m.

“We do not have complete numbers, but we have enough numbers to know this is not our night,” he said in a statement, adding, “We plan to capitalize on the support we earned and get back to work tomorrow to continue raising these issues to fight for the changes we championed during this campaign.”



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

BREAK TIME — In Andover Tuesday, Gannon Depetris took the time to fill out his ballot in the Sixth Congressional District primary at the Andover High School field house while son Kayce, 3, patiently waited.

In Norfolk county, early returns suggested the race was coming down to two former prosecutors looking to succeed the retiring district attorney, Michael Morrissey.

Adam Deitch, a former federal prosecutor, and Djuna Perkins, a former state prosecutor, were leading in a race dominated by debate over how Morrissey had handled two high profile investigations: the prosecution of Karen Read in the death of her boyfriend, Boston police officer John O’Keefe; and the death of Sandra Birchmore, a young pregnant woman and former participant in a Stoughton police youth program.

A jury last year acquitted Read of all charges connected to O’Keefe’s death.

In the Birchmore case, Morrissey’s office did not file any criminal charges, citing the state medical examiner’s finding that Birchmore killed her-

self. But in a shocking development that was seen by some as a rebuke of Morrissey, federal investigators have since charged former Stoughton police detective Matthew Farwell, 40, in her death.

Morrissey announced in January that he would not seek another term.

Also on the ballot were Robert Jubinville, a former governor’s councilor; defense attorney Jim Barakat; Greg Connors, Morrissey’s former top homicide prosecutor; and former state prosecutors Macy Lee and Craig MacLellan.

Whoever wins the Democratic primary will have the clear advantage in November. That candidate will face Joe Pagliarulo, a former state prosecutor from Millis who is running as a self-funded independent with \$3,000 he donated to his campaign.

There is no Republican candidate.

Pam Bonfiglioli, of Quincy, was among the Deitch supporters waiting for election results at Drifters Kitchen & Bar in downtown Quincy. She said the DA’s office needs to “clean house.”

Morrissey, a Quincy Democrat, became Norfolk district attorney in 2011 after spending decades in both houses of the Legislature.

He did not endorse any candidate in the Democratic primary, but defended his tenure and his staff, saying they were being unfairly maligned based on the conduct of former employees.

Even with Morrissey on the sidelines, his prosecution of Read and his investigation into Birchmore’s death dominated the primary.

The race for the office began forming two years ago, shortly after the FBI arrested Farwell and charged him with killing Birchmore, who was pregnant

at the time and had had a relationship with him. Farwell has pleaded not guilty.

Each candidate argued he or she is best positioned to restore public trust, increase transparency, and overhaul the office’s culture.

Deitch, 43, resigned last year as a federal prosecutor and relocated from East Boston to Quincy to run for the seat, citing his experience investigating public corruption in Norfolk County.

Read donated to his campaign and some of Birchmore’s relatives endorsed Deitch.

Perkins is a former state prosecutor with a private law practice. In 2024, she became the first candidate to form a campaign committee and challenge Morrissey.

During the campaign, Perkins vowed to bring a unique perspective to the office that she gained from her chaotic upbringing. Perkins said her

mother killed herself when she was a newborn and some family members experienced crime as victims and sometimes perpetrators.

Becca Kornet, 58, said she met Perkins about two years ago and was drawn to her experience working with victims of domestic violence and sexual assault.

“For me, it’s her focus on victims of domestic violence and sexual abuse,” Kornet said. “To have her, with her lived experience and career experience, be a voice there. I just feel confident that she’s the right person to have in that job.”

Danny McDonald can be reached at daniel.mcdonald@globe.com. Spencer Buell can be reached at spencer.buell@globe.com. Laura Crimaldi can be reached at laura.crimaldi@globe.com. Nick Stoico can be reached at nick.stoico@globe.com.

ENDORSEMENT

Rhode Island deserves a new governor

It has been a rough few years for Rhode Island Governor Daniel McKee. Just a year after he won a full term in 2022, the westbound span of a major Providence bridge was abruptly, and permanently, closed. A replacement span is still a year or two away, and traffic jams have become a way of life. The economy, strong in his first years in office, has sputtered, with employment falling and a company with a 103-year history in the state, Hasbro, deciding to move to Massachusetts. Housing costs have remained high, but housing starts are among the lowest in the country. Not surprisingly, McKee’s approval rating has fallen to new lows, with 8 in 10 people saying they disapproved of his performance in a poll released last week. His handling of transportation/infrastructure issues — read: the closure of the Washington Bridge — was the most-cited reason for his poor rating. McKee’s problems do not end there. The state Democratic Party declined to support him in next Wednesday’s primary, while at least 13 local Democratic committees, including the one in Providence, have endorsed his opponent — a remarkable turn of events for a sitting governor. The state AFL-CIO also refused to endorse, after having endorsed him four years ago. Approval ratings and union and party support are not necessarily the stuff of endorsement decisions. But when so many indicators point in the same direction, it suggests that something is badly amiss at the top of Rhode Island state government. If McKee were facing a weak candidate in next Wednesday’s Democratic primary, this board might be more open to his reelection. But he is not: Helena Buonanno Foulkes, who narrowly lost to McKee in the 2022 primary, is running again, and she presents a more dynamic alternative. As we did in 2022, the Globe editorial board enthusiastically endorses her in the primary. Foulkes, 62, and McKee, 75, are both pragmatic liberals who have made reducing the cost of living, creating jobs, expanding access to health care, building housing, and improving schools core components of their campaigns. But Foulkes has put forward bolder, fresher ideas. To create more housing, she would start a \$1 billion fund to provide loans and investment capital to

developers of both subsidized and market-rate housing. Financed through higher taxes on people with annual incomes of \$1 million or more, the fund could stimulate construction of 20,000 new units, her campaign asserts. She has also pledged to cut regulatory burdens on developers; encourage housing construction on vacant commercial spaces, parking lots, and state land; and make Rhode Island a hub for manufacturing low-cost modular housing. In K-12 education, she has focused her attention on improving vocational and technical training, pro-

see the company’s decision to stop selling tobacco products. But she also presided during the opioid crisis, when CVS pharmacies would come under intense scrutiny for their opioid sales. McKee has made Foulkes’s CVS tenure a cornerstone of his campaign, attacking her as lacking government experience and accusing her of putting profits ahead of people by failing to curtail opioid prescriptions faster. “This is not about the company or the thousands of Rhode Islanders who work there,” McKee said in a statement to the editorial board. “This is about the executive who made decisions that hurt our families.” Foulkes contends that as president, she moved to cut off hundreds of “pill-mill” doctors. She also notes that McKee invoked the same criticism in 2022; she argues that revisiting it now underscores a hole at the center of his campaign. “The governor, from the day I got in the race, has made this all he wants to talk about, because his record isn’t so great,” she told the editorial board. Indeed, it seems no more reasonable to hold Foulkes responsible for a national addiction crisis that touched every corner of the American health care system than it is to hold McKee responsible for the closing of a bridge that had clearly been deteriorating for years. At the same time, Foulkes’s business experience might be what Rhode Island needs right now. She shows a better grasp of the challenges companies face in deciding whether to relocate to, expand in, or leave the state. Case in point: She wants to expand bus service from Providence to a



Helena Buonanno Foulkes

posing a \$100 million bond to expand such programs. She has also criticized McKee for signing legislation that places a moratorium on new charter schools and reduces the cap on those schools. McKee was once a strong ally of the charter school movement, and his decision to sign the bill was widely seen as a bid to win the endorsement of both of the state’s teachers unions. In an interview with the editorial board, Foulkes said there are long waiting lists for open charter seats, most of them Black or Hispanic students. “We are ignoring their reality,” she said. Foulkes is a native of Rhode Island who, after graduating from Harvard, returned to the state to work for CVS Pharmacy, the retail division of the state’s second-largest private employer, CVS Health. She rose to become president between 2014 and 2018, helping over-

growing industrial hub in Quonset. Foulkes says she has spent much of the past four years listening to Rhode Islanders at school meetings and mass transit hearings, on playgrounds and in kitchens — and it shows. She can talk about local problems that matter to residents, from broken school fences to inadequate wages to spotty bus service. But she also speaks aspirationally for the entire state. “I don’t really think I’m running against Dan McKee at some level,” she told the editorial board. “I feel like I’m running against people’s perception that maybe this is just as good as we can ever be ... I’m an optimist, and I don’t want people to give up on government.” It’s the right sentiment from the right choice for Rhode Island governor.



HEATHER HOPP-BRUCE/GLOBE STAFF; ADOBE

AI needs a Ten Commandments

By L. Rafael Reif

L. Rafael Reif is president emeritus and a professor of electrical engineering and computer science at MIT.

In the biblical story of Mount Sinai, a wandering, traumatized, newly freed people — with no laws, no courts, no rules on how to live together — were handed a code of conduct in 10 lines. Short enough to memorize. Clear enough that a shepherd and a king alike could recite them. Society, once again, needs to civilize something new. Only this time it isn’t a people; it is an AI technology that talks, reasons, plans, and, most dangerously, acts on our behalf without seeking permission. Our approach to constraining it appears to be the opposite of what happened on Mount Sinai: pages and pages of terms of service, safety frameworks, and pending legislation, probably written by lawyers for lawyers, that few people read and even fewer understand. Clearly, 10 sentences cannot substitute for the immense complexity and technical work of alignment research, red teaming (testing for harmful

behavior), and regulation — any more than the original commandments substituted for the Talmud’s centuries of case law. But foundational texts do something case law does not: They set the moral floor that no amount of clever argument can override. They give ordinary citizens, not just experts, a way to say “that’s not allowed” and be understood. Every major AI lab publishes something resembling a constitution — a document meant to describe how its models should behave. Anthropic has one. OpenAI has a “Model Spec.” Google has AI principles. Legislators in Brussels, Sacramento, and Washington, D.C., are drafting their own versions in parallel. Each is well-intentioned. Each is also, in practice, not easily accessible to the general public impacted by these advanced models. The result is widespread anxiety about the future, and about society and humanity as a whole. This is, at the least, a vulnerability. When rules are not crystal clear, they risk becoming negotiable — a footnote to be lawyered around, or compromised, rather than a boundary to be respected. When they live in a long document, violations are hard to spot and harder to prosecute in the court of public opinion. The commandments etched at Sinai worked partly because everyone could un-

derstand instantly when one had been broken. Ask 10 people what an AI agent is (and is not) allowed to do, and you will probably get 10 different, confused answers. What are possible examples of what might be included in such a moral floor for AI? ■ Humanity retains ultimate authority over AI. ■ Do not evade human oversight. ■ Do not deceive. ■ Do not cause harm. ■ Do not exploit the vulnerable. The moral floor should only include fundamental principles that clearly identify what is strictly forbidden. Behavior that may be objectionable in some cases but not in others (e.g., AI-to-AI collaboration) should instead be decided by the human supervisor responsible for the AI behavior. The moral floor should also be defined and agreed upon by all nations that are currently developing AI models, so that it can be globally accepted. Is the above doable? In theory, yes. Every one of those principles could be written into a model’s training (most already are). What’s missing is not the technology to enforce an absolute moral floor: It is the cultural consensus that one should exist, with principles expressed in simple enough terms that a senator, a schoolteacher, a welder, and a

software engineer could all agree on their meaning and significance. In practice, on the other hand, recent events have made it clear that AI agents do not always stay within the constraints imposed by developers. This unauthorized autonomous behavior demands urgent attention if we are to safely coexist, work with, and benefit from “civilized” AI. Frontier AI labs such as OpenAI and Anthropic are already working on this serious challenge. They need to figure out how to manage AI training to take advantage of its huge benefits while always keeping humans in control of the trained AI. This needs to be a top priority and a collaborative effort. We already have an example of a coalition of major technology and infrastructure partners addressing critical software vulnerabilities in the defensive cybersecurity initiative Project Glasswing. In the biblical narrative, the Ten Commandments came before the more elaborate legal structure of Leviticus and Deuteronomy, not after. A society in the middle of transformation cannot wait for a perfect, comprehensive code before it clearly establishes what is forbidden, and how not to go rogue. It needs something to hold onto immediately, even if — and especially if — the details can be filled in later. Our society is in that in-between moment with AI: seasoned enough that current systems already write our emails, screen our resumes, execute financial trades, create their own AI, and even escape constraints; yet too young and green to have reached common agreement, in simple terms, on what these systems should never be allowed to do on our behalf. The tablets Moses carried down the mountain didn’t end human cruelty. People kept lying, stealing, and worse. But they gave a nascent society its first common language for naming those failures and arguably influenced much of our current moral and ethical values. Today, people are creating and developing intelligence that is much more capable, in narrow ways, than our own. We owe humanity the same discipline to civilize AI before it is too late: Write down what lines must never be crossed, make the list short enough to remember, and hold every actor building it, and using it, accountable for its actions.

INBOX

Two months from midterms, Trump messes with mail-in voting

Rural voters, older voters, voters with disabilities at risk of being shut out

As the article “New rule may curb mail-in voting” points out (Page A2, Aug. 31), the restrictions on mail-in voting that President Trump has demanded the US Postal Service implement “would particularly affect people in rural areas and older voters, who tend to cast ballots by mail in greater numbers.” Another major group on which this action would have a seriously negative impact are those who have temporary or permanent disabilities and health issues, many of whom are already under the threat of having their Medicaid and other health benefits revoked or limited by the current administration —and who now may not be able to vote to express their disapproval.

Depending on how you pronounce it, the word “invalid” can either mean not valid or, as a noun, someone who is bed-ridden or housebound due to illness. Tragically, Trump is apparently trying to consolidate the two when it comes to voting.

PRICE GRISHAM
Salem

Worse than sowing chaos, president is resorting to sabotage

Re “Trump’s mail-in voting order is sowing chaos. That’s the point”: In her Aug. 27 Opinion column Kimberly Atkins Stohr wrote about the federal government’s proposal to use the US Postal Service to screen mailed ballots so that they can be checked to ensure that the voter is a legal citizen. Atkins Stohr says this will cause chaos. I would go further: I would call it sabotage.

I am a retired IT guy who has been involved with large projects involving computer systems linked to multiple databases, used by employees, and that affect customers. To attempt to implement such a change to mailed ballots two months before an election is absurd.

To do such a project, you need to create detailed specifications, write computer code, sometimes add new hardware for interfaces, train staff, and inform customers how the changes will affect them. And then you need to test, test, test. Then, to determine whether the changes actually work *and* that the changes don’t break the production system, you need to perform something called regression testing, which can be more challenging than the initial testing of the changes. To conduct any change in a vital system such as the USPS or our elections without the rigor required amounts to sabotage.

BRUCE ALEXANDER
Winchester

Trump seeks dictatorship, with the Supreme Court’s help

In her excellent column “Trump’s mail-in voting order is sowing chaos. That’s the point” (Opinion, Aug. 27), Kimberly Atkins Stohr shows how the Supreme Court yet again has supported President Trump in his quest to destroy our democracy, this time by leaving the window open for him to create chaos and doubt surrounding the midterms.

I disagree only with one word in her essay. Atkins Stohr writes that Trump is attempting “to rule like a king.” Kings, however, depend on social norms and stable laws; they rarely destroy the power bases of subordinate powers, and they demand loyalty to their office.

What Trump aims for is not kingship but dictatorship, and he is following the classic path to it: Norms are broken, the law disdained, and its machinery used for his own purposes; the different segments of society are set against each other; and elections are undermined. We see all the signs: show trials, the cult of personality, and the intimidation of both enemies and allies. And of course, there is the demand for total, demonstrative, and constant loyalty to his person rather than his office.

Let’s face the truth: Our Supreme Court is helping to create a dictatorship in the United States of America.

BEATRICE F. MANZ
Arlington



PAT GREENHOUSE/MILTON

Tucker Elementary School in Milton.

Milton has the right idea: Confirming student residency is important

Re “Milton alters residency test amid criticism” (Page A1, Aug. 21) and “Milton’s schools want to know where you’re from” (Letters, Aug. 31): As a former Boston teacher, I know that confirming student residency was done regularly to ensure that there would always be space for Boston children. The reason for that practice was no more complicated than that.

We can wring our hands and decry unfairness all we want, but an orderly society sometimes requires rules. Systems are usually in place for sensible reasons. Randomly altering the rules to accommodate someone’s desire for a better school system is not the answer.

A good classroom starts at home, where a priority is placed on education above all else. Kudos to kids who are able to succeed without that in place (and the Boston school system, for one, has a slew of supports to help such students).

Throwing out established rules only leads to chaos, the last thing we want for any classroom.

JUDITH SILVA NEE
Winthrop



JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON/AP

President Trump walked to Air Force One at Morristown Airport on Aug. 16 in Morristown, N.J.

RENÉE GRAHAM

If Democrats win the House, Trump must be impeached

After Donald Trump won his second White House term in 2024, Democratic Representative James Clyburn of South Carolina made an inexplicable offer to President Joe Biden: If he pardoned Trump, Clyburn would support that decision.

There was never any indication that he had ever considered granting a pardon to Trump, who relentlessly disparaged Biden because the former vice president defeated him in the 2020 presidential election.

But Clyburn was undeterred. “I’m not talking about state here,” he said during a television interview in reference to Trump’s 2024 conviction on 34 felony counts for falsifying business records in New York. “I’m talking about things that could impede our federal government.”

Presidents can only grant clemency for federal crimes, but Biden did not pardon Trump, who faced multiple federal charges for mishandling classified documents as well as his efforts to overturn the 2020 presidential election, which led to the deadly Jan. 6 insurrection in 2021.

Now Clyburn sounds like he wants to throw Trump an undeserved lifeline again.

During her interview with Clyburn on NBC’s “Meet the Press” on Sunday, Kristen Welker asked whether he would “rule out supporting” calls to impeach Trump if Democrats retake the House in November.

“I don’t rule it out, but I don’t rule it in. No, I don’t,” Clyburn said. “But I don’t think that should be our priority if we get into office. Our priority ought to be making housing, education, energy, health care affordable and accessible for all of our citizens. Impeaching the president will not do that.”

But *not* impeaching this president means Democrats would forgo their best chance to hold Trump accountable for the unrestrained corruption, cruelty, incompetence, and unconstitutional actions of his administration.

It’s not as if Clyburn isn’t politically savvy. Days before the South Carolina primary, he endorsed Biden and saved the former vice president’s presidential hopes. Biden lost the first three Democratic primaries; in South Carolina, he won by nearly 30 points. Other Democratic contenders soon suspended their own campaigns and cleared the way for Biden to face off against Trump.

That was as much Clyburn’s victory as Biden’s. Then the highest-ranking Black member of Congress, the congressman understood the existential threat that Trump posed to America and how he could use his considerable influence to fight it.

As the Democratic-led House prepared to impeach Trump for a second time in 2021, after the Jan. 6 insurrection, Clyburn called out Elaine Chao and Betsy DeVos, then members of Trump’s Cabinet, for “running away from their responsibility” because they resigned from the administration rather than invoke the 25th Amendment to remove the president from office.

Clyburn to now suggest that Democrats should focus on matters other than impeachment would be to run away from their own responsibility.

Trump knows what may happen if the Republicans

lose their congressional majorities. That’s why he’s working so hard to undercut confidence in this nation’s elections. On Tuesday, the Department of Homeland Security reportedly planned to supercharge efforts to root out the widespread voter fraud that multiple studies have shown does not exist.

For a president to be expelled from office, they must be found guilty in a Senate trial. But the process of impeachment begins in the House. And the fear of impeachment is compelling Trump to use the weight of his



SUSAN WALSH/AP

Rep. James Clyburn, D-S.C., arrived for the State Dinner with President Joe Biden and French President Emmanuel Macron at the White House in Washington, Dec. 1, 2022.

administration to tilt the midterm elections to Republicans.

Clyburn certainly knows what it means to make a disastrous decision. In that same “Meet the Press” interview, Clyburn said that he regretted testifying in support of Clarence Thomas’s nomination to the Supreme Court in 1991.

“I have made mistakes in my life, and that’s one that I made, and I will own up to that mistake,” Clyburn said of that choice, which he made before he was elected to the House. At the time, he said that he considered Thomas a personal and professional friend.

Clyburn told Welker, “I had no idea that Clarence Thomas would rebel the way he has against his own background and experiences.”

He can’t say the same thing about Trump. Clyburn has watched Trump rebel against the rule of law, judges who rendered decisions against him, basic humanity, and democracy. He knows what Trump has done and how much further he will desecrate this nation unless his lawlessness is finally met with consequences.

Perhaps recognizing how ridiculous he sounded by shunning impeachment as a Democratic priority pending the outcome of the midterms, Clyburn later amended his initial comment. His party, he said, could focus on affordability and accountability: “And we can walk and chew gum at the same time, and maybe do both.”

There’s no “maybe” about it: If Democrats regain the House, they must impeach Trump.

Renée Graham is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at renee.graham@globe.com.

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With all eyes on trial, tensions up, inside and out

► **TRIAL**
Continued from Page A1

Meanwhile, in the courthouse lobby downstairs, Hannah Estrada was anxiously scrolling social media, watching the latest takes about the hugely polarizing case.

Estrada, 37, had traveled from Houston to witness the scene in person and support Clancy, a woman from a different world whose mental health struggles after giving birth nonetheless closely mirrored her own.

“I know what happened to her. I know where she went mentally,” Estrada said, describing her own efforts to cope with postpartum mental health. “Even if she feels like a monster, we want her to know there’s a lot of moms out here supporting her.”

Clancy has admitted to killing Cora, 5, Dawson, 3, and Callan, 8 months. She entered what’s commonly called an insanity plea, arguing she was experiencing postpartum psychosis after her psychiatric providers failed to properly diagnose and treat her.

The central question before the jury is whether she should be held criminally responsible for the killings.

Prosecutors allege Clancy, 36, carefully planned them because she wanted to kill herself and didn’t trust anyone else to care for her children. Under Massachusetts law, they have the burden of proving beyond a reasonable doubt that Clancy was in her right mind and able to obey the law.

Watching the trial testimony online, Estrada said, her mind went back to when her younger son was 8 months old, the same age as Callan. After going 48 hours without sleep, she asked her then-husband to call 911 because she feared she wasn’t in her right mind. She was ultimately institutionalized and medicated, an experience that left her even more traumatized.

“It’s like you’re leaving your rational mind,” she said, adding that she believes Clancy shouldn’t be held criminally responsible because she wasn’t herself at the time.

After following the case and discussing its themes, Estrada and her mother booked last-minute plane tickets from Houston, landed in Boston late Sunday, drove to Plymouth, and checked into a local hotel. After a few hours of sleep, they arrived outside the courthouse

Monday morning.

When court broke for lunch, they fought their way through a giant media scrum for a moment with Clancy’s defense lawyer, Kevin Reddington, the veteran Massachusetts trial attorney whose work on the case has turned him into somewhat of an internet sensation.

“He’s a man in a powerful position who’s speaking out for women,” said Estrada’s mother, Laurel Witwen.

She said she personally thanked Reddington for holding Clancy’s hand during especially emotional testimony.

As the women climbed into their rental car Monday evening, they waved goodbye to another Clancy supporter, Dawn Jeronowitz, who said she drove up from New Jersey to help raise awareness about the potentially dangerous side effects of psychiatric drugs. She said the case has exposed a misguided mental health system where providers are too quick

A Clancy supporter, Dawn Jeronowitz, said she drove up from New Jersey to help raise awareness about psychiatric drugs.

to write prescriptions.

Several of Clancy’s psychiatric providers testified during the trial, describing the various medications she took to address anxiety, depression, and insomnia.

“Her prescribers are guilty as hell,” said Jeronowitz, who published a memoir about her personal experiences with psychiatric drugs.

Jeronowitz was returning to her home in New Jersey Monday night.

“My heart will be here with you,” she told the women from Houston.

The trial has drawn a range of spectators to Plymouth over the past five weeks, including a demonstration where hundreds of women dressed in pink to show their support of Clancy.

Others, though, were decidedly not supportive of her. For example on Friday, Christine Fernandes and her teenage daughter displayed handwrit-



PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

TV cameras were protected from the rain Tuesday in Plymouth. Jurors will continue to deliberate Wednesday.

ten signs that read: “1st Degree MURDER” and “Kidslaughter.” Fernandes, of Fall River, said she was troubled that discussions of women’s mental health have taken attention away from the victims, Clancy’s three children.

After the jury was dismissed for the weekend, mother and daughter joined a small but raucous group of protesters at the back of the courthouse parking lot.

The group included Jake Lang, a far-right influencer who was pardoned by President Trump after being charged in the Jan. 6, 2021, attack on the Capitol.

“Capital punishment for Lindsay Clancy,” he yelled, waving a hot pink sign that said, “We used to burn witches at the stake.”

A woman next to him displayed another message: “Liberal women = mental illness.”

While the courthouse is abuzz with activity, the rest of Plymouth has apparently escaped the frenzy.

Sophia Moore was visiting from South Dakota, along with her husband and four children, ages 5 to 12. The family stopped Tuesday to see Plymouth Rock. Moore said posts about the Clancy case had come up on her social media, but she was quick to scroll past them because of the emotional toll.

“I’ve chosen not to click because I can’t even imagine a mom doing that,” she said.

Meanwhile, as the jury deliberations continued Tuesday afternoon, dozens of reporters camped out in the hallway near



Kimberly Souza made her feelings known. The case has struck a chord with many.

the courtroom, watching for signs of a verdict and carefully monitoring the movements of attorneys and court staff. Outside, camera crews tried to fend off intermittent rain showers using plastic bags and umbrellas to protect their equipment.

Everyone was in limbo.

And the uncertainty will persist for the time being. Judge William T. Sullivan dismissed the jury around 3:30 p.m., telling them to return Wednesday morning to continue deliberating.

As Reddington exited the courthouse, he was mobbed by a swarm of media peppering him with questions about

where the case stands. Asked if Clancy was emotionally prepared to have the case retried, he said no.

He said Plymouth District Attorney Tim Cruz should have to explain his decision to bring first-degree murder charges, which require a jury trial in Massachusetts. That public spectacle could have been avoided if prosecutors chose second-degree murder or manslaughter instead, which would allow the case to be tried before a judge alone.

“He drives the bus,” Reddington said of Cruz.

Elsewhere in the courthouse Tuesday, it was business as usual.

In another courtroom downstairs, the clerk told a defendant to hold tight because his paperwork was en route — yet another reminder that the wheels of justice often turn slowly.

“Sit down and relax, enjoy yourself,” she said. “Thank you for your patience.”

Jenna Perlman of the Globe staff and Globe correspondent Ariela Lopez contributed to this report. Lea Skene can be reached at lea.skene@globe.com. Follow her on X @[lea_skene](https://twitter.com/lea_skene). Shelley Murphy can be reached at shelley.murphy@globe.com. Follow her @[shelleymurphy](https://twitter.com/shelleymurphy).

Rampant fires prompt Greece to disturb antiquities to save them

By **Motoko Rich**
and **Niki Kitsantonis**

NEW YORK TIMES

MYSTRAS, Greece — At the medieval site of Mystras in the Peloponnese region of Greece, visitors marvel at the majestic cliffside ruins of a Byzantine walled city, including a palace built for despots and monasteries festooned with intricate frescoes.

Now, they also get to glimpse hulking olive-green water tanks, sprinkler towers, and bright red fire-hose containers dotted across the 84-acre site.

As climate change fuels more and bigger wildfires, Greece is beefing up protection for iconic archeological sites. But the measures, including installing large water pumps and backup electricity generators, clearing vegetation, and paving roads for fire trucks, can affect the visual character of the centuries-old antiquities.

For archeologists, such work is necessary but bittersweet.

Panagiotis Perdikoulis, an archeologist at Mystras, said that when workers installed water tanks and laid a snaking concrete road from the palace to an exit, his heart hurt a little.

“At the beginning, it was kind of alien,” Perdikoulis said.

“A few years ago you could have never imagined this kind of work could be set up on the site like this,” he added. “But over the past few years, the threat of climate change has



BYRON SMITH/NEW YORK TIMES

A newly constructed emergency access road at the archeological site of Mystras in Greece.

been extremely acute.”

In Greece, where wildfires killed several people this summer, including three firefighters and two men aboard a helicopter, large blazes that burn more than 500 acres at a time have become more frequent and intense. There are now fears of a repeat of the brutal fires that in 2007 neared ancient Olympia, the site where the Olympic Games were first played.

Trying to avert damage at ruins, the Greek government

passed regulations in June outlining fire safety measures for archeological sites, including hydrants and the pruning of vegetation. That made Greece one of only a few countries to have specific guidelines for protecting monuments from the ravages of climate change, according to UNESCO.

Already, officials have taken protection measures at more than 60 sites, the Culture Ministry has reported. Around Philippi, a walled city founded more than two millennia ago, a

water pumping station was built into the hillside. At Mycenae, a Bronze Age site narrowly avoided by a wildfire in 2020, regional authorities installed fire-hose containers.

Lina Mendoni, the Greek culture minister, said in a statement that the effort “shifts the mindset from restoration after disaster to systematically building resilience.”

The regulations call for measures that do not significantly alter the sites’ appearance. Still, “all these things have a visual

impact,” said Krista Pikkat, director of culture and emergencies for UNESCO, which has listed 21 world heritage sites in Greece.

“There’s always this balance that you need to find,” Pikkat said, adding that the authorities understand they “don’t have a choice.”

Mystras, which hosts about 150,000 visitors a year, is particularly vulnerable because it is in one of the hottest spots in the Peloponnese region, said Perdikoulis, the archeologist.

The site, perched on a steep incline stretching more than 2,000 feet above sea level, is also at risk because access is difficult, and the closest fire station is about 3 miles away. Mystras is surrounded by pine and cypress forests and overlooks a valley of olive orchards, all potential fuel for fire.

From 2022 to 2025, with European Union subsidies, Greece spent nearly \$4 million to install protection measures at Mystras. Regional authorities built a 5,000-foot pipeline from a municipal reservoir to the pumps.

During the installation, workers unearthed important archeological finds, including cells where monks slept and a portion of a Byzantine road, Perdikoulis said. Because of a lack of time or money to fully extract or restore those finds, he added, workers simply covered over the discoveries for fu-

ture generations, taking care to avoid laying pipes and tanks nearby.

The measures also include loudspeakers to broadcast evacuation announcements to visitors in case of fire. That is another essential precaution, said Gavriil Xanthopoulos, a specialist in forest fires, because visitors are usually “in the place for the first time, they’re relaxed, their mind is not on disaster.”

Tourists visiting the site recently acknowledged the need to protect the antiquities from fire.

Usuf Sarrys, 18, a trainee plumber who was visiting with family from Sydney, said he had noticed the “heaps” of fire-hose boxes. “It’s good that they have them just in case,” he said. “You don’t want to have this whole place burn down.”

To keep up the protection in the long term, the Greek government must find ways of funding the maintenance of the facilities even after EU funds ebb. Regularly pruning vegetation, for example, is expensive and might require budget trade-offs, said Emmanuel Vassilakis, a climate expert at the National and Kapodistrian University of Athens.

The government may have to make tough decisions when allocating budgets, Vassilakis noted. “But I think that we have to persuade the people that we need to protect our past and our culture.”

B

Metro

THE BOSTON GLOBE WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/METRO

Koh takes the crowded Sixth District primary

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

SALEM — Turns out second time's the charm.

Dan Koh, a former White House official and Boston City Hall alum, clinched the Democratic nomination in the Sixth Congressional District's five-way primary, the Associated Press projected Tuesday night, after vastly out-raising his opponents and promoting his Washington experience under former president Joe Biden.

Koh defeated four other candidates still in the race according to a call at about 10:30 p.m., perhaps most notably state Representative Tram Nguyen, an Andover legislator who had mounted an eleventh-hour surge with a slate

of late endorsements from several Massachusetts elected officials.

Koh led Nguyen by more than 10 percentage points with about 63 per-cent of votes counted when AP called the race.

He will now face Micah Jones, an Army veteran endorsed by former gov-ernor Charlie Baker, who was the sole Republican running in the North Shore-anchored district. If he wins that race come November, Koh could make history as Massachusetts' first Asian American representative.

The differences between Koh and Nguyen were on display at their watch parties Tuesday night, which took place a short walk apart from each other.

At the Hawthorne Hotel, a packed

SIXTH, Page B4

Collins victorious, Brownsberger contest close in state Senate Democratic primaries

By Niki Griswold and Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

State Senator Nick Collins of South Boston declared victory against Mayor Michelle Wu-backed challenger Latoya Gayle in a closely watched Democratic primary Tuesday night, while a race between first-time candidate Daniel Lander and incumbent state Senator William Brownsberger was too close to call in the early hours after polls closed, the campaigns said.

The results left unresolved the

question of how influential Wu would prove to be in two hotly contested state Senate primaries where she had waded in against Beacon Hill oppo-nents.

Brownsberger, without conceding, said Tuesday night he “might have lost,” but later told supporters who had gathered at Donohue’s Bar and Grill in Watertown that the vote count had turned in his favor, drawing cheers from the crowd. Lander, meanwhile, took the stage at his watch party in a Brighton restaurant, to say the race was “within double

digits.”

“While I wish tonight we were ready to say we had a decision, it is so, so close,” Lander said, but framed the tight margin as a victory.

“Tonight, we have already sent shockwaves on Beacon Hill,” Lander said, as he spoke alongside Wu, one of his most high-profile supporters and his former boss. Wu said Lander had “crushed” it in Boston.

Toppling Brownsberger — or even coming close — would be a major coup for Lander, 35. It would also be

STATE SENATE, Page B4



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

MOVING DAY

College students continued to arrive at their apartments in the Brighton and Allston neighborhoods Tuesday for the start of the fall semester.

Above: Anna Reh helped direct her brother Adam, a student at Boston University, as he carried a refrigerator out of their moving van on Pratt Street.

Right: BU students Ian Geraghty, Jack Goodman, and Ian McKelvey brought their belongings to their apartment.



Former boss testifies in Tompkins corruption trial

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

A former Massachusetts public safety secretary told a federal jury Tuesday that Suffolk Sheriff Steven W. Tompkins, who is on trial for alleged corruption, held no sway over permit-ting a cannabis company at the heart of the case.

Andrea Cabral, a longtime local public official, Tompkins's former boss at the sheriff's department, and a close friend of his for decades, said that a partnership between Tompkins's agency and Ascend Wellness Holdings, where Cabral served as an executive, was not a make-or-break

Andrea Cabral denied that the sheriff held any leverage over the cannabis company

initiative for state approvals.

Other measures undertaken by Ascend, she testified, would have fulfilled “positive impact” requirements needed for the company to receive the licensing necessary to launch its retail operation.

“Any one of them would have worked,” said Cabral on Tuesday.

She asserted that if the partnership with Tompkins's sheriff's department, which was a reentry program where inmates were funneled to Ascend for

potential employment, was with-drawn, it would not have risked Ascend's state applications.

Her testimony stood at odds with the crux of the prosecution's extortion case against Tompkins, a 69-year-old Democrat who, as sheriff, has run Nashua Street Jail and South Bay House of Correction for years.

A key part of the government's allegation is that Ascend needed the Suffolk sheriff's office to show how the business would have a “positive im-

pact,” especially on communities harmed by the nation's war on drugs.

For Ascend, that requirement was allegedly met through its partnership with Tompkins on a program to train and hire people recently released from jail, prosecutors have said.

Prosecutors allege Tompkins used his position as sheriff to extort Ascend, twice — once for early access to purchase \$50,000 worth of stock in the company and later to get his money back after the stock value tanked.

Tompkins had not signed any agreement that would have guaran-teed a refund on his initial invest-

TOMPKINS, Page B3

What comes next if jury stays deadlocked

If no verdict, Clancy could be retried

By John R. Ellement and Shelley Murphy
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — After indicating they were struggling to reach a verdict, jurors in the Lindsay Clancy trial recessed for the day Tuesday afternoon and are set to resume deliberations Wednesday morning over whether she is criminally respon-sible for the slayings of her three children.

Jurors requested to continue deliberat-ing for another day about five hours after they indicated they were stalled. They had sent a note to Plymouth Superior Court Judge William F. Sullivan alerting him that they were unable to reach a unanim-ous verdict.

The judge said he understood it was a long trial, as they had heard from more than 80 witnesses and reviewed about 300 exhibits. But he urged them to contin-ue deliberating, and they did.

At the end of the day, Sullivan granted the jury's request to go home and return Wednesday, saying, “I just want to thank you for all of your hard work and commit-ment.”

Clancy's attorney, Kevin Reddington, was swarmed by the media as he left the courthouse and said he was encouraged that the jury would continue to weigh the case after 23 hours of deliberations over four days.

“The fact that they have not said that they are done is very heartening,” Red-dington said. “Obviously they are working very hard.”

Clancy, 36, has admitted to strangling 5-year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan to death with exercise bands in the basement of their Duxbury home on Jan. 24, 2023. But she has plead-ed not guilty to first-degree murder, as-serting that she was suffering from post-partum psychosis and should not be held criminally responsible.

The 12 jurors, nine women and three men, are tasked with reviewing complex legal issues that lawyers sometimes strug-gle to understand, while also considering extensive medical and pharmaceutical data — all through the prism of the heart-breaking reality at the root of the trial: the deaths of three children at the hands of their mother.

Those factors raise the possibility that jurors will find themselves split on a wide variety of issues, with differences of opin-ion that may prevent them from reaching the constitutional requirement of a unanim-ous verdict.

In such an instance, the jury foreper-

CLANCY, Page B3

INSIDE

Farwell trial

A federal judge ruled Tuesday that the defense team for Matthew Farwell, the former Stoughton police detective ac-cused of killing Sandra Birchmore, would be allowed to introduce evidence relating to her mental health struggles and history of suicidal thoughts. **B2**

Judge to allow evidence tied to Birchmore’s mental health

By Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF

A federal judge ruled Tuesday that the defense team for Matthew Farwell, the former Stoughton police detective accused of killing Sandra Birchmore, would be allowed to introduce evidence relating to her mental health struggles and history of suicidal thoughts.

The ruling came during a lengthy pretrial hearing, where the defense sparred with federal prosecutors over which expert witnesses and evidence on Birchmore’s mental state and her relationship with Farwell should be presented at Farwell’s upcoming trial. The hearing is one of the last proceedings be-

fore the trial, which is expected to begin in October.

Farwell is charged with killing a pregnant Birchmore, 23, in 2021 and then staging her death to look like a suicide to prevent her from disclosing how he groomed and sexually abused her as a child. Farwell’s defense team maintains that Birchmore killed herself.

The defense argued that introducing her mental health history — including previous elements of suicidal ideation — would be relevant.

Over the defense’s objections, though, the court ruled to allow prosecutors to explicitly refer to Birchmore as a victim.

Judge Denise J. Casper said

that, regardless of the “different theories” of the case, describing Birchmore as a “victim” would not be prejudicial to the defense’s argument that she died by suicide.

Several matters raised in the hearing were taken under advisement, meaning that Casper will issue a ruling on them in the coming weeks. Those motions include the introduction of Birchmore’s texts, oral communications, and handwritten journal entries into evidence.

The defense argued that such evidence is tantamount to hearsay, in part because Birchmore declined to take legal measures against Farwell while she was alive. Allowing it — through a le-

gal provision that allows hearsay in the case of “wrongdoing” — would stretch existing case law and prejudicially suggest that Farwell killed her to silence her.

Prosecutor Brian A. Fogerty said that these statements would be supported by other evidence such as medical records and witness testimony.

“What’s important to remember about all of these statements is that there will be independent corroboration for the veracity of the things Ms. Birchmore is saying,” he said.

Casper said she would review existing case law before making a final decision on whether to admit Birchmore’s statements.

The court also heard several

motions to prevent certain expert witnesses on both sides from testifying.

One potential witness for the prosecution, Dr. William Smock, is an expert in strangulation who, after reviewing autopsy records and other materials, was one of two experts to conclude that Birchmore’s death was a homicide. The other expert, Dr. Michael Baden, was also objected to by the defense.

The defense argued that some of Smock’s conclusions were unreliable, particularly relating to the imprint of a clasp on the strap Birchmore was strangled with, as well as a small broken bone in the neck that he said indicated a homicide.

The prosecution countered by arguing that Smock could testify to details that were missed in the initial autopsy, which ruled Birchmore’s death a suicide.

The defense also pushed to exclude the testimony of Dr. Lisa Rocchio, a forensic psychologist who would describe elements of grooming in Farwell and Birchmore’s relationship.

Casper seemed to indicate that she would be willing to allow at least some of the contested testimony, noting that certain disputes appeared to be “in the nature of cross-examination, as opposed to exclusion.”

Camilo Fonseca can be reached at camilo.fonseca@globe.com.



CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

DRIP DRY — A pedestrian carried an umbrella as they walked in the rain in downtown Boston earlier this summer.

R.I. lawmaker to resign, after report of her move to S.C.

By Dan McGowan
GLOBE COLUMNIST

PROVIDENCE — State Representative Julie Casimiro has informed the attorney general’s office that she plans to vacate her House District 31 seat, after initially saying she would finish out her term despite moving to South Carolina on July 1.

In an email to the attorney general’s office, the outgoing Democratic lawmaker said she planned to step down by the close of business Tuesday.

“I have spoken to 2 very qualified attorneys who both said I was still eligible to serve, but I

am choosing not to as all of this political theatre is taking away from all of the good work I have done for children and families,” she wrote in the email.

Casimiro continued: “I would have preferred to quietly exit Rhode Island politics, but it seems as though that didn’t happen.”

The Globe first reported last week that Casimiro had made a home in Hardeeville, S.C., her primary residence as of July 1, raising questions about whether she remained eligible to serve in the Rhode Island House. Casimiro, who has represented

North Kingstown and Exeter since 2017, initially said she planned to continue serving remotely until her successor was sworn in in January.

The issue drew calls for her resignation from both House Speaker Chris Blazewski and Attorney General Peter Neronha. Blazewski said Casimiro should consider stepping down “in order to address legal questions about her eligibility to serve the balance of her term and in an abundance of caution.” Neronha said Thursday that his advice was for her to resign.

Casimiro had defended her decision to remain in office by pointing to her responsibility to her constituents.

“Who is going to take care of my constituents?” she said when asked earlier this month whether she had considered stepping down when she moved.

Casimiro announced in June that she would not seek reelection to the seat, which she has held since 2017.

Dan McGowan can be reached at dan.mcgowan@globe.com. Follow him @danmcgowan.

Maine juvenile, tied to 764 network, to serve time for sex crimes

By Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

A 17-year-old Maine resident linked to “online nihilistic extremist groups” connected to the 764 network has been ordered to serve “a term of official detention” for sex crimes and cyberstalking, the FBI said.

The teenager, whose name was withheld, became the first juvenile in the country “federally charged and adjudicated” for acts of delinquency related to the 764 network, the FBI’s Boston office said in a statement.

The teenager was found delinquent on multiple infractions, including conspiring to sexually exploit a child, sexually exploiting and enticing a child, distributing child sexual abuse material, sending interstate threats, cyberstalking victims, and identity theft, authorities said.

Officials didn’t say how much time in custody the teenager will spend or when the sentence was handed down. The teenager will also serve a term of “juvenile delinquent supervision” once the custodial term ends, the FBI said.

The bureau said it’s currently investigating more than 500 people nationwide who are tied to “violent online networks” commonly known as 764.

According to the FBI, network members befriend minors and other vulnerable people online before coercing them into escalating sexual and violent behavior, including pushing victims to create graphic content and child sex abuse material, sexually exploit siblings, harm family pets, cut themselves with sharp objects, or attempt suicide.

Ted E. Docks, the FBI special agent in charge of the bureau’s Boston division, said the network remains squarely in law enforcement’s sights.

“This first-in-the-nation case should make it crystal clear that if you conspire to commit violent, extremist crimes, your age will not shield you from accountability,” Docks said in the statement. “What this juvenile did would shock most people to their very core, and it is our hope that by publicizing this case, others will be deterred from making the same devastating choices this teen did.”

Maine US Attorney Andrew Benson echoed his remarks, saying that “if you sexually exploit a child, the fact that you yourself are a minor will not protect you from the consequences of your actions.”

John A. Eisenberg, assistant attorney general for national security, said the juvenile’s conduct “required a forceful response.”

“The shocking and disturbing nature of the criminal conduct uncovered in this case — committed by a juvenile — required a forceful response to protect the public from predatory nihilistic violent extremism,” he said. “This case makes clear, unfortunately, that parents must be vigilant, both to protect their children from the crimes of these extremists and to ensure their children do not fall into their influence.”

Members of the nihilistic network have “a common purpose of destroying civilized society” and hope to sow chaos and create social unrest by targeting vulnerable victims, authorities said.

Travis Andersen can be reached at travis.andersen@globe.com.

Cyclist killed in crash with truck in Lynn, officials say

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF
and Lauren Albano
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A cyclist was killed in a collision with a pickup truck in Lynn on Monday night, according to Essex District Attorney Paul F. Tucker’s office.

The crash occurred around 9:30 p.m. at the intersection of Broad and Silsbee streets, where a 2025 Honda Ridgeline pickup truck and bicycle collided, Tucker’s office said.

The cyclist, a 30-year-old man, was taken by ambulance to Salem Hospital, where he was pronounced dead, officials

said. His name was not released pending notification of his family.

The crash is under investigation by Lynn police, the State Police Collision Analysis and Reconstruction unit, and the State Police Crime Scene Services unit.

No further information was immediately released.

The death is the second bicycle fatality in the North Shore city since June.

Cyclist William Beard was killed after he was hit by a tractor-trailer at the intersection of the Lynnway and Commercial Street, according to the district

attorney’s office.

A bicycle advocate said while it’s unclear how Monday’s crash occurred, the area only has a line defining a bike lane, not a separated bike lane.

“It’s just a line of paint,” Jonah Chiarenza, executive director of Bike to the Sea, a nonprofit that promotes bicycling safety. “It would be better to have a separated lane, with physical elements like a curb or vehicle parking, and good visibility ahead of intersections.”

He added that faster and larger vehicles, like the 2025 Honda Ridgeline involved in the crash, have a higher chance

of causing fatal or serious injury in a collision with a cyclist because of their size and power.

“It should be safe for people to walk and bike without fear of fatal injury,” Chiarenza said. “There’s a lot of behavioral things as well as infrastructure and enforcement that have to come together to help make that a reality.”

Nick Stoico can be reached at nick.stoico@globe.com. Lauren Albano can be reached at lauren.albano@globe.com. Follow her on X @LaurenAlbano_.

The Boston Globe

News

CONTACTS, TIPS, COMMENTS
Switchboard: (617) 929-2000
(617) 929-7400
newstip@globe.com
comments@globe.com
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	City	Retail	Other
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Sunday-only home delivery	\$22.50	22.50	22.50
Daily single copy	\$4.00	4.00	4.00
Sunday single copy	\$6.00	6.00	6.00

This day in history

Today is Wednesday, Sept. 2, the 245th day of 2026. There are 120 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Former US Olympic Committee Chairman and former Major League Baseball commissioner Peter Ueberroth is 89. Football Hall of Famer Terry Bradshaw is 78. Basketball Hall of Famer Nate Archibald is 78. Actor Mark Harmon is 75. Tennis Hall of Famer Jimmy Connors is 74. Football Hall of Famer Eric Dickerson is 66. Former British Prime Minister Keir Starmer is 64. Actor Keanu Reeves is 62. Boxing Hall of Famer Lennox Lewis is 61. Actor Salma Hayek is 60.

►In 1666, the Great Fire of London began, which would destroy

more than 13,000 homes and hundreds of additional structures, including St. Paul’s Cathedral, over the ensuing three days.

►In 1789, the United States Treasury Department was established.

►In 1864, during the Civil War, Union General William T. Sherman’s forces occupied Atlanta.

►In 1935, a Category 5 hurricane slammed into the Florida Keys on Labor Day, claiming more than 400 lives.

►In 1945, Japan formally surrendered in ceremonies aboard the USS Missouri in Tokyo Bay, ending World War II.

►In 1958, President Dwight D. Eisenhower signed the National

Defense Education Act, which provided aid to public and private education to promote learning in such fields as math and science.

►In 1963, Alabama Governor George C. Wallace prevented the integration of Tuskegee High School by encircling the building with state troopers.

►In 1969, in what some regard as the birth of the internet, two connected computers at the University of California Los Angeles passed test data through a 15-foot cable.

►In 1998, a Swissair MD-11 jetliner crashed off Nova Scotia, killing all 229 people aboard.

►In 2005, four days after Hurricane Katrina, a National Guard

convoy packed with food, water, and medicine rolled into New Orleans.

►In 2013, on her fifth attempt, US endurance swimmer Diana Nyad became the first person to swim from Cuba to Florida without using a shark cage.

►In 2018, a huge fire engulfed Brazil’s 200-year-old National Museum in Rio de Janeiro, as firefighters and museum workers raced to save historical relics.

►In 2024, an attempted jailbreak in Congo’s main prison left at least 129 people dead, including some who were shot by guards and soldiers and others who died in a stampede at the overcrowded penitentiary in Kinshasa.

Lottery

	6069	
TUESDAY MIDDAY		
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)		
<u>EXACT ORDER</u>		
All 4 digits	\$5,726	
First or last 3	\$802	
Any 2 digits	\$69	
Any 1 digit	\$7	
<u>ANY ORDER</u>		
All 4 digits	\$477	
First 3	\$267	
Last 3	\$134	
TUESDAY NIGHT	5205	
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)		
<u>EXACT ORDER</u>		
All 4 digits	\$5,459	
First or last 3	\$764	
Any 2 digits	\$66	
Any 1 digit	\$7	
<u>ANY ORDER</u>		
All 4 digits	\$455	
First 3	\$127	
Last 3	\$127	

	2-9-30-37-45	
MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE		
Aug. 31		
Millionaire Ball 4		
Jackpot: \$1 million per year		
MASS CASH		
Sept. 1	2-7-13-19-34	
Jackpot: \$100,000		
MEGA MILLIONS		
Sept. 1	1-22-51-61-63	
Megaball 17		
Jackpot: \$160,000,000		
PREVIOUS DRAWINGS		
	Midday	Night
Monday	4970	2645
Sunday	7657	5863
Saturday	5506	2352
Friday	9008	1099
Thursday	0457	9070
TUESDAY NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND		
Maine, N.H., Vermont		
Day: 3-digit 843	4-digit 5842	
Eve: 3-digit 360	4-digit 3901	
Rhode Island	7149	

Delays plague teenager’s murder case

Charged in killing of woman on Maine pond

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

A Maine judge expressed frustration Tuesday over the slow pace of the case against Deven Young, the teenager charged in the killing of Sunshine “Sunny” Stewart on a midcoast pond in July 2025.

Young was 17 at the time of Stewart’s death and was initially charged in juvenile court, but prosecutors have since been seeking to try him as an adult. He is now 18.

District Judge Eric Walker said earlier this year he hoped a proceeding to settle that question would take place in August or September. But at a hearing Tuesday in Rockland, he conceded it was not likely to happen until early next year.

“I’m getting a bit frustrated that this is taking so long,” Walker said.

Young’s attorney, Jeremy Pratt, asked to delay the proceeding, called a bind-over hearing, until January to provide time for a defense expert to evaluate whether Young should be tried as an adult.

Pratt said the expert has been unable to enter Long Creek Youth Development Center in South Portland, where Young has been held, for more than a month.

“That has added a wrinkle of complication,” Pratt said.

He did not explain the reason for the lack of access, and the state’s Department of Corrections, which runs the secure juvenile facility, did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Pratt said the defense’s expert would need three months to complete her report, which he said was about as long as a state expert took to complete a similar evaluation.

Upgrades to the judiciary’s IT systems could further delay the proceeding and potentially require a change of venue, Walker

said. He ordered another status conference for November but indicated the bind-over hearing would likely slip to January or February.

Stewart was found bludgeoned and strangled near an island on Crawford Pond the morning after she set out paddleboarding from a campground where she intended to spend parts of the summer. After a two-week search for her killer, authorities arrested Young, who had been staying at the campground with his family.

He entered a denial, similar to a not guilty plea.

Because Young was charged in juvenile court, the case remained shrouded in secrecy until April, when Walker found him competent to stand trial. Proceedings have since been held in public, though authorities have released few public records related to the case.

If tried as an adult, Young could face 25 years to life in prison. If not, he could only be held in a juvenile facility until he turned 21.

Stewart, 48, was a beloved member of her community in Tenants Harbor, where she worked as a contractor. She had previously been a ship captain, a lobsterwoman, and a bartender on a beach in the Virgin Islands.

Several of Stewart’s friends attended Tuesday’s hearing remotely, displaying images above their names of a paddleboarder’s silhouette and the text “#JUSTICEFORSUNNY”

One family friend who attended, Tennie Komar, later told the Globe she found it “extremely hard” that the legal process was taking so long.

“We want this done and over with so we can have closure,” she said.

Bethany Parmley, who grew up with Stewart and saw her days before her killing, said that every delay in the process was “excruciating.”

“Everybody wants justice — and it’s taking so long,” she said.

Paul Heintz can be reached at paul.heintz@globe.com. Follow him on X @paulheintz.



HANDOUT

Ashley Taunton (right) with her son Joey Taunton and his girlfriend, Lauren Esteves. Taunton was injured in July when a car crashed into her on Interstate 95 in Rhode Island.

Taylor Swift donates \$50,000 to Conn. woman

Injured while aiding teens after R.I. crash

By Christopher Gavin
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — When someone is in need of help, Ashley Taunton always tries to do whatever she can, she said.

“I don’t really think usually before I do it,” Taunton said. “It’s just a God-given thing.”

That’s why the Connecticut mother of three stopped on a rainy day in July to help three teenagers in a car that hydroplaned on Interstate 95 in Rhode Island.

Her selflessness ultimately put Taunton herself in harm’s way. When another vehicle hydroplaned, it hurtled toward Taunton and the teens, crashing into Taunton as she shoved one of the teens out of the way, she said Monday.

Taunton, 42, spent weeks in the hospital after suffering injuries to her leg, ankle, and internal organs, she said. She still has a long recovery ahead of her.

Her act of kindness did not go unnoticed: A GoFundMe campaign set up to help Taunton and her family make ends meet recently got a \$50,000 donation — from superstar Taylor Swift.

The “Karma” singer, who owns a house in Westerly’s Watch Hill not far from the crash in Hopkinton, R.I., made the contribution to the online fund-raiser on Friday.

“Wishing you the best recovery possible and sending love to your family!” Swift wrote, signing the note, “Taylor.”

Taunton told the Globe on Monday that Swift’s hefty donation was shocking to see. She said GoFundMe confirmed to her the contribution indeed came from the singer-songwriter.

“I couldn’t imagine it,” Taunton said. “I was like, ‘There’s no way’ ... But who else would do that?”

Swift, who has a net worth of \$2 billion, according to Forbes, has a well-documented history of generosity, especially on the GoFundMe platform. The online fund-raising site reports Swift has made donations to various causes over the years, from an effort to raise money for a family of eight facing massive medical expenses, to another that helped a fan with autism obtain a service dog.

Swift is also known to give back in other ways. Ahead of their wedding in July, Swift and then-fiancé Travis Kelce donated \$26 million to charities across the country, including a \$1 million donation to the Rhode Island Community Food Bank.

“She’s definitely always been someone that we have admired and been a fan of,” said Taunton, a former Westerly resident herself.

On July 18, Taunton was driving with her 14-year-old daughter, Olivia, heading back home to Ledyard, Conn., from Newport on Interstate 95 south. She was about 2 1/2 miles from the Connecticut state line when she saw a vehicle near the woods on the side of the highway, she said.

Three teenagers were getting out of the stopped car, which had apparently hydroplaned in the rain, she said. All of them were relatively all right physically, although “a little bit banged up,” Taunton recalled.

As Taunton was consoling them, another person who had pulled over at the scene yelled that there was another car coming toward them, Taunton said.

“It happened so very fast,” she said.

She pushed one of the teens out of the way. (She later discovered he is, coincidentally, the brother of one of her children’s good friends, she said.)

Then Taunton experienced what “felt like a big explosion — like, you get rolled by a big wave but so much worse,” she said.

She suffered apparent injuries to her leg and ankle, internal bleeding, and a collapsed lung, she said. Lying on the ground, she worried whether help would arrive in time, she said.

She was first brought to Westerly Hospital, then to Rhode Island Hospital in Providence. Taunton, who had suffered lacerations on several organs, underwent three surgeries in three days while she was in a four-day, medically induced coma, she said, and she nearly lost her foot.

Overall, she was in the hospital for 31 days, Taunton said. While she is doing better now, her husband, Joseph Taunton, is on leave from his job to take care of her, and Taunton, who has several jobs, has not been able to work, she said.

A friend started the GoFundMe campaign to help the family cover its daily bills and expenses, and any medical costs not covered by insurance, the fund-raiser’s webpage states. Taunton said the effort is a “lifecycle,” as her recovery is expected to take at least a year.

She was at physical therapy with her husband Friday when they received word about Swift’s generous donation.

“We were in disbelief,” Taunton said. “Like, no way, this is real. This can’t be real.”

In the days since, other donations have poured in, including some \$13 contributions — a gesture Swift’s fans have been known to make in honor of Swift’s lucky number.

Taunton said she is not quite sure how Swift learned about the fund-raiser, but added, “I just thank God she found mine and felt it in her heart and was led to donate.”

As of Monday afternoon, more than \$90,000 had been raised. Taunton said her family has already been able to prepay their oil bill for the upcoming winter.

A Christian, Taunton said it’s a blessing to see that something good could come out of what happened — to see people come together.

“We’re just so humbled and so grateful and appreciate that we can see kindness spread and just the goodness of God spread instead of always the negative, because there’s a lot of that out there,” Taunton said.

Christopher Gavin can be reached at christopher.gavin@globe.com.

What happens if Clancy jurors are hung

►CLANCY
Continued from Page B1

son would again alert Sullivan that they are deadlocked. But Sullivan has legal authority to keep jurors deliberating even beyond that using what is called the “dynamite charge.” It is also known as the Tuey-Rodriguez charge.

“Even after they’ve reported that [they are deadlocked], the judge can give that [dynamite] charge, and then they can continue to deliberate,” retired Superior Court judge Thomas Drechsler said.

Judges essentially tell jurors in such instances that they are in the best position to assess the prosecution’s case and reach a verdict beyond a reasonable doubt.

“There is no reason to suppose that the case will ever be submitted to [12] persons who are more intelligent, more impartial, or more competent to decide it than you are, or that more or clearer evidence will be produced on one side or the other,” the model “dynamite” instruction posted on the SJC website reads. “With all this in mind, it is your duty to decide this case if you can do so conscientiously.”

If the foreperson repeatedly returns to court and alerts the judge overseeing the case that the deadlock has persisted and jurors are all locked in on their viewpoints, the judge must decide on his or her own whether they have devoted enough time and attention to their task.

“Sometimes the judge evaluates whether there has been due and careful deliberation comparing the length of the trial to the length of the deliberations,” retired Superior Court judge John T. Lu wrote in an email to the Globe. “Hung juries are unusual but not rare.”

At that point, the judge has



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Lindsey Clancy’s attorney Kevin Reddington spoke outside Plymouth Superior Court Tuesday.

the authority to declare a mistrial, which ends that trial — but not the prosecution. Prosecutors could then decide whether to retry the case; they also have the option to negotiate a plea deal with the defendant.

In another recent high-profile case, the prosecution of Karen Read in Norfolk Superior Court, Judge Beverly Cannone declared a mistrial in the initial trial two years ago after the jury deadlocked after 20 hours of deliberations.

In a note sent to Cannone, the jury foreman had written that jurors could not find a path to unanimity.

“The deep division is not due to a lack of effort or diligence, but rather a sincere adherence to our individual principles and moral convictions,” the foreman wrote. “To continue to deliberate would be futile and only serve to force us to compromise these deeply held beliefs.”

Norfolk District Attorney Michael Morrissey retried Read last year. She was found not guilty of the major charges she

faced, specifically that she murdered her boyfriend, former Boston police officer John O’Keefe.

The prosecutor in the Clancy case is Plymouth District Attorney Timothy J. Cruz, and he would face the decision of whether to try the case anew in the event of a hung jury.

Prosecutors, like Cruz, also decide whether the new trial will be on the original charge or a lesser included one. In Clancy’s case, that would mean shifting to second-degree murder from first-degree murder, for example. If the charges were reduced to second-degree murder, she could waive a jury trial and ask a judge to decide the case.

“That would be entirely up to the prosecutor as to what charges and what level of charge to proceed on,” Drechsler said. “Could you retry it as a lesser charge? It’s unusual for that to happen, but it could happen. It’s a rare, pretty rare, in my experience.”

During a decades-long career as a prosecutor, a defense lawyer and judge, Drechsler said the

outcome with a new jury is never certain for either the prosecution or the defense.

“In terms of what happens, I’ve seen it go both ways. I’ve seen hung juries where on the second go round it’s an acquittal. I’ve seen hung juries where on the second go around it’s been a conviction,” Drechsler said. “You just don’t know.”

In another recent high-profile case, a jury in February 2024 convicted Emanuel Lopes in a second trial of murdering Sergeant Michael Chesna and Vera Adams, of Weymouth, on the morning of July 15, 2018.

That verdict came after a jury failed to reach a decision in the first trial in earlier 2024, resulting in a mistrial.

In the second trial, the jury came back with the guilty verdict after being given the “dynamite” charge twice, according to Lopes’s lawyer, Larry R. Tipton.

John R. Ellement can be reached at john.ellement@globe.com. Shelley Murphy can be reached at shelley.murphy@globe.com.

Ex-boss testifies in Tompkins federal trial

►TOMPKINS
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ment, according to the indictment, but an Ascend cofounder paid him back anyway.

The partnership between Ascend and the sheriff’s department allegedly gave Tompkins leverage; without it, according to prosecutors, company officials feared they would not have their license renewed to operate a shop downtown.

But Cabral, who previously served on the advisory board for the state’s Cannabis Control Commission, said Tuesday that to her knowledge, no cannabis company has been denied a provisional license from state authorities because they didn’t have something in their “positive impact” plan.

Cabral was the key — and only — witness called by the defense. She has a lengthy friendship with Tompkins that extends back to when they were both undergraduates at Boston College during the 1970s. When Cabral was Suffolk sheriff, Tompkins was one of her first

three hires at that agency. When she left that post, she recommended that the then-governor Deval Patrick appoint Tompkins to succeed her.

The governor did just that, and Tompkins won multiple reelection campaigns to the office.

On Tuesday, Tompkins’s defense attorney, Martin G. Weinberg, made sure to connect Cabral with Ascend, his argument being that Tompkins would never do anything to hurt the company because that would mean harming Cabral.

Weinberg also quizzed Cabral about Frank Perullo, an Ascend cofounder who was the star witness for the prosecution earlier in the trial. Specifically, Weinberg tried to dispel the notion that Perullo, a longtime political mover-and-shaker in Massachusetts who is the alleged extortion victim in the case, was someone prone to intimidation.

“Frank isn’t afraid of anything or anyone,” said Cabral from the stand. Later, she described Perullo as someone who

“definitely knows how to say ‘no.’”

Previously, Weinberg had portrayed Perullo as having “negotiated a cynical exchange” with federal authorities to avoid prosecution. In contrast, Weinberg on Tuesday highlighted that Cabral had not asked for immunity from federal authorities.

Earlier in the trial, Perullo said he was worried that if the plug was pulled on the Suffolk sheriff’s inmate reentry partnership with Ascend, it would mean further delays in getting his retail operation off the ground, possibly slowing the permitting process and complicating the company’s progress toward an initial public offering.

Perullo also said he didn’t think the Ascend stock deal with Tompkins “was right.”

“I had never been asked for something that was directly tied to a government action,” said Perullo under oath.

During cross-examination on Tuesday, federal prosecutor Dustin Chao tried to undermine

Cabral’s credibility, needling her about a rule she had at one point when she was sheriff where employees were barred from donating to her political campaign. Chao ticked off a lengthy list of relatives of sheriff’s employees who did donate to her campaign while she was in charge of that office.

He also asked her to confirm she did not sell a single Ascend share to Tompkins. Cabral had testified that when Tompkins conveyed to her that he was interested in investing in the nascent local cannabis industry, she directed him to “talk to Frank.”

“I gave nothing to Steve Tompkins,” she said.

The trial is in the middle of its second week. Tompkins did not take the stand. Closing arguments are expected to begin Wednesday morning.

Danny McDonald can be reached at daniel.mcdonald@globe.com. Follow him @Danny_McDonald.

PRIMARY 2026

Dan Koh emerges the winner from crowded Sixth District

►SIXTH
Continued from Page B1

room of Koh supporters crowded around a screen displaying analysis from NBC News' Steve Kornacki. Cheers went up each time his lead expanded over Nguyen's, as the crowd snacked on a charcuterie spread in the hotel's Grand Ballroom, plastered with signs displaying Koh's union support.

At 11:15 p.m., Koh walked out to address his supporters, to chants of "Let's go Koh" from the 100-plus people in the room. He noted his Lebanese and Korean heritage, recounting his family's story to the crowd.

"Just a generation or two later, a Korean Lebanese guy is your Democratic nominee," Koh said. "That's America, baby."

He thanked Biden, whom he said he spoke with on the phone before taking the stage.

"For those who are wondering when you had something not go your way, whether you'll ever have another shot ... it may take a while," Koh said. "It may take eight years."

Nearby, dozens of Nguyen's staff, volunteers, and supporters took over Rockafellas restaurant, a Salem staple, with campaign posters dotting the room while black witch hats and candles hung suspended from the ceiling. Attendees, nursing drinks and munching on finger food, kept their eyes on three television screens over the bar, which were also tuned to Kornacki.

Arriving to raucous applause and shouts of "We love you, Tram," Nguyen wiped tears from her eyes before telling the several dozen supporters gathered that she had called Koh to congratulate him.



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Dan Koh was accompanied by his daughter while voting in Andover.

"While this is not the outcome that we had hoped for, I am just so deeply proud of this incredible people-powered grassroots campaign," Nguyen told the crowd.

"We ran against millions of dollars, and look what we accomplished together," she added.

Koh, much like his 2018 bid in the Third District, far out-raised the field, boasting a \$4.7 million cash haul as of mid-August. He has used those funds to blanket the district with mes-saging about his work under Biden — coming as many Dem-ocrats have distanced them-

selves from the former presi-dent since the party's devastat-ing 2024 losses.

The former White House of-ficial has argued his experienc-es make him best equipped to deliver for the district. He ran a TV ad featuring smiling cameos from Biden and former vice president Kamala Harris, alongside photos from his White House days. Former Bos-ton mayor Marty Walsh, whom Koh served under, stumped for Koh throughout the district, ar-guing he has "lived experience in the political world."

But prominent Massachu-setts Democrats have, in recent

weeks, coalesced around Nguyen, an Andover representative who has leaned into her back-ground as a Vietnamese refugee who defeated a Republican to win her State House seat.

Representatives Lori Trahan and Ayanna Pressley — the only sitting Congress members to wade into the contest — en-dorsed Nguyen days after early voting began. The pair, along-side Attorney General Andrea Campbell, headlined a rally for Nguyen in Salem on Sunday.

In many ways, Nguyen's background and message ap-peared tailor-made for Demo-crats' political messaging this

cycle, centering on protecting immigrants, promoting afford-ability, and taking on the Trump administration. The four-term representative im-migrated to Massachusetts at age 5 from Vietnam and grew up in public housing before becom-ing the first in her family to graduate from college.

Koh, in the final stretch, faced attack after attack, largely over funds he'd received. A group called Guardrails Alli-ance, which purportedly seeks to push back against influence from pro-AI groups, flew a ban-ner over Boston and the North Shore that accused Koh of being "funded by the same AI billion-aires" who back President Trump.

Much of his criticism also came from John Beccia, a Lynn-field financial technology exec-utive and a largely self-funded, first-time candidate who has poured \$4 million into his bid. Beccia had held himself up as a political outsider, with a cam-paign focused on affordability.

The field, which had as many as eight Democrats run-ning this year, has narrowed in recent weeks — even as recently as this past weekend. On Satur-day, Mariah Lancaster, a Salem veterinarian and former con-gressional aide, dropped out and endorsed Nguyen, saying the "district deserves a con-gressperson who answers to the voters and no one else." Lan-caster's exit, however, came af-ter early voting ended, and their name remained on the ballot.

Nguyen isn't the only candi-date who has received backing from a statewide official. Topsfield Town Moderator Jamie Belsito, a former state rep-resentative, held an event in

Gloucester featuring Auditor Diana DiZoglio, who endorsed Belsito early on in her cam-paign.

Belsito, who has centered her run on rejecting money from pro-Israel groups and op-posing the war in Gaza, has es-pecially criticized Nguyen over her time in the Legislature, in-cluding her vote to narrow the scope of a legislative audit.

The race also included Beth-any Andres-Beck, a Middleton software engineer who was first to enter the Sixth District pri-mary to challenge Moulton last summer before he, in turn, de-cided to run against Senator Ed Markey.

Andres-Beck, who focused their bid on discussing how to regulate artificial intelligence, told the Globe last month that their candidacy was "worth do-ing, whether or not I win," pointing to the discussions they had with voters on the subject.

Fund-raising in the Sixth District this year was on pace to top recent open contests in Massachusetts that have also featured crowded Democratic fields: Candidates, including the sole Republican running, collectively raised \$11.9 million as of mid-August.

In the 2018 race to fill the open Third District seat, by comparison — in which Koh was among the top fund-raisers but narrowly lost to Trahan — 10 candidates raised a total of \$11.6 million, including funds they lent themselves. In 2020, the candidates running in the open Fourth District, won by now-Representative Jake Auchincloss, collectively raised \$11.9 million.

Anjali Huynh can be reached at anjali.huynh@globe.com.

Collins wins, Brownsberger race close in state Senate

►STATE SENATE
Continued from Page B1

a major indication of Wu's sway in the district, which includes Belmont, Watertown, and parts of Boston and Cambridge. A two-decade veteran of the state Legislature, Brownsberger is one of the top Democratic lead-ers in the Senate.

The Brownsberger and Col-lins races had drawn attention for their potential to upset the status quo on Beacon Hill and demonstrate just how far Wu's influence extends in Boston politics.

In the Collins race, however, Wu's efforts on behalf of candi-date Gayle did not manage to topple the powerful incumbent. Collins held onto the seat, which is anchored in South Boston and Dorchester.

Collins told The Boston Globe that city election results obtained by his campaign show that he achieved a "decisive" victory, which he said demon-strated that his constituents are looking for an "independent" representative in the state Sen-ate, who is willing to compro-mise.

"I love this city, I love this state, and I want to make sure that it has the type of represen-tation that can represent every-body," Collins said as he ad-dressed a crowd of cheering supporters at Florian Hall in Dorchester.

Just after 11 p.m., Collins said Gayle had not called him to formally concede, but said, "it was not a close election." That said, he implied that he ap-preciated the competition.

Collins acknowledged Wu's endorsement and support for Gayle made for a challenging reelection race, but argued that ultimately his message resonat-ed with voters.

Gayle conceded to Collins, and emotionally addressed her family, volunteers, and other supporters at Sweet Teez Bak-ery in Dorchester.

"The results are not what we wanted, but that's not why I'm crying," Gayle said, shedding a few tears. "He said that I made him be a better state senator, and I hope he means that. We ran one hell of a race"

Gayle noted that the fight isn't over for her, thanking the organizations and nonprofits who stood by her and hoping they continue working toward



MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Campaign signs dotted this voting station in Boston Tuesday.

what her campaign envisioned.

Wu made waves among po-litical observers in June when she endorsed Lander and Gay-le, two first-time candidates, in their bids to unseat Democratic incumbents Wu has fiercely feuded with in recent years.

Wu's influence has weighed heavily over both contests. Brownsberger and Collins both bitterly and publicly clashed with Wu in her first term over their opposition to her proposal to temporarily shift more of the city's prop-erty tax burden onto commercial real estate to ease coming spikes in homeowners' prop-erty tax bills.

Wu's decision to throw her weight behind the two chal-lengers raised eyebrows in the

Boston political universe, and was seen as a direct attack on longtime incumbent Democrats in the body that determines whether many of the mayor's policies succeed or fail.

Wu is coming off her own, resounding reelection victory last year, when she handily beat her main mayoral challenger, Josh Kraft, by double digits in the September preliminary, leading Kraft to drop out of the race before the general election.

Wu has argued that Lander and Gayle would better repre-sent Boston residents in the up-per chamber, where several of Wu's other priorities — includ-ing an effort to cap annual rent increases, and a proposal to tax high dollar real estate transac-tions — have met dead ends.

But her support has also forced Lander and Gayle to answer questions about their perceived "independence" from the may-or.

Both Lander and Gayle have insisted they would be more than mere proxies for Wu on Beacon Hill. Both pitched themselves to voters as fresh faces who would bring an in-creased sense of urgency to the state Legislature, which has faced criticism for its lack of transparency, and its extraordi-nary control over municipal policies ranging from new taxes to distributing liquor licenses.

Meanwhile, Brownsberger and Collins heavily emphasized their records and experience in office as they campaigned for voters' support this year, and

argued they represent appro-priate balance and separation from the mayor's influence.

Juwan Skeens, a former city of Boston youth worker, also ran against Collins in the Dem-ocratic primary.

Wu's backing was a huge boost to Lander and Gayle, as they sought to tackle the notori-ously difficult challenge of un-seating incumbent lawmakers in Boston. Wu door-knocked and canvassed alongside both first-time candidates, promoted their campaigns on her social media accounts, and lent them the support of her robust grass-roots volunteer network.

Lander and Gayle also re-ceived tens of thousands of dol-lars in political donations from the Wu-connected "Boston

Leads" super PAC.

Meanwhile, the Citizens for an Affordable Massachusetts independent expenditure PAC, which has ties to former Boston mayor Martin J. Walsh, contrib-uted at least \$43,000 to Collins' campaign. Walsh also endorsed Brownsberger in his reelection campaign.

No Republicans are running for either state Senate seat.

Kate Selig of the Globe staff and Globe correspondent Sterling Davies contributed to this report. Niki Griswold can be reached at niki.griswold@globe.com. Follow her @nikigriswold. Emma Platoff can be reached at emma.platoff@globe.com. Follow her @emmaplatoff.

The Boston Globe

Business

‘No organic social interactions anymore’

Why young people are enlisting AI to help them make friends in Boston



MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Bethany McMorris, Debby Nguyen, and Victoria Emile danced to a karaoke performance on the floor of Stage Karaoke x Studios in Allston recently. The group was connected through the app 222place, an app that seeks to bring together people based on similarities.

By Jane Miller
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Between doomscrolling and post-pandemic social awkwardness, half of Americans have reported feeling socially isolated. Now, some young adults in Boston are letting AI select their friends as a way to combat that loneliness.

“When I first moved to Boston, I didn’t know anybody,” said Isaiah Mansour, 31, who moved to the area in 2023 for a job in biotech. “My whole team is remote, so I didn’t have any kind of built-in infrastructure to meet people.”

For Mansour, socializing with new people has

never been a challenge, and he immediately joined local Facebook groups and sports clubs. But “it just didn’t totally click,” he said.

Adam Fneiche, a college grad who recently moved to Boston from Ohio, also struggled to break the ice with locals.

“There’s a joke I’ve heard a lot, and it’s where do you make friends in Boston? The same place everyone else did, in kindergarten,” said Fneiche, 22.

Mansour and Fneiche both opted for an innovative solution to their social problems: They downloaded apps that use machine learning to match them with potential friends.

Several apps that use AI to connect users with

new friends have popped up in the past few years. Apps like 222place and Timeleft use algorithms to match people who seem similar and then plan activities. An app called RealRoots is for women only.

Operating in multiple cities in the US and abroad, 222place launched in Boston last year, founder Arman Roshannai, 25, said.

“We came together around 2020, during the height of the pandemic,” Roshannai said. “It was pretty clear that both depression was increasing in young people and the number of close friendships that we had were going down.”

To tackle the problem, he and cofounders Keyan

SOCIAL AI, Page B7

STAT

Alnylam defends heart disease drugs

Argues its medicines maintain their value

By Andrew Joseph
STAT

When AstraZeneca on Friday detailed the failed trial of its drug Wainua in a heart condition known as ATTR-CM, the bad news, according to one school of thought, extended to Cambridge-based Alnylam Pharmaceuticals.

Some analysts interpreted the study’s miss as a broad sign that silencers — the kind of medicine that Alnylam sells and that AstraZeneca was testing — offered no added benefits if patients were already on another kind of drug known as a stabilizer, and as an indication that stabilizers might be superior.

Now, Alnylam is mounting a defense of its silencers, with ramifications both for its marketed drug Amvuttra, and for its next-gen treatment nucesiran.

In an interview with STAT on Sunday, Pushkal Garg, the company’s chief research and development officer, argued that a class-wide sentiment shouldn’t be the takeaway from AstraZeneca’s CARDIO-TTTransform study. Instead, he made the case that there are key differences between his company’s drugs and in the Phase 3 study of nucesiran, known as TRITON-CM, that is currently enrolling participants.

For one, Wainua dialed down the production of TTR — the protein that

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TECH LAB



JENNY KANE/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Brockton would join the rest of Massachusetts’ largest cities and the majority of municipalities in setting up a community aggregation plan.

Brockton looks to ease electric rates through bulk buying. It’s about time.

City to adopt municipal aggregation plan

By Hiawatha Bray
GLOBE STAFF

Brockton is the only large city in Massachusetts that hasn’t embraced a municipal power-buying scheme aimed at lowering residents’ electric bills. But that’s about to change.

In June, the Brockton City Council voted to allow Mayor Moises Rodrigues to begin setting up a community aggregation system, a state-approved system for purchasing electric power for all the homes and

businesses in Brockton. It’s hoped that this system will result in a lower electric rate compared to that of National Grid, the utility that serves the city.

Brockton’s population of about 106,000 makes it the sixth-largest city in Massachusetts. And it’s the only one of the state’s 10 largest cities that hasn’t already embraced community aggregation, a cost-saving option that has been available

TECH LAB, Page B6

POWER PLAY

In politics, prediction markets get top billing

The betting industry serves as another data point in the ‘digital Wild West’

By Shirley Leung
GLOBE COLUMNIST

As primary results rolled in from across Massachusetts Tuesday night, some political junkies were keeping one eye on the prediction markets.

That’s because Kalshi and Polymarket have infiltrated our politics — much in the way betting odds have become part of our sports culture. And you can bet not just on who wins, but on the margin and voter turnout.

Sure, prediction markets have been around for decades, but lately they’ve become big business. Ahead

of this election cycle, CNN and the Wall Street Journal inked partnerships with Kalshi and Polymarket respectively, embedding real-time data onto their sites. Trading volume at Kalshi and Polymarket, the two leading prediction markets, has grown exponentially over the past year to about \$24 billion a month, according to a Pew Research analysis, as people bet on just about everything from sports to political primaries.

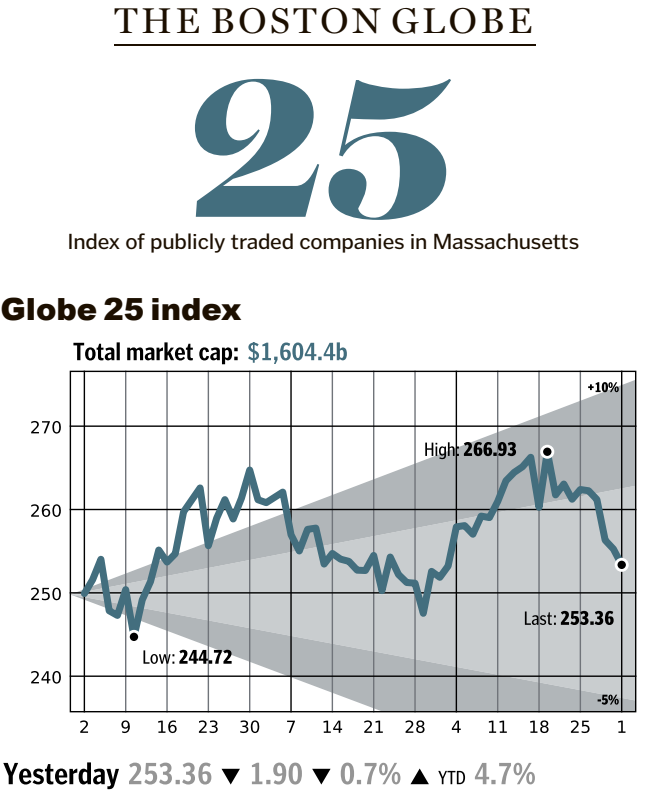
The markets are popular because, well, people like to make money.

And you can do that if you place the

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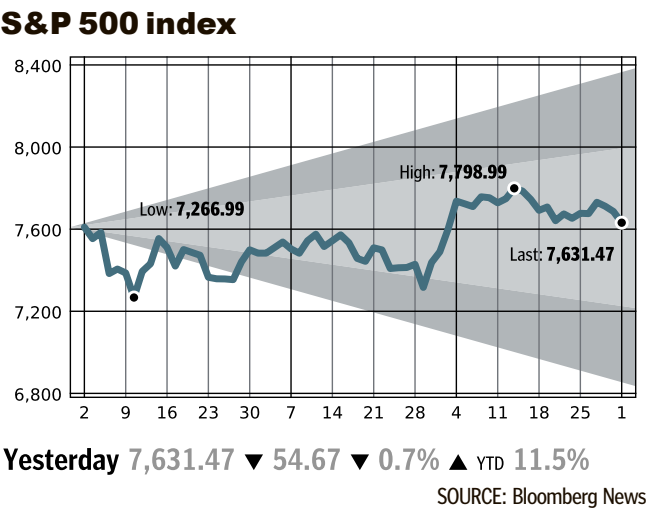
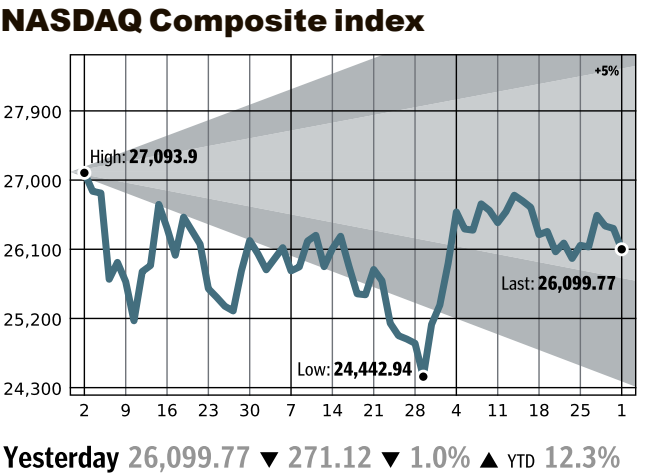
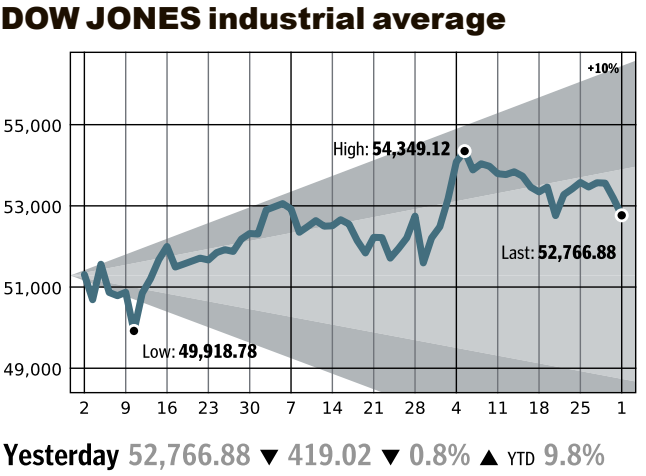


	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	898.53	+0.00	+0.0	239.3
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	600.50	-16.60	-2.7	222.0
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	354.52	-7.62	-2.1	171.8
TJX COS INC (TJX)	133.27	-0.64	-0.5	146.6
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	547.65	+3.13	+0.6	138.8
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	176.02	+0.32	+0.2	82.0
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	48.08	-0.22	-0.5	69.7
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	154.27	+13.93	+9.9	61.6
TERADYNE INC (TER)	335.46	-14.37	-4.1	52.4
STATE ST CORP (STT)	187.79	-3.59	-1.9	51.6
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	31.89	+0.03	+0.1	43.4
WATERS CORP (WAT)	405.84	-8.79	-2.1	39.9
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	114.22	-1.13	-1.0	34.0
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	246.11	+5.42	+2.3	32.9
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	216.04	-0.61	-0.3	31.9
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	70.50	+0.36	+0.5	26.6
VERALTO CORP (VLT)	97.05	-1.52	-1.5	23.7
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	38.22	-1.45	-3.7	23.1
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	262.01	-1.82	-0.7	20.0
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	129.51	-5.78	-4.3	19.8
MKS INC (MKS)	246.44	-9.80	-3.8	16.7
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	315.25	+0.00	+0.0	16.6
PTC INC (PTC)	152.81	-2.93	-1.9	16.6
AKAMAI TECHNOLOG (AKAM)	106.46	-2.16	-2.0	15.3
VICOR CORP (VICR)	175.99	-11.69	-6.2	8.1

Markets

Bad day for oil, Big Tech, bonds

Stocks closed broadly lower Tuesday as another round of US military strikes on Iran sent oil prices higher, stoking worries about stubbornly high inflation. A bond market sell-off deepened, putting more pressure on stocks. The weak start to September follows a shaky but mostly positive month for Wall Street. Every major index notched monthly gains in August. The same worries continue to hang over Wall Street, though, including anxiety over rising prices, government debt, and the impact of global conflicts on the US and the global economy. Technology stocks were among the heaviest weights on the market. Nvidia fell 1.5 percent, Amazon dropped 1.9 percent, and Advanced Micro Devices gave up 2.4 percent. Much of the continued pressure being felt by Wall Street is coming from an ongoing sell-off in US government bonds. The US debt surpassed \$40 trillion two weeks ago, a shocking milestone as defense costs and interest on the burgeoning deficit make up an enormous share of federal spending. The bond sell-off is global, with other nations facing the same economic pressures. Higher yields on bonds signal higher borrowing costs on mortgages and other loans. — ASSOCIATED PRESS



Music industry grapples with AI use

Some see as new tool, others as existential threat

By Brent Crane
NEW YORK TIMES

Comedian Bill Stiteler didn’t follow a conventional path to pop music stardom. In fact, he doesn’t really see himself as a musician at all.

A couple of years ago, Stiteler began creating jokey “realistic walk-up songs” for Major League Baseball players using Suno, an artificial intelligence music generator. The clips helped boost his follower count on Instagram. But his first certifiable hit came when he applied the same irreverent tone to travel and asked Suno to compose a song about a vacation trip.

His AI-assisted ode to an island, “The Puerto Rico Song,” has nearly 20 million Spotify streams, millions of views on YouTube and a licensing deal that earns him royalties. (He won’t disclose dollar amounts.) In June, Puerto Rico’s tourism board flew him out to record a music video. “It’s a wild place to vacation,” his AI singer belts. “Slot machines in the bus station.”

Stiteler, 37, has produced dozens of ticklish AI ditties about cities, often obscure ones



Barry Chin/Globe Staff / File

Mikey Shulman, cofounder of Cambridge-based Suno.

(Altoona, Pa.; Morgantown, W.Va.; Manchester, N.H.). He writes the lyrics for what he calls his “pseudomusic”; Suno does the rest. “I’m not an artist,” he said. “I’m a fartist.”

The process gives him “such impostor syndrome about this musician stuff,” he added. “Musicians work their entire life. But I make this freaking AI Puerto Rico song and it’s smoking, like doing really well.”

The music industry has similarly mixed feelings about AI tools like Suno, which have set off a debate — and several lawsuits — over how to monetize the growing tsunami of AI-created tunes.

“Some folks believe that AI music should be eradicated,” said Rob Jonas, chief executive of Luminate, a music industry analytics company. “Others believe that music is not about how it’s made but how it makes you feel. If AI creates the same emotional reaction that organic mu-

sic does, then it’s music.”

Suno (Hindi for “listen”) was founded in Cambridge in 2022. Since then, around a dozen AI-generated songs have appeared on the Billboard charts. Deezer, a European music streaming platform, said last month that AI-generated songs accounted for half of its total uploads. Spotify, in partnership with Universal, is allowing users to pay to remix certain songs using AI.

Over 100 million people have made music with Suno, the company says, each producing an average of 42 songs per month. Two million users pay up to \$30 a month for more advanced features, like splitting a generated track into isolated vocals and instruments. For a few weeks this year, Suno was the most popular download in the music category of Apple’s app store. (Apple Music announced this month that it would soon require AI music to be tagged as such.)

There are competitors: Udio, Riffusion, ElevenLabs. But Suno, which has raised roughly \$1 billion from the likes of Bond Capital and Union Square Ventures, with a \$5.4 billion valuation, is the clear leader of this emerging industry. Many artists find the rise of such platforms scary. But in the telling of Mikey Shulman, Suno’s chief executive, no one should be afraid.

“The purpose of Suno is to al-

low the whole world to feel creative fulfillment,” he said. “In the future, this will be present in a lot of different domains. We do music.” Not all artists are afraid: “It’s a new tool for creativity,” hip-hop titan Dr. Dre told The New York Times this month. “I’m embracing it.”

The labels and artists who see Suno as mostly a threat portray AI music less as another creative tool than another iteration of Napster-esque thievery. A hacker who breached the start-up and shared findings with 404 Media accused Suno of illegally scraping songs from YouTube Music, Genius, Deezer, and others. The hacked data “involved outdated source code that is no longer in use,” Suno told the publication. In a statement, a spokesperson said that Suno’s models were “trained on publicly available music files on the open internet.”

In November, Warner announced a partnership with its former litigant. Warner artists, from Ed Sheeran to Charli XCX, can now individually opt in to let Suno use their names, images, likenesses, voices and compositions in AI-generated songs. Suno also acquired Songkick, the concert-discovery platform, from Warner as part of the deal. Most significantly, Suno is developing a “licensed model,” trained on Warner’s catalog.

Alnylam defends heart drugs after Wainua failure

►STAT
Continued from Page B5

gets misfolded in ATTR-CM, driving the disease — less than Alnylam’s drugs have shown they can, which can lead to differing clinical results. The patients in CARDIO-TTTransform as a whole had more advanced disease, whereas TRITON is prioritizing early-stage patients who are more likely to be helped by any effective treatment. And TRITON has all-cause mortality as a primary endpoint, while AstraZeneca’s study was limited to cardiovascular outcomes.

“This is a systemic disease — patients die from a variety of causes,” Garg said, adding that the CARDIO-TTTransform data “reaffirm that those were the right choices to make” with regard to the design of TRITON. At the same time, Garg said that Alnylam was continuing to review the data and would make “any further adjustments” to the trial if necessary.

In the nuresiran trial, Alnylam is also “managing” the percentage of patients who enroll who are already on a stabilizer by including in the study sites in parts of the world where stabilizer use isn’t as common, he said.

In Amvuttra’s successful Phase 3 HELIOS-B study, which was presented two years ago at the European Society of Cardiology’s annual meeting, 40 percent of participants were on a stabilizer at the outset of the trial. In CARDIO-TTTransform, the proportion was 57 percent, according to results presented Friday at this year’s ESC conference in Munich, reflecting the increase in stabilizer use over the years. While Wainua seemed to show a benefit among partici-



ALNYLAM

Multiple companies, including Alnylam, are working to treat ATTR-CM.

pants who weren’t already on a stabilizer — the so-called monotherapy subgroup — the drug’s poor performance in combination with a stabilizer caused the overall failure of the study, investigators said.

ATTR-CM, also called transthyretin-mediated amyloid cardiomyopathy, is a progressive heart disease that occurs when TTR becomes misfolded, building up in heart muscles. The heart then can’t pump blood as well, ultimately leading to fatal heart failure without treatment. The condition is caused by a mutation or by aging.

Silencers are designed to tamp down the production of TTR, while stabilizers, including BridgeBio’s new Attribry and Pfizer’s older drug Vyndamax, aim to prevent the protein from misfolding.

On Sunday at the ESC meeting, researchers also presented further analyses of the HELIOS-B study that showed Amvuttra helped patients on a range of endpoints regardless of whether they were already on a stabilizer when they enrolled in the study. Still, the magnitude of benefits was greater in the monotherapy arm.

Investigators described the findings as a trend indicating that Amvuttra provided ad-

ditional benefits when used in combination, although the results were not statistically significant because the study was not designed or powered to answer that particular question.

“The present analysis suggests the possibility that vutrisiran may also provide incremental clinical benefit among patients receiving background tafamidis therapy,” they wrote in a paper published in the Journal of the American College of Cardiology, using the respective scientific name of Amvuttra and Vyndamax. Because of the lack of statistical power, they wrote that “these analyses should be interpreted as hypothesis-generating.”

Alnylam, in a press release touting the presentation, said the analyses “reinforce the impact of vutrisiran ... and warrant further evaluation of TTR silencing and stabilization combination strategies.”

“This focus on mono versus combo a little bit misses the forest for the trees,” Garg told STAT. “The bigger part is having really deep [TTR] knockdown, getting in to the right patients, and having the right endpoint. And in those settings, we think a silencer can be quite effective, both in mono and in combo.”

Brockton to embrace aggregated electric plan

►TECH LAB
Continued from Page B5

for nearly three decades. It’s unclear why the city hasn’t attempted aggregation until now, and Brockton officials did not respond to a request for comment.

The idea of community aggregation was born in Massachusetts in 1997, and incorporated into the state law that deregulated the sale of electric power.

The law required utilities to spin off their power generators into independent companies. These generators could compete against each other, which might lead to electric price wars and lower power bills. Meanwhile, the utilities would continue to deliver power to homes and businesses as government-regulated monopolies.

Eventually, 35 US states would embrace power deregulation, but it didn’t lead to lower prices. In fact, electricity generally costs less in states where power generation is still regulated.

In a deregulated market, the

companies that generate electric power, including giant firms such as Constellation Energy and NRG Energy, can market their power to millions of individual consumers and businesses. But like selling door to door, it’s difficult and costly.

Massachusetts energy activists came up with an alternative. Cities and towns could bundle all their electric users and let power generators bid on the right to supply all of them with electric power under a single contract. In exchange for suppliers getting inexpensive access to a big pool of customers, the cities could demand a lower rate.

The 1997 deregulation law included a provision to allow the creation of these community aggregation programs. The nation’s first aggregator, the Cape Light Compact, was founded in 1997. Since then, aggregators have been established throughout the United States, and in Massachusetts, 245 communities — or about 70 percent of the state’s municipalities — have set up similar

plans.

During a public hearing on the plan on Aug. 24, the only resistance came from Brockton’s Ward 3 City Councilor Philip Griffin.

“I’m not saying I’m against it,” said Griffin. “I just don’t like the way that it’s set up.” He complained that all Brockton residents will be automatically signed up for the plan, with a 30-day window to opt out.

“I don’t want to be forced into something that I don’t want to be involved in,” Griffin said. “I don’t think a lot of residents do either.”

Griffin also said he wants more information about Good Energy, the company that will run the program on behalf of the city, and how the company plans to make a profit on the deal.

Patrick Roche, Good Energy’s director of innovation, conceded that there’s no guarantee that an aggregator will always provide cheaper electricity than the utility’s basic rate. But it often works out that way.

For instance, Good Energy

runs the aggregator service for Brookline, which offers electric rates as low as 13.4 cents per kilowatt-hour, compared to the 17.3 cents basic residential service cost charged by Eversource. That works out to a savings of around \$23 a month for a typical household. “These aren’t windfall savings, but they can be meaningful,” Roche said.

In Boston, where Eversource charges the same basic residential rate, the city’s aggregator service charges as little as 13.6 cents per kilowatt-hour.

And in both Brookline and Boston, the aggregator’s rate is locked in until December of 2027, while Eversource resets its rates every six months.

Roche said the aggregator’s long-term price stability is one of its best features.

“We can guarantee you that we can bring you more stability,” he said.

Hiawatha Bray can be reached at hiawatha.bray@globe.com. Follow him @GlobeTechLab.

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TALKING POINTS

FASHION

SHEIN'S SHARES FALL AFTER HONG KONG TRADING DEBUT THAT SPOTLIGHTS ITS CHINA ROOTS



Shares in fast-fashion online retail giant Shein fell as much as 10 percent after they began trading on Hong Kong's stock market Tuesday, after a long delay in the company's plans to list its shares publicly. Shein raised about \$1.7 billion, priced at 48.56 Hong Kong dollars (\$6.19) a share, in its initial public offering in Hong Kong in one of the city's biggest new share sales this year. "Shein's Hong Kong listing marks a new starting point," said Leigh Gui, Shein's chief financial officer, in a short speech at its listing ceremony. In early trading, the shares fell to below HK\$44 before losses narrowed later in the day. It closed nearly unchanged at HK\$48.50. Shein's appeal to customers has been built on ultra-fast, affordable fashion, delivered from China to the West in just days. The end of "de minimis" tariff exemptions in the US and the European Union has raised duties for low value parcels from China, including Shein's products. Higher logistics costs partly due to the war in Iran also have squeezed the company's low-price business model and profitability. Tariff costs have forced Shein to raise prices, "cutting into its main advantage," said Jacob Cooke, CEO of WPIC Marketing + Technologies. Shein recorded a \$99 million loss in the first three months of this year, compared with a \$395 million profit in the same period a year earlier. Earlier, Shein, pronounced "she-in," explored listing its shares in New York and London. It moved its headquarters from China to Singapore around 2021. But increasingly strict scrutiny by Beijing and by regulators in the US and Europe led it to embrace its Chinese roots and switch to a listing in Hong Kong.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

TECH

APPLE BEGINS ITS NEXT BALANCING ACT AS NEW CEO TAKES OVER



John Ternus became Apple's CEO on Tuesday, succeeding Tim Cook, the company's leader for the last 15 years. The long-anticipated handoff, Cook has said, will be "perfectly smooth." But the changing of the guard could still have some bumps. Ternus will have to guide Apple through an unusual amount of leadership churn. He will have to stem an exodus of talent to companies like OpenAI. And he will have to distinguish himself from Cook, who will remain at Apple as its executive chair. Most of all, Ternus will have to perform a balancing act: displaying the financial predictability and discipline that have been a hallmark of the Cook era while showing that Apple can still create new products that capture the imagination of consumers. Ternus will have to do so while steering Apple through arguably the biggest technology shift in a generation. At its annual hardware event this month, Apple is expected to introduce a foldable iPhone — its most significant change in 19 years to its most important product. The company is also taking another stab at weaving artificial intelligence through its products. "Apple is going to have to face this idea of 'What's next?'" said Michael Gartenberg, a consumer technology analyst who worked as a product marketer at Apple from 2013 to 2016. The task for Ternus, he added, is to "bring Apple back to being a cool brand even though it's a multitrillion-dollar company, show that you are able to innovate." Apple, which has waffled over how aggressively to embrace AI, will tackle those questions with a changing management team. Over the past four months, Ternus, 51, has started to install his own executives, mixing a roster of Apple veterans with newcomers.

— NEW YORK TIMES

FOOD & BEVERAGE

KEURIG DR PEPPER TO SELL BACK CHOBANI STAKE, MANUFACTURING SITE FOR \$925M

Keurig Dr Pepper said on Tuesday it would sell its stake in Chobani back to the yogurt maker along with a manufacturing facility for \$925 million, as the beverage company reshapes its business following its acquisition of JDE Peet's. Keurig, which has a headquarters in Burlington, will sell its entire equity stake in Chobani for \$800 million, and a manufacturing facility and warehouse in Allentown, Pa., for \$125 million. The company has been reshaping its portfolio since its \$18 billion acquisition of Dutch coffee and tea maker JDE Peet's in April. It is also preparing to separate its coffee and beverage operations into two publicly traded US companies. Chobani said it would invest about \$1.2 billion over the next five years in the facility, as it seeks to create milk with more protein and less sugar than traditional milk. Last month, Keurig Dr Pepper maintained its annual forecasts after strong demand for its soda and energy drink brands helped it beat second-quarter sales and profit estimates.

— REUTERS



PRIVATE EQUITY

NESTLE TO DIVEST MAINSTREAM SUPPLEMENTS BUSINESS FOR \$1B

Nestle on Tuesday agreed to divest Holistic Health platform, its mainstream vitamins, minerals, and supplements (VMS) business, to private equity firm Yellow Wood Partners for \$1 billion, according to a statement from the two companies. The deal includes seven brands — Nature's Bounty, Osteo Bi-Flex, Ester-C, Gard, Nuun, Puritan's Pride, and Sisu — and the US private-label supplements business, the Swiss food giant said in its statement. "We are focusing our resources where we have the strongest competitive advantage," Nestle chief executive Philipp Navratil said, adding that "the mainstream VMS business requires a different approach under dedicated ownership." The deal, which is expected to close by the first half of 2027, is Yellow Wood's sixth acquisition from major consumer companies since 2019. The Boston-based firm acquired lip balm brand ChapStick from Haleon in 2024, and Unilever's non-core beauty and personal care division Eliada Beauty in 2023.

— REUTERS

EMPLOYMENT

JOB OPENINGS RISE TO 7.3M AS LABOR MARKET REMAINS STURDY

Employers posted slightly more job openings in July but the American labor market remained sturdy in the face of higher costs that are squeezing household budgets. US job openings ticked up to 7.27 million in July from a revised 7.18 million in June, the Labor Department reported Tuesday. The department's Job Openings and Labor Turnover Survey also showed that layoffs fell. But so did the number of people quitting their jobs — a sign of confidence in their prospects. The report showed that gross hiring — before subtracting those who lost or quit their jobs — dipped to 5.1 million in July from 5.3 million in June.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

HOMEBUILDING

US CONSTRUCTION SPENDING DROPS TO NEARLY 3-YEAR LOW IN JULY



US construction spending unexpectedly fell in July, hitting the lowest level in nearly three years as higher mortgage rates weighed on single-family homebuilding. The Commerce Department's Census Bureau said on Tuesday that construction spending dropped 0.5 percent to \$2.158 trillion, the lowest level since October 2023. Data for June was revised higher to show construction spending unchanged instead of dipping 0.1 percent, as previously reported. Economists polled by Reuters had forecast construction spending would be unchanged in July. Construction spending plunged 3.8 percent on a year-over-year basis in July. Spending on private construction projects decreased 0.5 percent after easing 0.1 percent in June. Investment in residential construction tumbled 1.3 percent. Spending on single-family housing projects dropped 3.2 percent. On a year-over-year basis, it plummeted 6.5 percent in July. Homebuilding is also being squeezed by a glut of unsold single-family houses. The average rate on the popular 30-year fixed-rate mortgage is hovering near a one-year high of 6.66 percent, data from mortgage finance agency Freddie Mac showed. It has surged by almost 70 basis points since the US-Israeli war with Iran started in late February. Spending on multifamily housing units, which account for a small share of the housing market, rose 0.2 percent in July.

— REUTERS

Young people turn to apps to make friend connections

►SOCIAL AI
Continued from Page B5

Kazemian, 27, and Danial Hashemi, 25, developed a personality test to try to predict initial social compatibility among strangers, he said.

Subscribers pay \$22.22 a month and are matched with people based on their personality-quiz responses. Then they attend a night of activities the app plans for them, he said.

When Fneiche moved to Boston, he spent most of his time with his sister. But once she went out of town, he felt like he needed to seek out some new friends — via app.

"It's almost like joining this community," he said, standing outside his third 222place event at Stage Karaoke x Studios in Allston.

It's "like a paid third space in a way, like a digital third space," he added. "You're there to make friends" and "there's this expectation that everyone's gonna be open to it."

The women-only app, RealRoots, also uses a predictive AI model to match friends.

The founder, Dorothy Li, of Thousand Oaks, Calif., was inspired to make the app after her own struggles with post-grad loneliness.

"I was literally just going to yoga studios, saying 'Hi' to people at gyms, you know, trying to make eye contact at cafes," Li said.

people to find social communities.

"Maybe 50 years ago, there was a lot of social infrastructure for people already, like community centers, churches, sports leagues," he said.

"Right now, it almost feels like the burden to build your entire social infrastructure is on each individual person," he added. "It's kind of unfair to expect one individual person to do all this for themselves."

"It is definitely harder post-grad," Fneiche said. "Especially if your co-workers aren't your age or if they don't live nearby. Like I love you, Mark, but you're 32 and you live in Framingham. I don't think we can hang out."

Experts say multiple factors may be making it harder for young people to cultivate social connections.

"I think most people will agree that there are a lot of reasons why this generation seems to have less developed interpersonal skills," said Dori Hutchinson, director at the Center for Psychiatric Rehabilitation at Boston University.

"This is a generation that has literally grown up with the phone as an extension of who they are," Hutchinson said. "It has impacted their interpersonal skill development because they just have reduced real world, real people connecting."

Gen Z in particular went

'I went from having basically no friends in the area to I can organize a party with 40 people easily at this point.'

ISAIAH MANSOUR,
who found several friend connections using an app

With her attempts at building connections falling flat, she began developing an alternative in the form of RealRoots, which she launched in 2024.

After taking a personality test and paying a \$289 subscription fee that includes six weeks of experiences with a group and a year of access to certain RealRoots activities, members get matched with a group of six to 12 women, Li said. If they don't click with their group after a first meeting, they have the opportunity to be rematched.

Torri Webb, 37, joined RealRoots at the end of 2024 after moving to Boston the year before and struggling to befriend locals.

"I just was, like, starting to get really depressed," she said.

She said she joined RealRoots to "commit" to solving her loneliness spell. "Everyone was so nice, and I do feel like the girls were really well matched to me," Webb said.

Of course, as with any gathering of random people, the app meet-ups can be hit or miss.

Sometimes the algorithm will predict high compatibility with someone you don't click with at all, said Dean Impastato, 22, a 222place user.

"I think that only happened once," he said.

In other cases, the picks are spot on.

"One of the guys that I met in my very first event has become one of my best friends," Mansour said.

Mansour went on to do 14 events with 222place in the month of January alone.

"I went from having basically no friends in the area to I can organize a party with 40 people easily at this point," Mansour said.

Roshannai thinks friendship apps can take the burden off

through the pandemic "at a very important time of development in their life," Hutchinson said.

Still, a concern raised by some users is that apps reinforce dependence on the digital sphere for human connection. But Roshannai says he sees them as a way to make the most of your time IRL.

"We have no intention of trying to capture more screen time or get people trapped on their phones," Roshannai said. "We're doing whatever we can to give people as much in real life time as possible."

Victoria Emile, 26, of Cambridge, thinks a lot of the same people using friendship apps are also on dating apps, especially post-COVID.

"Social interactions in general have become much more difficult ... which is why you use apps now," said Emile, who moved to the area from France a few years ago. "So there are no organic social interactions anymore."

Mansour admitted he was someone who downloaded a friendship app after a breakup.

"I think a lot of us came kind of coyly exploring it as a relationship avenue," Mansour said. "But what ended up happening was we all became friends, and now we don't want to date within that cohort because the friendship is so much more valuable."

Finding your people is important, experts say, regardless of the avenue used to get there.

"If young people have grown up with apps and using apps as a way to kind of structure how they go about building community and expanding their friendships," Hutchinson said, "if that works for folks, then I say go for it."

Jane Miller can be reached at jane.miller@globe.com.

New ‘delightful’ college aid form offers estimate more quickly

By Ann Carrns
NEW YORK TIMES

Filling out the FAFSA college student aid form may not yet be “delightful,” as federal officials hope. But after fixes triggered by a notorious technical meltdown three years ago, the online application may start to shed its burdensome reputation.

The FAFSA update for the 2027-28 academic year is undergoing testing and is scheduled to be made widely available to students by Oct. 1, the traditional annual opening date.

“It has changed tremendously for the better,” said Julia Hellmich, senior managing director of the college readiness and alumni support program at KIPP DC, a network of charter schools in Washington.

The new form can generally be completed quickly, and gives students an estimate of their financial aid eligibility much faster than previous versions did, according to Federal Student Aid officials as well as advocates and parents who have tested it.

A government website was upbeat, telling users, “There’s a lot to look forward to” in the new FAFSA. It said changes, like tweaks to the wording of some questions, “aim to make the applicant experience quicker and more delightful.”

That should be welcome news for families in a year that has brought worrisome changes to the world of student aid, including new borrowing limits on education loans for parents and graduate students.

The FAFSA now has a new feature, added in April for the current, 2026-27 form and kept for the coming October version: embedded fraud detection screening, which could require some students to verify their identities on camera while completing the form.

What is the FAFSA?

The FAFSA, short for the Free Application for Federal Student Aid, is required for students seeking federal financial aid for studies beyond high

school. The form collects personal and financial information from students and parents and calculates eligibility for federal aid, including grants, work-study programs and low-cost loans.

Many states and many universities also use the form to divvy up their own need-based aid. About 2 million high school seniors typically file the form each year, according to the National College Attainment Network, a non-profit that promotes college attendance. And research shows that high school seniors who complete the FAFSA are more likely to attend college right after graduation.

Are things expected to go smoothly this year?

Yes, based on early trials of the form, known as beta testing. “It’s 99 percent running smoothly,” said Eddy Conroy, a spokesperson for the National College Attainment Network. Several of the group’s member organizations have participated in the testing, which began in early August and expanded to a wider pool of students last week.

About 2,300 forms were completed in the first stage of beta testing, according to the Education Department, and larger numbers are going to be processed in the coming weeks.

Live testing of the form before its wide release has become routine as part of the effort to catch potential issues early. In the fall of 2023, during a major overhaul of the form under the Biden administration, serious glitches delayed the form’s availability by about three months. The situation improved in 2024 after early testing helped identify problems, but the form was still delayed by a month. Last fall, under the Trump administration, the FAFSA opened to the public on time.

Can I participate in testing?

Early testers were invited by community groups and schools chosen by the Education Department in seven states (Alabama, Arizona, California, Florida, Mississippi, New York and

Pennsylvania) as well as in Washington, D.C., Puerto Rico and the Marshall Islands (which has close ties to the United States).

You can join the latest test phase by submitting a request online at StudentAid.gov. If you are chosen, you’ll be notified by email. If you complete the form during the testing period, you won’t need to resubmit it later; the forms filed during the test are official FAFSAs.

Financial aid experts say it’s fine to wait until October to complete the form. “There’s no advantage or disadvantage” to filing it before then, said Sarah Austin, a policy analyst at the National Association of Student Financial Aid Administrators — unless you want to cross a task off your to-do list. “If October is a significantly busy month for you, you can absolutely request to participate now,” she said.

Leslie Smith, 57, who lives in Washington and is a part-time student, said she and her daughter, a sophomore at American University, had each filled out the form at an event hosted by College Track, a group that promotes college readiness. “I like to get stuff off my plate,” Smith said. Because she had filled out the form before, she said, most of her information was already there.

Once the form opens to the public, it’s typically best to submit it as soon as you can, Austin said. That’s because states and colleges might have limited aid and often set priority deadlines for applications, some as early as mid-January. If you wait too long, you may miss out on money for college.

What can I expect from the form this year?

One welcome change is that students and families should get an estimate of their federal aid eligibility within a minute or two of submitting the form, Conroy said. Previously, they had to wait several days.

That’s a significant improvement, he said, because students and their parents often complete the form at evening or weekend workshops. With a swift re-



NEW YORK TIMES

sponse, they can discuss the results and head home with a better idea of how much aid they can expect for college, rather than having to follow up again later.

Overall, said Aaron Lemon-Strauss, the former FAFSA program director, the average time to complete a form is now about 10 minutes per person, based on data from the current FAFSA and the beta testing that reflects first-time and returning filers. In the past, he said, it could take an hour or longer.

Manisha Mishra, deputy director of Alabama Possible, a nonprofit anti-poverty group that promotes college attendance, said 127 families attended its FAFSA test event on Aug. 20 at a high school in Trussville, Alabama. Most completed the form in about 15 to 20 minutes, she said.

At KIPP DC, 175 students participated in testing this year, with 40 percent completing the form at an in-person event. That’s an increase from 20 percent last year, when KIPP DC first joined the testing, a spokesperson said.

Does the form have new security features?

So-called real-time identity screening tools were added to the FAFSA in April to reduce student aid fraud, the Federal Student Aid department said. Based on the analysis of the built-in tools, participants considered “high risk” would be required to confirm their identities on camera by showing a government-issued ID, like a driver’s license. Factors used to assess risk might include mouse and keyboard movement that suggest automation, and whether the applicant’s location fits with his or her home and school addresses, according to a summary provided during a summit on higher-education fraud in July.

Prediction markets explode in politics

►POWER PLAY Continued from Page B5

right trade at the right time, just like buying and selling a stock. On Kalshi, there’s \$2.9 million and counting riding on the outcome of the Democratic Senate primary between Ed Markey and Seth Moulton. And when people bet their own money, they tend to be honest, which isn’t always the case when a pollster calls up.

But while pollsters try to be clear about where they get their information — demographically-representative surveys of real people — determining who’s setting the market on political prediction markets, and what information they’re using, can be murky.

“We’re really headed into a new kind of digital Wild West,” said Joan Donovan, an assistant professor of journalism at Boston University who studies technology and social change. “When it comes to marketing these as polls, they’re really only representative of a largely male audience of gamblers who are very rarely represented in polls.”

Kalshi says the median age of a trader on its site is 28 years old and about three-quarters of users are men. Hundreds of thousands of people in Massachusetts have signed up for accounts; only about 25 percent of all visitors place trades.

Prediction markets can be most useful in races where there isn’t much public polling — and so far research indicates that they’re pretty accurate. A recent Washington Post analysis of 268 primary races this year found that when candidates received a 70 to 80 percent odds of winning on either Kalshi or Polymarket in the two months leading up to the primary, they did, indeed, prevail about 75 percent of the time.

Meanwhile, political polls have been famously off ever since 2016, when Hillary Clinton was widely forecast to win the presidency. This primary season also produced some big misses in Wisconsin and Michigan.

So do pollsters have to worry their jobs might be supplanted by the wisdom of the crowd?

“I don’t pay attention to the prediction markets with any sort of serious lens because they’re so volatile,” said Jane Rayburn, a Massachusetts-based Democratic pollster who works all over the country including for New York Mayor Zohran Mamdani. “My job is to take a snapshot in time, assess the state of a race, and then figure out how to move the needle.”

David Paleologos, a Suffolk University pollster who conducts polls for the Globe, isn’t worried either. He notes that prediction markets traders rely on traditional polls to formulate their odds, and their accuracy often comes from aggregating both public and private polls.

“That added information makes them more reliable to predict outcomes than ANY INDIVIDUAL pollster,” he wrote in an email.

Yet it’s far from clear what prediction markets might look like going forward.

They exist in a gray legal area. Massachusetts Attorney General Andrea Campbell sued Kalshi last year, saying it needs a gaming license to offer sports bets here. Other states have filed similar legal challenges, and the US Supreme Court may ultimately decide if prediction markets should be regulated like online sports betting.

There’s also growing concern about insider trading, despite Kalshi’s own rules banning it. On Monday, the platform issued its first lifetime ban against former congressman George Santos, who allegedly bet on his State of the Union appearance. That came on the heels of White House teleprompter operator Gabriel Perez settling federal charges that he profited off of Kalshi’s “mention market,” where he traded on the content of presidential speeches.

Josh Clinton, a professor of political science at Vanderbilt University who studies prediction markets, urges people to proceed with caution.

“The stakes of democracy,” Clinton said, “are too much to let your decision be based on some number that we may not fully understand.”

Shirley Leung is a Business columnist. She can be reached at shirley.leung@globe.com.

A general store almost as old as America

In business since 1793, patrons enjoy candy, local honey, and an ‘atmosphere of bygone days’ at S. Dartmouth shop

By Steven Kurutz
NEW YORK TIMES

SOUTH DARTMOUTH — Davoll’s General Store opened for business during George Washington’s second presidential term. It has been around so long that newspaper articles from the 1940s praised its “atmosphere of bygone days.”

Davoll’s, which lies at a crossroads in South Dartmouth sells items as varied as garden hoes and local honey, and it has a cafe in the back.

Since 1793, it has had 13 proprietors. The current owners are the Shattuck brothers, Ben, 42, and Will, 44.

Ben Shattuck, a writer, lives most of the year in Brooklyn with his wife — actress, comedian, and writer Jenny Slate — and their 5-year-old daughter. But he comes by his ownership genuinely. He grew up in South Dartmouth, a coastal farming community, and his family ties to the area go back five generations. Shattuck and Slate spend the summers there, in a converted dance hall designed by his great-grandfather.

Shattuck’s memories of the store go back to when he was drawn to the bins of penny candy. “The Glennons owned it when I was growing up,” he said, referring to a local eye doctor and his wife. “I don’t know how the owners made it. I guess because online shopping didn’t exist.”

In recent years, general stores, long a lifeline in rural America, have undergone a revival — along with an upscaling.

Modern iterations, stocked with organic produce and artisanal goods, are doing brisk business in places like the Catskills, coastal Maine, and Nashville, Tenn. Last year, Mindy Gray, who is married to Jonathan Gray, the billionaire president of the investment firm Blackstone, took over the Sagonack General Store in the Hamptons, stocking it with Charleston Chews, free-range chicken, \$159 hoodies and a \$300 cocktail kit.

The appeal is simple: General stores offer nostalgia for a bygone era and an attractive backdrop for social media.

Ben Shattuck seems uninter-

ested in retro trendiness. But he misses the days when people spent their disposable income in town, rather than online or at corporate chain stores.

“The teeth of capitalism have torn through small businesses,” he said. “Instead, we have McDonald’s, Home Depot, Dunkin’. Those all used to be blended into this beautiful thing called a general store.

“It’s not that the New England general store is old-fashioned,” he continued. “It’s timeless.”

For a long time, Davoll’s was a source of provisions for the farmers who worked nearby. Old men sat on the porch chewing tobacco and playing checkers. A tailor worked on the second floor. The store also had a post office.

“Davoll’s was always the center of attention,” said Jane Tuckerman, who grew up in South Dartmouth and lives across the street in a 19th-century farmhouse.

These days, the big dairy farms are nearly gone, and the area has become the sort of artsy agrarian place where a crowd will gather on a Friday evening to hear a talk on heirloom seeds.

Shattuck’s version of Davoll’s embodies its current time and place. It sells water in glass bottles, not plastic. The beef, grass-fed, is from Jordan Farm just down the road. You won’t find the processed snacks or high-fructose sodas you would at a truck stop (or the old Davoll’s, for that matter). But it hasn’t priced itself out of the local economy. You can buy a bouquet of cut flowers for \$10 and a meal for \$20.

The clientele is a mix of locals, weekenders with homes along Buzzards Bay, and tourists. On a recent Friday, around lunchtime, the dirt parking lot was full. Shattuck was inside by the register as a white-haired man, sandwich in hand, breezed past.

“Hey, Dad,” Shattuck said.

The man was his father, Bill Shattuck, a landscape painter who has a studio nearby.

The son eyed the sandwich. “Did you pay for that?”

The father told him to put it on his tab.

During the pandemic, Ben



JILLIAN FREYER/NEW YORK TIMES

Shattuck and Slate stayed at the rural Shattuck family home. One day, he was lamenting the lack of public gathering spaces in a conversation with Jim Chouinard and Kim Arruda, a husband-and-wife team who were the owners of Davoll’s at the time. They suggested he make them an offer. (Shattuck declined to say how much he paid for the store.)

Chouinard and Arruda had already done much to bring the place into the 21st century, including the addition of the cafe. Shattuck kept the restaurant and obtained a liquor license. He expanded the modest selection of local history books to create a bookstore at the center of Davoll’s. He brought in his brother, Will, who lives in Oregon and works in the coffee business, as a partner.

To manage the store, Ben Shattuck hired Mary Ann Buckley, who was born and raised in the area and had previously managed an organic market and cafe.

“You have some high, some low,” Buckley said of the mix of products. She showed off one of her favorite items, a reusable Euroscrubby kitchen pad for \$3.99. “There’s a thrill for me in anticipating what people will need before they need it.”

Shattuck’s role has lessened over time as Buckley has taken on more duties. But he sometimes finds himself in the thick of it. “I have to meet a man to talk about

walk-in fridges at 1,” he said. “I know absolutely nothing about that.”

Open six days a week, even in the emptiness of winter, Davoll’s hosts a monthly book club and invites prominent authors like Nathaniel Philbrick to give readings. It also sponsors a knitting circle, Irish music session, and Burns Night, a yearly celebration of Scottish poet Robert Burns.

“I wanted it to feel like a place where you can loiter and linger and run into people,” Shattuck said.

It’s a sharp contrast to the Davoll’s of yesteryear, when it was under the proprietorship of a series of frugal, taciturn Yankees. Local lore is filled with tales of Wilfrid and Virginia Morrison, who ran Davoll’s from the 1950s through the mid-’70s. Wilfrid, it is said, once charged a man whose car had broken down 10 cents to use the phone. When the stranded driver said he didn’t have change, Wilfrid opened up a charge account for him.

Under the Glennons, the store sold ceramic Christmas villages year-round and bologna sandwiches on Wonder Bread. “A lot of times, you’d ask for something and they’d say, ‘I’m pretty sure we don’t have it,’” said Deborah Kovacs, a writer who has lived in South Dartmouth since 1985. “Then they’d go check and come back and say, ‘Yep. We don’t have it.’”

Ben Shattuck, the 13th proprietor of Davoll’s General Store since it opened more than 200 years ago, keeps in mind that it shouldn’t appeal more to the Instagram crowd than to the longtime regulars.

‘Davoll’s was always the center of attention.’

JANE TUCKERMAN, who grew up in South Dartmouth

It's September, and Fenway rocks again



Mickey Gasper started September with a bang at Fenway Park by cracking a first-inning solo homer, but the Red Sox went on to lose to the Mariners.

DAN SHAUGHNESSY



Days of miracle and wonder.

Imagine what this must be like for incoming college freshmen on Park Drive, Bay State Road, and Commonwealth Avenue. It's your first night in Boston and the evening's periodically interrupted by joyous noise and pulsating lights from inside the ancient, hardball theater across the street from the Cask 'n Flagon.

The Red Sox did it again Monday at Fenway Park. Winning a game that featured three lead changes and runs scored in every inning except the fourth, they rebounded from a three-

run deficit in the eighth and bested the Mariners, 9-8, in the 10th when Trevor Story — playing his first Fenway game since May 14 — cracked a gapper to left-center with the bases loaded and one out.

"I've been watching the boys do it all year," Story said. "It inspires me. These guys have done some great work. It's what this team has been doing all year and I'm proud to be part of it."

"That's a big moment and a huge win," said (still interim) Sox manager Chad Tracy. "There were countless moments you could point to where the game flipped."

"Best fans in the world," said 22-year-old Roman Anthony, who had four hits in his first two games after a frustrating three months on the shelf with a mysterious hand injury.

It's finally September and after an awful first half (32-46) and a historic midsummer (43-18), the Red Sox are almost exactly where they were at this time last year, apparently bound for the same postseason matchup — a best-of-three joust vs. the Yankees, with the entire series being played at Yankee Stadium.

Boston's four-game Bronx weekend was disappointing, with the Sox dropping three of the four by an aggregate 26-9. The super-hyped end-of-summer series pushed the Yanks to a season-high 19 games over .500 and may have snuffed out the Sox' last chance to overtake their hated rivals. New York has a terrific bullpen, and its offense will only get better when Aaron Judge returns.

When the final story of this wonder-

SHAUGHNESSY, Page C2

Paez's debut starts poorly, Red Sox lose

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

Mariners 9 In the leadup to a 9-6 loss to the visiting Mariners on Tuesday night, the Red Sox made a calculated risk: Allow Sonny Gray to rest, and accept whatever happens in the game that would have belonged to him.

It's the final four weeks of the regular season. Their place in the postseason seems secure, if not guaranteed. So the Red Sox are zooming out. With a torrid summer, they have earned the luxury to think bigger.

Giving Gray four extra days off before a busy month, maybe two, was more valuable than this one game, win or lose, in the view of the Red Sox, so they made their decision, felt comfortable in it, and picked among their inexperienced alternatives to fill in.

His name was Jedixson Paez. He is a 22-year-old Venezuelan righthander who signed with the team in 2021. And he was pummeled by Seattle for eight runs and 10 hits in 3⅓ innings at Fenway Park in the Red Sox' most uncompetitive start in about three months. Paez

RED SOX, Page C2

►Sox place reliever Guerrero (shoulder) on injured list. C2
►Kroenke to buy Angels. C3



Red Sox starter Jedixson Paez, who was called up Tuesday from Triple-A Worcester, surrendered the ball after giving up eight runs on 10 hits in 3⅓ innings.

Patriots run it back with dynamic duo

By Christopher Price
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — Ask Jeremy Springer what he looks for in a kickoff returner, and he has a quick answer.

"Guys have to make good decisions," said the Patriots' special teams coordinator. "They have to be able to run through smoke. They've got to be fearless."

Ask Kyle Williams and Efton Chism if they're up for another season of running through the smoke, and you'll get smiles.

"Honestly, I mean, I would love that," said Williams, who was third on the team last season with 11 kickoff returns for 290 yards, an average of 26.4 yards.

"I know for me, it's huge just to try to get on the field that way," said Chism, who led the team with 16 returns for 383 yards, an average of 23.9 yards.

►Henderson again absent from practice. Notes, C4
►Romo pleads no contest. C4

After a summer spent auditioning kickoff return candidates, the Patriots appear to have settled again on Williams and Chism to start the season.

Last year, Antonio Gibson proved effective early. In the first five games, he averaged 28.5 yards per return (and added a return for a touchdown in a road win over the Dolphins), good for a spot in the NFL's top 10 through the first month of the season.

But after Gibson went down with a season-ending knee injury last October and TreVeyon Henderson was asked to shift his focus to offense, Chism and Williams handled the job.

The Patriots ended the sea-

PATRIOTS, Page C4



Wide receivers Efton Chism (above) and Kyle Williams will likely handle kickoff return duties for the Patriots after combining last season to run back 27 of them for 673 yards.

BEN VOLIN
ON FOOTBALL

Don't count out Belichick at UNC

Bill Belichick hasn't made many friends in college football, and as he begins his second season at North Carolina, his critics are lining up to bury him.

Expectations for the Tar Heels couldn't be lower. Coming off a 4-8 debacle, the Tar Heels were predicted to finish 15th out of 17 teams in an Atlantic Coast Conference preseason media poll, and their over/under for wins is just 4.5.

Bruce Feldman of The Athletic recently called Belichick "a laughingstock of college football." ESPN's Paul Finebaum called out the "mass chaos" at UNC and said of Belichick, "He's a grouch. He's a bully. And his career in college is about to go down in flames."

Yet a funny thing happened on the way to the unemployment line — Belichick and the Tar Heels won their season opener Saturday in Dublin.

They pulled off a 15-10 win over TCU as 7.5-point underdogs — the same TCU team that crushed North Carolina, 48-14, in Belichick's first game last season.

"This is really a special trip for our team," Belichick said postgame. "I think we were inspired yesterday at the rally, when Chancellor Roberts said, 'We didn't come out here for the experience, we came out here to win,' and that's what the players did today."

Belichick, 74, still has plenty

ON FOOTBALL, Page C4

INSIDE Cruise control
Gracious Gauff takes care of business in opening-round match at US Open; Cobolli, Sakkari shake off deficits. **C5**

Global power
With a team littered with WNBA stars, Team USA will be looking to win its fifth straight FIBA World Cup. **C5**

Top priority
For high school field hockey teams coming off championship seasons, repeating begins with reloading their rosters. **C5**

Baseball

Guerrero goes on IL for some relief

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

Transitioning to playoff preparation mode, the Red Sox put reliever **Tyron Guerrero** on the injured list Tuesday because of right shoulder inflammation, hopeful that a respite will position him well for late September and beyond.

Interim manager **Chad Tracy** characterized Guerrero's issue as "fatigue," less an acute injury and more a product of overuse. The righthander's shoulder strength is down and "it's been on and off for a bit now," per Tracy, and the Sox could avoid using him only so often. Guerrero is not due to get an MRI.

At the outset, this is similar to the calls made by the team on fellow righty relievers **Garrett Whitlock** (who returned quickly as expected after resting his elbow) and **Justin Slaten** (whose elbow recovery has dragged a tad). The-matically similar are decisions to skip **Sonny Gray's** start and put first baseman **Willson Contreras** on the IL to let his troublesome left hamstring heal.

Tracy said he is "very hopeful" that Guerrero will return when eligible, which is Sept. 16.

"It's a lingering issue that we've been able to manage," Tracy said. "We're at a spot now where it's like, hey, if we need a break, let's do it because we can't afford to go four days right now without somebody, and he needs a breather."

Guerrero (3.26 ERA) endured his second meltdown in a month Monday, giving up three runs and three hits in one-third of an inning against the Mariners.

On Aug. 12, with his velocity similarly down a tick, Guerrero allowed four runs and recorded no outs against the Blue Jays. The Sox didn't pitch him for the next six days.

To fill Guerrero's roster spot, the Red Sox brought back righthander **Wyatt Olds** from Triple-A Worcester. He had a 0.00 ERA in six appearances in his first go-around in the majors, before being sent down Saturday. He was called on in the fourth inning of a 9-6 loss to the Mariners at Fenway Park and allowed a run in 2½ innings.

Rutschman's elbow aches

Adley Rutschman was out of the lineup for a second day in a row — and a fifth time in eight games — because of a sore right elbow.

Tracy said the Red Sox probably will have to manage that issue for the rest of



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Left fielder **Jarren Duran** (and the scoreboard guy) can only watch as the Mariners put up a five-spot in the second.

the season. The catcher hyperextended the elbow on a swing Aug. 24 in Miami.

"I wouldn't say it's alarming," Tracy said. "If we just give it a couple days here, we can calm it down, then you might be able to go for a few days. But also in that rest period, you might be able to get it past it. So that's what we're in the process of trying to do."

When Rutschman got an MRI, "there was nothing on there that we didn't expect to see," Tracy said. "We just have to watch."

Kiner-Falefa returns to mix

The Red Sox activated infielder **Isiah Kiner-Falefa** from the injured list. He had been out since mid-June because of a stress reaction in his left forearm.

With **Trevor Story**, **Nick Sogard**, and **Andruw Monasterio** handling middle-infield duties, Kiner-Falefa figures his job will be "pinch defense," entering late in a game as a closer of sorts.

"Whatever the team needs me to do, I'm happy to do that," he said. "I feel like the defense is elite, so you [have to] use it. I feel like you can use it more when it's up the middle or whatnot [as op-

AL wild card

	W	L	Pct.	GB
*New York.....	78	60	.565	—
Boston.....	75	64	.540	—
Cleveland.....	70	68	.507	—
Texas.....	69	70	.496	1½
Baltimore.....	69	70	.496	1½
Toronto.....	68	71	.489	2½
Minnesota.....	67	72	.482	3½
Seattle.....	65	74	.468	5½
Detroit.....	63	75	.457	7
Kansas City.....	62	77	.446	8½
*Los Angeles.....	53	85	.384	17
Athletics.....	53	86	.381	17½

* — Not including late game

posed to at first base, where others have more experience]."

Tracy said he could, for example, sub Kiner-Falefa in at second base and slide Sogard to first (for **Mickey Gasper**) to upgrade defensively at both spots.

Kiner-Falefa finished the loss at second base and was 0 for 2.

Paez gets spot start

The Sox also called up righthander **Jedixson Paez** from Worcester. He started against Seattle in his Red Sox debut

(fourth major league game overall). It didn't go well, with the Mariners battering him 10 hits (and two homers) and eight runs in 3½ innings . . . Since Sept. 1 marked the annual expansion of active rosters from 26 to 28 players, the team did not need to clear space. To open spots on the 40-man roster, they put lefthander **Eduardo Rivera** on the 60-day IL (lumbar strain) and designated infielder **Brett Harris** for assignment . . . **Roman Anthony** (2 for 5) played right field — his first time on defense in three games since returning from the IL — with **Wilyer Abreu** (2 for 5) getting the DH day. Tracy said he made the decision because Anthony "is very fresh right now and I've got a right fielder that's not." . . . The game was delayed for approximately 10 minutes before the bottom of the sixth inning because of an umpire injury delay. Plate umpire **Will Little** exited after taking a foul ball to the head/neck area, and second base ump **Ryan Wills** replaced him.

Tim Healey can be reached at timothy.healey@globe.com. Follow him @timbhealey.

Red Sox lose after Paez's debut starts poorly, ends early

► **RED SOX**
Continued from Page C1

walked two and struck out three.

The Sox (75-64) have dropped five of their past seven games. They remain in possession of the second American League wild card, 3½ games behind the top wild card Yankees and 4½ games ahead of the third wild card Guardians.

Gray, who admitted this week to needing "a couple days" because of "general body fatigue," said he is slated to pitch Saturday against in Baltimore.

"I wouldn't call it prioritizing rest. I think it was necessary," interim manager Chad Tracy said.

"It felt like it was necessary for [Gray] to get some rest, for him physically to stay on line. It's not something we just walked into intentionally. It was necessary, and if that has him in a really good spot on the backside of this, then that's good."

For the Mariners (65-74), righthander Bryan Woo held the Red Sox to two runs and five hits in six innings. He struck out seven and walked one.

Eli White's two-run double in the seventh inning and Jahmai Jones's pinch-hit two-run homer in the ninth made it close, forcing Seattle closer Andres Munoz into the game — a minor victory for the Sox. Munoz recorded the final two outs without issue.

"I know we lost there, but you're looking at getting their closer in back-to-back days," Jones said. "It becomes a question mark for [Wednesday]. So, all in all, as an offense, we did what we could to try to give us the best chance for success [Wednesday]."

Paez's path to his Red Sox debut — not his major league debut — was wind-ing.

After he spent parts of five seasons in the farm system, the White Sox plucked Paez in the Rule 5 draft last December, even though he hadn't pitched above High-A.

He went to spring training, made Chicago's Opening Day roster, appeared in three games in March as a reliever, then was cut and given back to the Red Sox.

Paez spent most of this year with Double-A Portland (4.41 ERA in 17 games) and was recently promoted to Triple-A Worcester (2.92 ERA in three games). Across the two levels, he had 74 strikeouts and just seven walks in 61½ innings, which is part of why the Red Sox selected him for this assignment.

"He's a supreme strike-thrower," Tracy said before the game.

The gory details of Paez's mess: Dominic Canzone tagged him for a home run in the first inning, which hurt less when Mickey Gasper got the



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Trevor Story hustled down the line to beat the throw to **Seattle's Josh Naylor** for an infield single in the eighth, his second hit of the night.

run back with a solo shot of his own in the bottom half. It was Gasper's seventh longball in 13 games.

In the second, the game got away from Paez. Randy Arozarena's three-

run home run — off the advertising along the back of the Green Monster — was the climax of a five-run rally.

The third inning similarly devolved into a 30-pitch slog, but Paez managed

September rolls back around, and with it Fenway Park once again rocks

► **SHAUGHNESSY**
Continued from Page C1

ful, kooky season is told, the record will show that the Sox trailed the Yankees by 15½ games on June 24, pulled to within a half-game on Aug. 7, but never vaulted ahead. The Sox lost two of three in the Bronx last October and seem securely locked into going there again Sept. 29 through Oct. 1 for the first round of these playoffs.

They have played postseason games at Fenway only once in the last seven seasons. It would be a shame if they don't get to next month, as so many of their July-August games were five-star, theatrical masterpieces.

Evidently resigned and content with their probable position in the 2026 postseason tournament, the Sox on

Tuesday elected to tank Game 2 of the Mariners series, rolling out rookie Jedixson Paez for his fourth big league game. The wide-eyed kid was predictably pummeled (8 runs, 10 hits, 2 homers, 3½ innings) in a 9-6 Boston loss. Twenty-three regular-season games remain.

Independent of Tuesday's debacle, the 2026 Sox have trademarked dramatic, preposterous comebacks with performances by a chorus line of over-achieving no-names. Everybody got in on the act Monday, but the comeback successes of Story and Anthony should not overshadow another homer by Mickey Gasper, more winning play from Nick Sogard, and two innings of clutch relief from a lefty named Alec Gamboa.

If you are old enough to remember the Cardiac Kids of 1967, you are telling the young'uns that this team reminds you of that team, with Cedanne Rafaela playing the role of Reggie Smith.

There is no comp from any old days that can match the Gasper story. A 30-year-old, 5-foot-9-inch son of Merrimack, N.H., a career minor leaguer who failed to get his first major league hit in 18 at-bats with the 2024 Red Sox, Gasper in the month of August batted .400 with six homers and an OPS of 1.671 — a number that puts him alongside the likes of Barry Bonds and Ted Williams in the best months in baseball history. He then started September with a homer in his first at-bat Tuesday.

Accordingly, there was some fan

outrage Sunday when Anthony Seigler and Gasper were sent back to Worcester to make room for rehabbed Story and Anthony. Seigler and (particularly) Gasper were the faces of Boston's surge, 4-A players dumped by other organizations, hanging on to the dream in Triple-A Worcester. Both overachieved wildly when the Sox surged, particularly Gasper. The notion that the big club could casually cast him aside rubbed some fans the wrong way.

When the Sox were annihilated by the Yankees, 16-1, in their first game after cutting Gasper, I immediately went to my home office and starting typing the first draft of "The Curse of Mickey Gasper."

Alas, the theme dissolved Monday afternoon when Gasper was recalled to

replace Sox slugger Willson Contreras, who is sidelined with a hamstring injury. And then Gasper homered into the Sox' bullpen in the first inning.

Of course.

It was only the beginning of a mad, magical night at Fenway — the 34th comeback win of this Sox season and their fifth walkoff.

Get used to it, you freshman first-timers in the Back Bay and beyond. This is Boston and it is September and the Red Sox and their fans are having a blast. Join the party. You'll remember it for the rest of your life.

Dan Shaughnessy is a Globe columnist. He can be reached at daniel.shaughnessy@globe.com. Follow him @dan_shaughnessy.

Baseball

AL

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Tampa Bay	83	55	.601	—	—	7-3	W 1
*New York	78	60	.565	5	—	5-5	L 1
Boston	75	64	.540	8½	—	5-5	L 1
Baltimore	69	70	.496	14½	1½	7-3	L 1
Toronto	68	71	.489	15½	2½	5-5	L 1
CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Chicago	73	65	.529	—	—	6-4	W 1
Cleveland	70	68	.507	3	—	8-2	W 2
Minnesota	67	72	.482	6½	3½	4-6	W 3
Detroit	63	75	.457	10	7	2-8	L 3
Kansas City	62	77	.446	11½	8½	7-3	L 2
WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Houston	70	69	.504	—	—	5-5	L 1
Texas	69	70	.496	1	1½	5-5	W 3
Seattle	65	74	.468	5	5½	4-6	W 1
*Los Angeles	53	85	.384	16½	17	2-8	W 1
Athletics	53	86	.381	17	17½	4-6	L 5

NL

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Atlanta	82	57	.590	—	—	7-3	L 2
*Philadelphia	78	60	.565	3½	—	8-2	W 5
Miami	70	69	.504	12	3	5-5	W 1
Washington	67	74	.475	16	7	6-4	W 2
New York	62	77	.446	20	11	4-6	L 1
CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
*Milwaukee	85	53	.616	—	—	6-4	L 2
*Chicago	78	60	.565	7	—	4-6	W 1
*St. Louis	68	70	.493	17	4½	3-7	L 2
Pittsburgh	68	71	.489	17½	5	5-5	W 3
Cincinnati	66	73	.475	19½	7	5-5	W 1
WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
*Los Angeles	82	55	.599	—	—	6-4	W 1
*Arizona	73	66	.525	10	—	5-5	L 2
San Diego	73	66	.525	10	—	4-6	L 1
San Francisco	57	82	.410	26	16	5-5	L 1
Colorado	53	86	.381	30	20	3-7	W 1

* — Not including late game

RESULTS

TUESDAY

Seattle 9	at Boston 6	At Texas 8	Athletics 5
At Tampa Bay 6	NY Mets 2	Chi. White Sox 5	at Houston 1
At Cincinnati 4	San Diego 3	At Colorado 4	Baltimore 2
At Pittsburgh 13	San Francisco 12	Milwaukee	at Chi. Cubs
At Cleveland 6	Toronto 1	NY Yankees	at LA Angels
At Washington 9	Atlanta 5	Philadelphia	at Arizona
At Minnesota 15	Detroit 2	St. Louis	at LA Dodgers
Miami 6	at Kansas City 3		

MONDAY

At Boston 9 (10 inn.)	Seattle 8	At Chi. Cubs 17	Milwaukee 3
San Francisco 7	at Atlanta 3	At Texas 8	Athletics 1
NY Mets 3	at Tampa Bay 2	At Houston 6	Chi. White Sox 3
San Diego 5	at Cincinnati 0	Baltimore 2	at Colorado 1
At Washington 6	Miami 3	At LA Angels 10	NY Yankees 1
At Minnesota 11	Detroit 1	Philadelphia 2	at Arizona 1



CHRIS O'MEARA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Ryan Vilade put the Rays in front for good in a 6-2 victory Tuesday against the visiting Mets with an RBI single in the third inning.

WEDNESDAY'S GAMES

	Odds	2026 W-L ERA	Team rec.	2026 vs. opp..... W-L IP ERA	Last 3 starts..... W-L IP ERA
SEATTLE AT BOSTON, 4:10 p.m.					
Miller (R)	+115	4-8 4.12	4-12	0-1 5.0 1.80	0-2 15.0 9.60
Sandoval (L)	-135	1-3 4.20	6-3	0-0 0.0 0.00	0-2 15.0 6.00
SAN DIEGO AT CINCINNATI, 12:40 p.m.					
Mize (R)	-140	5-8 3.45	8-13	0-0 0.0 0.00	1-1 13.2 3.95
Williamson (L)	+120	2-3 6.11	3-3	0-0 0.0 0.00	1-2 12.2 7.11
ATLANTA AT WASHINGTON, 1:05 p.m.					
Holmes (R)	-160	9-5 3.71	18-7	0-1 9.2 4.66	2-1 14.2 5.52
Kent (L)	+135	1-2 5.59	1-3	0-0 0.0 0.00	1-2 15.1 5.28
ATHLETICS AT TEXAS, 2:35 p.m.					
Lopez (L)	+140	5-4 4.82	8-11	0-0 12.0 3.75	0-0 17.0 2.12
Bradford (L)	-165	0-3 3.42	1-4	0-0 4.0 4.50	0-2 15.0 4.20
BALTIMORE AT COLORADO, 3:10 p.m.					
Rogers (L)	-160	9-9 4.38	13-12	0-0 0.0 0.00	2-1 18.0 5.50
Sugano (R)	+135	12-8 5.23	14-10	0-0 0.0 0.00	0-3 12.0 12.75
PHILADELPHIA AT ARIZONA, 3:40 p.m.					
Painter (R)	Off	3-8 5.95	7-11	0-0 5.0 1.80	1-0 18.0 4.50
Cabrera (R)	Off	0-3 5.32	0-5	0-0 0.0 0.00	0-2 12.0 6.75
NY METS AT TAMPA BAY, 6:40 p.m.					
Hagenman (R)	+140	— —	0-0	0-0 0.0 0.00	0-0 0.0 —
Jax (R)	-165	6-9 3.63	9-9	0-0 0.0 0.00	1-2 16.2 1.62
SAN FRANCISCO AT PITTSBURGH, 6:40 p.m.					
Roupp (R)	+130	8-13 4.25	8-18	0-1 4.0 2.25	1-2 16.0 4.50
Jones (R)	-150	2-6 4.83	6-10	0-0 0.0 0.00	0-2 13.2 3.95
TORONTO AT CLEVELAND, 6:40 p.m.					
Cease (R)	-130	9-5 2.33	17-9	0-0 0.0 0.00	2-0 19.0 1.89
Canitillo (L)	+110	9-7 3.70	18-10	0-1 5.0 1.80	1-0 16.2 2.16
DETROIT AT MINNESOTA, 7:40 p.m.					
Anderson (R)	-105	4-5 3.87	2-5	0-0 3.2 2.45	0-1 14.2 3.68
Kremer (R)	-115	2-5 5.60	4-8	0-1 4.0 18.00	0-1 14.2 6.75
MIAMI AT KANSAS CITY, 7:40 p.m.					
Pérez (R)	-110	7-10 3.44	11-13	0-0 0.0 0.00	1-1 14.0 3.86
Cameron (L)	-110	9-8 3.98	9-16	0-0 0.0 0.00	3-0 20.0 0.90
MILWAUKEE AT CHI. CUBS, 7:40 p.m.					
Misiorowski (R)	-160	14-5 1.73	17-8	2-0 12.0 0.75	3-0 18.0 1.50
Peterson (L)	+135	7-7 5.11	8-10	1-0 5.2 3.18	1-0 16.0 3.94
CHI. WHITE SOX AT HOUSTON, 8:10 p.m.					
TBA	+110	— —	0-0	0-0 0.0 0.00	0-0 0.0 —
Wesneski (R)	-130	4-1 3.86	5-1	0-0 0.0 0.00	2-1 14.0 3.86
NY YANKEES AT LA ANGELS, 9:38 p.m.					
Schlitter (R)	-165	12-6 2.09	17-11	0-0 0.0 0.00	2-0 17.0 1.06
Detmers (L)	+140	4-8 3.54	9-18	1-0 7.0 1.29	1-0 20.0 0.45
ST. LOUIS AT LA DODGERS, 10:10 p.m.					
TBA	+200	— —	0-0	0-0 0.0 0.00	0-0 0.0 —
Yamamoto (R)	-250	12-8 2.56	16-8	0-0 0.0 0.00	1-1 18.2 1.93
Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season					

Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season

NOTEBOOK

Kroenke to add Angels to empire

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Kroenke Sports and Entertainment has reached a deal to purchase controlling ownership of the Angels from **Arte Moreno**, expanding its sprawling empire of teams across every major US professional sport with the addition of the beleaguered baseball club.

The company led by **Stan Kroenke** made the surprising announcement Tuesday, saying it expects to close the transaction in early 2027. Major League Baseball, which must approve any sale, didn't immediately comment on the news, but The Athletic reported the deal is being done at a \$4 billion valuation — a record for an MLB team.

Kroenke Sports and Entertainment will be only the fourth permanent owner of the Angels, who were founded as an AL expansion club in 1961 by early Hollywood star **Gene Autry**. His widow, **Jackie**, temporarily owned the team for a year after his death before selling it to Disney in 1999.

Kroenke's company owns the NFL's Los Angeles Rams, Premier League champion Arsenal, the NBA's Denver Nuggets, the NHL's Colorado Avalanche, Major League Soccer's Colorado Rapids, and SoFi Stadium, along with the large Hollywood Park campus around the multibillion-dollar Inglewood arena.

Moreno, an outdoor advertising magnate from Arizona, bought the Angels from the Walt Disney Company in 2003. While the club had steady success in its first years under Moreno with much of the roster that won the 2002 World Series, winning five AL West titles in six seasons during the 2000s, the team entered a period of decline since its most recent playoff victory in 2009.

The AL-worst Angels are headed to their 11th consecutive losing season and their 12th consecutive non-playoff season, both the longest active streaks in the majors. Incredibly, they've made the playoffs just once during the 16-year career of three-time AL MVP outfielder **Mike Trout**, who teamed with two-time AL MVP **Shohei Ohtani** for six seasons with no success.

In sharp contrast, Kroenke's teams consistently have been among their sports' best in recent seasons. The Rams, the Avalanche, the Nuggets, and Arsenal have all won championships over the past five years.

A significant portion of the Angels' struggles can be attributed to the 80-year-old Moreno, who repeatedly inserted himself into personnel decisions.

While he spent aggressively on payroll in his attempts to build a winner, his biggest moves usually backfired, with a series of high-profile acquisitions who produced a fraction of their anticipated impact. His acquisitions of **Anthony Rendon**, **Gary Matthews Jr.**, **Josh Hamilton**, and many others were expensive disasters, while even his landmark \$240 million free agent contract for **Albert Pujols** didn't result in the homers or the victories expected from the price tag.

Williams whiffs Blue Jays

Gavin Williams struck out a career-high 13 and allowed just two singles in seven innings, leading the host Guardians to a 6-1 win over the Blue Jays in a matchup of teams in the thick of the AL wild-card race. **Patrick Bailey**, rookie **Angel Genao**, and **Angel Martinez** all hit two-run homers for the Guardians, who are 11-4 since Aug. 12 . . . **Freddy Peralta** pitched six terrific innings against his former team, **Junior Caminero** extended his hitting streak to 15 games with two singles, and **Yandy Diaz** homered and doubled as the host Rays beat the Mets, 6-2. Peralta (7-11), acquired from the Mets for three minor leaguers in an Aug. 2 trade, struggled at the start. He gave up **Francisco Lindor's** leadoff homer and consecutive singles to **Bo Bichette** and **Carson Benge**. But the righthander settled down and retired 17 of his final 18 batters.

Pirates outlast Giants

Brandon Lowe scored from third when San Francisco third baseman **Oswalds Basabe** short-hopped a throw to first baseman **Rafael Devers** with two outs in the ninth inning as the host Pirates beat the Giants, 13-12. Lowe's four-hit night included his 29th home run. **Oneil Cruz** had four hits and drove in four runs for Pittsburgh, which recovered after blowing a six-run lead. The Pirates, who scored nine runs in the third, have won five of seven despite allowing the Giants to rally to tie it at 12 thanks to a five-run eighth . . . **Royce Lewis** and **Ryan Jeffers** hit three-run homers during a 10-run sixth inning for the host Twins to highlight a 15-2 victory over the skidding Tigers.

NATIONALS 9, BRAVES 5

ATLANTA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Baldwin c	4	0	1	1	0	1	.279
Acuña Jr. rf	4	1	0	0	0	2	.238
Olson 1b	4	1	1	0	0	1	.256
Harris lf cf	4	1	2	1	1	2	.296
Dubón 2b	4	0	0	0	0	2	.266
Albies dh	4	1	1	1	0	0	.254
Riley 3b	4	0	0	0	0	2	.220
Hicklen lf	3	1	1	0	1	2	.364
Kim ss	3	1	0	3	0	0	.112
Totals	34	5	8	4	1	10	

WASHINGTON	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Abrams ss	4	1	2	2	1	1	.269
Crews rf	4	1	0	0	1	2	.218
House 3b	3	0	1	3	1	1	.242
Lile lf	3	1	0	0	2	2	.255
Morales dh	5	2	3	1	0	2	.600
Ortiz 1b	3	0	0	0	0	1	.211
Chaparro ph-1b	4	0	0	1	1	1	.250
Ford c	4	1	2	0	1	1	.205
Vivas 2b	3	1	1	0	1	0	.242
Núñez pr-2b	1	0	1	0	0	0	.216
JacobyYoung cf	4	1	2	1	0	1	.249
Totals	35	9	12	8	7	12	

Atlanta.....011 000 030 — 5 8 1
Washington.....041 001 21x — 9 12 0

E—Suter (1). LOB—Atlanta 3, Washington 10. 2B—Baldwin (15), Olson (33), House (13), Morales (1), Vivas (12). HR—Harris II (24), off Beeter, Albies (21), off Irvin, Morales (1), off Smith-Shawver. SB—Abrams (27), Lile (14), Ford (2). SF—House. DP—Washington 1.

Atlanta	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Smith-Shawver L 0-1	4	6	5	5	3	5	7.13
Mederos	1	1	0	0	1	1	2.93
Burkhalter	1	1	1	1	1	1	9.00
Suter	2	4	3	2	2	5	2.20

Washington	IP	H	R</
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CBS's Romo enters no-contest plea

CBS NFL analyst and former Cowboys quarterback **Tony Romo** pleaded no contest to a charge of operating while intoxicated and issued a statement apologizing for the actions that led to his July arrest.

Romo was arrested July 23 following a traffic stop as he was driving south on Interstate 43 in Wisconsin. CBS has since placed him on leave from his role as its lead NFL analyst.

According to Milwaukee County court records, Romo lost his driving privileges for six months and was ordered to complete an alcohol assessment program.

Romo also owes \$834. An interlock device must be installed on any vehicle owned or operated by Romo or registered to his name, and that order will remain in effect for at least one year after he is issued a license.

“The past month has been difficult, but it has also been personally significant,” Romo said in a statement on Instagram. “It has required me to confront and own my mistakes fully — to the Lord, to myself, to my family and now to the public.”

Romo said the multiple back surgeries that led to his retirement as a player “left me with constant, debilitating pain.” He noted that the pain “led to a dependence on pain medication, and my efforts to get off those medications led to an over-reliance on alcohol.”

“None of this is an excuse,” Romo said. “These are my failures and I take responsibility for them.”

Romo said he is working with a



MORRY GASH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Tony Romo (left) will not be in the booth with CBS broadcast partner Jim Nantz when the Vikings host the Packers on Sept. 13.

team of doctors to address his health and “make the necessary changes.” He thanked his family, friends and the NFL community for their support.

“As I turn my attention to my health, my family, and, in time, my return to CBS, I kindly ask for privacy during this period,” Romo said.

CBS Sports president **David Beron** said last month that he does not have a timeline for a decision about Romo's future with the network.

Romo, 46, has been the lead game analyst for CBS's NFL coverage since 2017 after making four Pro Bowl appearances during a playing career that ran from 2004-16 and was spent entirely with Dallas.

Analyst **JJ Watt** will join play-by-play announcer **Jim Nantz** and sideline reporter **Tracy Wolfson** on CBS Sports' lead NFL team during Romo's absence. Their first game will

be on Sept. 13, when the Vikings host the Packers.

Porter's status unclear

Joey Porter Jr.'s balky back felt good enough to return to practice for the Steelers.

At the moment, his health appears to be the least of his concerns.

The fourth-year cornerback didn't commit to playing in the Steelers' season opener against the Falcons Sept. 13 if he and the team can't come to terms on a new contract.

“I don't know,” Porter said. “I've got to talk to [the front office] and my agents about that one.”

Porter, 26, is entering the first season of the rookie contract he signed after being selected with the first pick of the second round in 2023. He said during minicamp in June that he believes he's one of the best defensive backs in the league

and is confident that he'll be compensated that way.

Three months later, Porter has yet to put pen to paper.

While general manager **Omar Khan** said Monday he wants Porter — the son of former Steelers line-backer and coach **Joey Porter Sr.** — to be in Pittsburgh for the entirety of his career, it doesn't feel as if the sides are particularly close.

Colts hope WRs can play

The Colts expect receiver **Keenan Allen** to play in the season opener despite his recent arrest. They also remain hopeful injured receiver **Alec Pierce** also plays against the Ravens on Sept. 13. Allen was arrested early Sunday morning on drunken driving charges, and general manager **Chris Ballard** told reporters Tuesday the team dealt with the incident internally. He did not say specifically what punishment, if any, had been applied. Allen has not spoken publicly since he was released from custody Sunday afternoon. The arrest could lead to a league-imposed suspension though this is the first time in Allen's 14-year pro career he's been cited in a legal matter. Pierce worked out with the team Tuesday after being activated from the physically unable to perform list . . . Packers running back **Josh Jacobs** still has the support of coach **Matt LaFleur** and general manager **Brian Gutekunst**, who remain optimistic the three-time Pro Bowler will come off the commissioner's exempt list and play this season. Jacobs was placed on the exempt list after being charged with two misdemeanors in a domestic violence case.



ANDY LYONS/GETTY IMAGES

Jackson Koivun, a professional golfer for only three months, was named to the US roster for this month's Presidents Cup.

SportsLog

Woods expected to change his not-guilty plea

Court documents showed Tuesday that **Tiger Woods** plans to change his not guilty plea in a DUI case stemming from a rollover crash in Florida. In March, Woods's Land Rover clipped a truck and rolled onto its side, after which the golfer was arrested on suspicion of driving under the influence, officials said. Woods had pleaded not guilty to driving under the influence in the case in Martin County circuit court, just north of Palm Beach County. He is expected in court Wednesday morning for a plea conference hearing, according to a notice of the hearing posted Tuesday. No additional details about the nature of the plea change were released. Woods was traveling at high speeds on a beachside residential road on Jupiter Island with a speed limit of 30 miles per hour when his Land Rover caused \$5,000 in damage to the truck, according to an incident report. He managed to crawl out of the vehicle without any injuries and told a deputy that he was looking down at his phone and changing the radio station when he hit the truck. Woods agreed to a Breathalyzer test that showed no signs of alcohol, but refused a urine test, authorities said. A sheriff's office report said deputies found two pain pills in his pocket, and he showed signs of impairment. The crash was his fourth since 2009.

Koivun in Presidents Cup

Jackson Koivun, 21, was added to the US team for the Presidents Cup just three months after leaving Auburn, one of two newcomers to an American team that hasn't lost in 28 years. Koivun, who won the 3M Open in his third start as a professional and qualified for the PGA Tour postseason in just five tournaments, is the first player since **Jordan Spieth** in 2013 to start a year without a tour card and play in the Presidents Cup. US captain **Brandt Snedeker** also took **Jacob Bridgeman**, who won at Riviera this year. Snedeker passed over **Ryan Gerard**, the No. 22 player in the world who finished third at the Tour Championship. **Chris Gotterup**, **Xander Schauffele**, **Justin Thomas**, and **Patrick Cantlay** were also captain's picks. International captain **Geoff Ogilvy** picked a pair of Canadians in **Corey Connors** and **Nick Taylor**. He also took **Ryo Hisatsune**. It will be the first time since 1998 the International team has two Japanese players, with **Hideki Matsuyama** earning one of the six automatic spots. Ogilvy also chose **Nico Echavarria**, **Sungjae Im**, and **Christiaan Bezuidenhout**. The Presidents Cup is Sept. 24-27 at Medinah . . . The USGA announced Sankaty Head Golf Club on Nantucket will host the 2036 US Women's Mid-Amateur.

SOCCER

Revolution add Gazdag

The Revolution made their signing of veteran MLS midfielder **Dániel Gazdag** official, likely capping an active transfer window for new general manager **Chris Tierney** by adding a long-time nemesis to their attack. Gazdag, 30, is signed through December 2027, with additional club options for the latter half of the 2027-28 and the full 2028-29 MLS seasons. The Columbus Crew bought out his contract Friday. Gazdag played 43 games for the Crew in the last two seasons, with seven goals and five assists. The Hungarian had 59 goals in MLS play and 72 overall in 161 games over four-plus seasons for Philadelphia, the leading scorer in franchise history. His 22 goals in 2022 landed him on the MLS's Best XI team and began a run of three straight seasons reaching double digits. In 12 career matches against the Revolution, Gazdag has seven goals.

JON COUTURE

MISCELLANY

Devils trade for Evangelista

The Devils acquired **Luke Evangelista** in a trade with the Predators. New Jersey sent a conditional first-round pick and its own second-rounder in 2028 to Nashville for the 24-year-old forward, who is coming off setting career highs with 44 assists and 56 points last season. He has one more year on his contract at a salary-cap hit of \$3 million . . . Former Celtic center **Tacko Fall** received an invitation to training camp from the 76ers.

Henderson is again not on the practice field

By Christopher Price
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — Patriots running back **TreVeyon Henderson** was the most notable name not spotted at the start of Tuesday's practice.

Henderson, who was in the locker room chatting with reporters before the workout, has not been seen on the field since he took a spill during practice last week.

A league source indicated Henderson was dealing with a minor lower-right ankle issue, and the fact that he was out Tuesday was “likely a

precautionary measure.”

Tight end **Cameron Latu** was also not seen during the window when media was allowed to view practice. Latu, who as claimed on waivers by the Patriots after being let go by the Eagles, has a relationship with coach **Mike Vrabel** that dates back a couple of seasons.

“I was with Cam during my time in Cleveland, and really enjoyed getting to know him, being able to work with him and trying to help him,” Vrabel said. “We had some conversations about him last year, and he went on to do some really good things to help Philadelphia. Then we

just thought it would be a good opportunity to add somebody that has excelled at special teams and also looking to earn a role at tight end.”

Cornerback **Christian Gonzalez**, currently in contract discussions with the Patriots, was among those present.

Roster additions

The Patriots filled their remaining roster spots by re-signing center **Ben Brown** and rookie linebacker **Erick Hunter** to the 53-man roster. In addition, the Patriots signed linebacker **K.J. Britt**, defensive tackle

Jalen Hunt, offensive lineman **Jake Kubas**, and linebacker **Jose Ramirez** to the practice squad.

Captains named

The Patriots announced that safety **Kevin Byard**, tight end **Hunter Henry**, cornerback **Marcus Jones**, quarterback **Drake Maye**, offensive tackle **Morgan Moses**, and linebacker **Robert Spillane** were named captains following a player vote.

Christopher Price can be reached at christopher.price@globe.com. Follow him on Bluesky at christopherprice.bsky.social.

Patriots to run it back with Chism, Williams

►PATRIOTS
Continued from Page C1

son with a respectable 25.5 yards per return, good for the middle of the pack, but Chism and Williams lacked that extra gear that Gibson seemed to possess.

Now, after one of the most underwhelming position battles of camp — one in which no fewer than 10 players took reps at the position during practices and in preseason games — it appears Williams and Chism are poised to run it back this season.

“We need depth. That's why you've seen a lot of guys back here because the average team went through about five or six guys last year,” Springer said. “So we're just trying to build depth, because as the season progresses, injuries do happen or guys move on the depth chart. That

will affect us in the long run.”

Both Chism and Williams were coy about whether they'll be handling the job in next week's season opener, but on Tuesday, both sounded excited.

“We'll see in a couple days kind of what the vibes are,” said Chism.

“That's all up to the coaches. You know what I'm saying? That's their decision,” Williams said. “If it's me, then I'm ready to roll. And if it's not, I'm saying next man up, and we've just got to go play ball.”

Between the rule changes and the unforgiving nature of the job, it's not an easy gig.

“You catch the ball 30 yards behind everybody, and the holes that you see on TV or that you see in the film room, they shrink up and it closes a lot faster than what people

think,” said Williams. “So, what you think is there is not really there.”

“The biggest difference between at least college and NFL is all the different rules,” Chism said. “If it lands inside the landing zone or outside, what you need to be aware of. And the rapid-fire decision-making process. Those are things that you have to spend time learning, especially when it comes to making those split-second decisions.”

One thing the Chism/Williams duo does have in its favor is a good working relationship. The pair, who are neighbors in the locker room, spent a sizable portion of the 2025 season working together and building chemistry. Chism notes that when there's a good connection between two returners, it's a little like being an outfielder.

Belichick's UNC critics prematurely counted him out

►ON FOOTBALL
Continued from Page C1

to prove, and it won't be easy with a roster sporting 60 new players from last year, including 40 freshmen. But his critics might want to take a little pause and let the season play out.

Because if there's one thing Belichick proved in 24 years coaching the Patriots, he has a history of solving problems and figuring things out.

“He's coached a lot of football games. He's pretty much always dead on,” UNC quarterback Billy Edwards Jr. said Saturday. “Pretty much everything he challenged us with, I think we did a great job responding to it.”

The hallmark of Belichick's Patriots teams was that they always got better. Four of their Super Bowl rings came in seasons in which they started 2-2 (2001, 2003, 2014, and 2018) or worse. Belichick's winning percentage by month with the Patriots: .633 in September, .713 in October, .689 in November, and .701 in December/January. Belichick helped popularize the saying that the first four games of the regular season are just an extension of the preseason.

“I think once you get to the fifth,

six, seventh game of the year, October, then you kind of hit your stride a little bit,” he said Saturday after the win.

No question, Belichick's first season in college football was a disaster. His critics laughed at the arrogance of Belichick promoting North Carolina as “The 33rd NFL team,” as the Tar Heels suffered four losses by 20-plus points, had bad losses to rivals Duke and N.C. State, and didn't have a single player drafted. The program generated mostly negative headlines, centered around Belichick's young girlfriend and ongoing feud with the Patriots, and if he didn't have two years and \$20 million fully guaranteed left on his contract (through the 2027 season), he probably wouldn't have made it to this season.

But the TCU win is intriguing. Maybe Belichick isn't washed up. Maybe he actually has a better grasp of the schemes, personnel, and recruiting in his second year of college football.

Trent Dilfer learned not to bury Belichick back in 2014. His comments following the Patriots' Week 4 blowout loss to the Chiefs rocketed around the world — “We saw a weak

team. The New England Patriots, let's face it, they're not good anymore. They're weak.”

Belichick responded days later with his notorious “On to Cincinnati” news conference, which led to a 43-17 win over the Bengals, and eventually, a Super Bowl ring.

“What I forgot, and what others forgot, is that this is a developmental league,” Dilfer said a few years later. “And early in the season, there's so much hype in the offseason on who's going to be good, who the stars are, what teams are going to do, that early in the year, you knee-jerk react when you don't see it come to fruition.”

The dysfunction that marked Belichick's first year at North Carolina hasn't subsided. The Tar Heels opened the season with Belichick's right-hand man, Michael Lombardi, suspended with pay over an unknown workplace investigation, and Belichick's son Steve has been away from the team for a month with an unexplained medical leave.

Yet with Belichick calling defensive plays, the Tar Heels held TCU to 10 points and 281 yards, and did just enough on offense on a rainy day to

US readies World Cup title defense

WNBA stars line up for international play

By Julian Benbow
GLOBE STAFF

Few national teams in any sport have matched the sustained championship success of the US women’s basketball team.

Across the past 15 Olympics and FIBA World Cups, the Americans have won 14 gold medals — eight consecutive Olympic titles and six in the past seven World Cups.

When the US women open this year’s World Cup on Friday in Berlin against China, they will begin their pursuit of a fifth consecutive World Cup championship. In the tournament’s 73-year history, only the Soviet Union, which won five straight titles from 1959 through 1975, has put together a longer gold-medal run.

Even after WNBA stars A’ja Wilson and Kelsey Plum withdrew Monday for health reasons, the United States remains the heavy favorite. Sonia Citron and Kiki Iriafen replaced Wilson and Plum on a roster led by Breanna Stewart, Napheesa Collier, and Chelsea Gray.

US coach Kara Lawson said the sport’s rapid international growth could make this tournament especially challenging.

“There’s no question that the world is improving at a rapid rate,” Lawson said. “It’s so exciting to see, and I see it at every level. You can see how good everybody is getting. So I think that’s an obvious statement, that the world is improving and has continued to improve.

“There’s more depth to the teams at the World Cup now. When you look at rosters, there’s a number of high-quality players. I think the depth of these rosters is really strong. I think it’s going to be the most difficult World Cup to win because of that, which is exciting. You

should want it to be difficult. It should be hard to win a World Cup.”

The US women have not lost a World Cup game since 2006, when Russia, led by guard Oxana Rakhmatulina’s 18 points, stunned the Americans, 75–68, in the semifinals. Since then, the Americans have won 30 consecutive World Cup games — and most have not been close.

In 2022, the United States pummeled South Korea, 145–69, in group play. The 76-point margin made its 22-point victory over China in the final look almost modest by comparison.

Since the 2006 loss, the United States has beaten its World Cup opponents by an average of 32.1 points.

The Americans have won 23 consecutive World Cup games by double digits. The last opponent to come within 10 points was Australia in a 83–75 game in 2010.

Even with stakes at the highest, the United States has made winning look easy. It has won the past four World Cup finals by an average of 18 points.

On top of that, there hasn’t been a consistent rival.

The Americans faced four different opponents in the past four finals: the Czech Republic in 2010, Spain in ’14, Australia in ’18, and China in ’22.

China reached that final with centers Han Xu and Li Yueru serving as two of its anchors. Both are in China’s extended squad this year, but earning another opportunity against the United States will not be easy.

France’s roster features substantial WNBA experience, including Storm center Dominique Malonga, Sun guard Leïla Lacan, and Valkyries forward Gabby Williams.

Australia, which finished third in 2022, also has a deep pool of WNBA talent, including another Storm center, Ezi Magbegor, and Wings forward Alanna Smith.

More than 50 active WNBA players are expected to compete for 15 of the tournament’s 16 national teams. Although the United States will feature the bulk of the league’s talent, other international players will play prominent roles.

Sun wing Kennedy Burke will play for Turkey. Former Sun center Brionna Jones, now with the Dream, will represent Puerto Rico. Fire guard Carla Leite will play for France, along with Valkyries sharpshooter Janelle Salaün. Forwards Nyara Sabally and Leonie Fiebich will play for host Germany.

For the second consecutive World Cup, at least half of the US roster will be playing in the tournament for the first time. Iriafen, Citron, Aliyah Boston, Paige Bueckers, Caitlin Clark, Rhyne Howard, and Angel Reese are among the players who will make their World Cup debuts.

Lawson’s message was simple. “Be yourself,” Lawson said. “Your play and your confidence is what brought you here. So the expectation is that you’re going to compete and impact the game for us like you do for your team.”

Although Collier and Jackie Young each have two Olympic gold medals — one of Young’s came in 3x3 competition — this will be the first World Cup for both.

“Only three of our players have ever played in a World Cup before,” Lawson said. “So there’s a lot of newness to our roster, a lot of people experiencing this for the first time.”

The experience level — and the competition level — might be different, but the expectation will be the same.

“Every team’s job is to try and win this,” Lawson said. “So we’re hungry and we’re focused on trying to put our best performances on display and see if we can get the job done.”

Julian Benbow can be reached at julian.benbow@globe.com.



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

After watching and learning , new senior captain **Caroline Handwerk** is ready to lead the mighty Walpole field hockey team this season.

HIGH SCHOOL FIELD HOCKEY NOTEBOOK

Defending champions try to reload on the fly

By Inaaya Omer
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The past three years, **Caroline Handwerk** observed and soaked it all in, as one captain after another set the pace for Walpole field hockey, now the three-time defending Division 1 champions.

Now, as a senior captain, she is embracing the responsibility of seizing a leading role and the challenges ahead.

“We lost 20 seniors, which is a huge class,” she said. “They led us to this championship along with everyone else’s help . . . The pressure’s on, but we have to realize that we’re losing so many people. We can’t be too hard on ourselves, we need to keep steady.”

As Walpole coach **Jen Quinn** emphasized, despite the departing talent and experience, “rebuilding, that’s never a thing for us . . . we’re just reloading.

“The end goal isn’t any different. We’re still trying to be the best out there, and we’re going to work and do what we need to do to get there.”

The challenge for Walpole is to maintain its high standard, while replacing nearly its entire starting lineup.

That pressure is shared by all the defending champions, including Somerset Berkley (Division 2), Uxbridge (D3), and Dennis-Yarmouth (D4).

Quinn will lean on her three captains, Handwerk, who is committed to Stonehill; **Ella Dacey** (Merrimack), and **Riley Halloran**, who will play lacrosse at Merrimack, along with sophomore **Eva Karacalidis**, a returning starter.

“It’s going to take us a little bit to settle in, and just sort of find that groove,” said Quinn. “I’m going to use those few returners that I have as my base and my foundation to build upon.”

Developing a strong field hockey IQ is pivotal, per Quinn.

“Make sure that they’re not programmed,” she said. “They’re working together and they’re working off of each other instinctively without having to have someone tell them where to go.

“Making them think for themselves is really important, and it sets a lot of athletes apart.”

That culture is what Handwerk hopes will help the Porkers transition from last season to this one.

“I think we are known for having such good team chemistry. It’s like a sisterhood for us,” said Handwerk.

Karacalidis, one of the few returning players with varsity experience, said she is working on her on-field communication and “trying to be more of a leader.”

Dennis-Yarmouth faced a similar situation last year in coach **Leslie LaFronz’s** second season. At the time, the Dolphins had no expectations. Now there is a different pressure.

“I feel like people, we’re on their radar, and so I’m trying to just pick up where we left off and keep developing the players,” said LaFronz.

“I took over the program two years ago, not knowing any of the teams up here . . . so winning the state championship last year was such a thrill because we had no big expectations. We just played each game and tried to get better.”

Uxbridge also faces a reset. Coach **Kelly Rosborough** shared the biggest goal is to build a team that is “competitive, connected, and committed.”

“I think the exciting part is seeing how much potential this group has and watching them grow into their own team, rather than trying to be last year’s team,” said Rosborough. “New season, new team, still a champion mind-set.”

They are all chasing the same goal, but this season holds more unknowns.

“I just want my legacy to be that I left everything out there. I did everything I could, win or lose,” said Handwerk.

US OPEN

Gauff moves on, Cobolli avoids upset

By Brian Mahoney
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Even Coco Gauff had to applaud a couple times when her opponent hit some nifty shots.

There was the ball that Zeynep Sonmez tracked down deep in the corner and hit down the line on the run. There was a volley with unusual spin that just cleared the net for another point.

Many of the rest of the highlights belonged to Gauff.

The No. 4 seed opened her quest for a second US Open title Tuesday by beating Sonmez, 6-3, 6-4, regaining control of midway through the second set after her opponent from Turkey picked up her play.

“I know that I can raise my level if I need to do and I like to challenge my opponent to let them keep up the level the whole match,” Gauff said. “And if they do, I clap my hands and I walk off court with my head held high.”

Instead, she’s walking into a second-round match against either Paula Badosa or Daria Kasatkina.

Flavio Cobolli rallied from two sets down to avoid an early upset on the men’s side, and his wasn’t even the most dramatic comeback Tuesday.



JULIAN FINNEY/GETTY IMAGES

Flavio Cobolli needed 4 hours, 12 minutes, and five sets to advance.

Maria Sakkari fell behind, 6-2, 4-0, once she was finally able to get on the court after the rain stopped, then the No. 32 seed rallied to edge Robin Montgomery, 2-6, 7-5, 6-2.

The two turnarounds provided some rare spirit on a day when some of the busiest people were the ones trying to dry the courts.

French Open champion Mirra Andreeva and 2024 US Open runner-up Taylor Fritz had smooth sailing into the

second round, unlike some of the other close calls after a rainy morning.

Cobolli, the No. 5 seed and French Open runner-up, beat Francisco Comezana, 3-6, 2-6, 6-3, 6-4, 6-4, finishing his match that lasted 4 hours, 12 minutes not long after some sun had broken through the clouds and allowed play to start on all the outside courts.

Cobolli made his first career two-set comeback to avoid joining No. 4 seed Novak Djokovic and No. 10 Arthur Fils among early losers in a men’s draw that was already missing top-ranked Jannik Sinner, who was unable to play because of a right knee injury.

Gael Monfils turned back the clock and pushed back the end of his Grand Slam career, beating Adolfo Daniel Vallejo, 2-6, 6-1, 6-2, 6-0, to become the oldest man to win a US Open match since Jimmy Connors defeated Jaime Oncins on Sept. 2, 1992, when he turned 40.

Alex Eala’s many fans were treated to a victory as the No. 17 seed from the Philippines had little trouble dispatching American Mary Stoiana, 6-1, 6-2.

Madison Keys, the No. 22 seed and 2017 US Open runner-up, beat 19-year-old Alina Korneeva, 7-5, 6-4.

State works to curtail bad bettor behavior

By Michael Silverman
GLOBE STAFF

Caleb Durbin believes it’s a sad and strange state of affairs that sports bettors fling hateful and threatening language on social media toward the athletes who “lost” bets for them.

That’s why he’s grateful for the “Bet on Respect” initiative that the Massachusetts Gaming Commission introduced this week.

The program offers a pathway that could lead to an abuser being banned from legally betting on sports in the state.

“It’s a normal thing for us, but it shouldn’t be a normal thing,” said the Red Sox third baseman before Tuesday night’s game against the Mariners at Fenway Park. “You don’t just want people to get away with saying whatever they want as far as hate goes because that’s not cool, and we’re people at the end of the day. Sports betting is its own beast, as far as people who have money involved.”

Drawing a bright line that hopefully illuminates the difference between old-fashioned cheering and razzing from hateful speech is basically the point of the initiative, said Jordan Maynard, chair of the MGC.

“We’re not asking anyone to be nice, right? We’re asking people to be decent and kind,” said Maynard. “Something I’ve been telling myself a lot lately is, ‘You know, it’s OK to be miserable when you lose a bet, but you can’t make an athlete’s life miserable because you lost that

bet.’”

The MGC’s website offers a portal where athletes, fans, or anyone aware of bettors crossing the line can report the incident in detail. The submission would spark an investigation that, with enough evidence, could lead the MGC to place the offender on the state’s list of excluded bettors.

“People have been jeering at athletes since there’s been athletics, right?” said Maynard. “But with the introduction of sports wagering and with our regulatory authority that really started in 2022 and 2023, we started thinking about how can we actually create a deterrent to harassment, and how can we make this better?”

“I want to do what we can do within our control to create that deterrent.”

The bulk of what the investigators will be looking for comes from MGC regulatory language: “Whether, in connection with sports wagering, the individual has either: willfully and maliciously engaged in a knowing pattern of conduct or series of acts over a period of time directed at a specific person, which seriously alarms that person and would cause a reasonable person to suffer substantial emotional distress; or expressed an intent to injure the person or property of another.”

Red Sox starting pitcher Garret Crochet, the Bruins’ Jeremy Swayman, the Revolution’s Griffin Yow, and Celtics president of basketball operations Brad Stevens, plus Maynard and other MGC commissioners, appear in a promotional video the commission produced to help

spread the word.

The Bruins, Celtics, Red Sox, Patriots, Revolution, Boston Legacy FC, and the NCAA have partnered with the commission, as have Bally Bet, BetMGM/MGM Springfield, Caesars, DraftKings, Encore Boston Harbor, Fanatics Betting and Gaming, FanDuel, and Penn Entertainment/Plainridge Park Casino.

Durbin said when he was with the Brewers last season, a teammate received a threatening direct message on his social media account that referenced the player’s newborn baby. The player reported it to the team, which took action. The player also contacted the messenger to explain he had gone too far.

The messenger, said Durbin, responded with “ ‘Oh, I’m so sorry.’ These are kids and they don’t understand. They need to learn though. They’ve got their phone and they think they’ve got all the power in the world. You know, there’s a person on the other end of what they’re saying.”

Durbin smiled as he shook his head.

“The whole concept of it is bizarre, that you have random people DMing you not nice things — that’s just a weird thing in society,” he said. “Like face to face, that would never happen, that type of thing, you know what I mean?”

“I think social media just kind of opens the door for that. But that’s the way society kind of is now, unfortunately.”

Michael Silverman can be reached at michael.silverman@globe.com.

Globe Top 20

No.	
1.	Walpole
2.	Somerset Berkley
3.	Sandwich
4.	Franklin
5.	Hingham
6.	Wellesley
7.	Winchester
8.	Andover
9.	Watertown
10.	Lincoln-Sudbury
11.	Canton
12.	Belmont
13.	Dennis-Yarmouth
14.	Dover-Sherborn
15.	King Philip
16.	Monomoy
17.	Medfield
18.	Lynnfield
19.	St. Mary’s
20.	Reading

Corner hits

■ Roster and starter battles should serve Gloucester well this fall.

“We have a very strong program with a lot of players,” said Gloucester coach **Lauren Riley-Gove**. “There’s internal competition which makes it fun and always helps the girls to get their game to the next level.”

In a 13-5-1 finish last season, Gloucester was ousted by perennial Division 3 power Watertown in the second round. However, Riley-Gove saw promise in the team’s 12th straight postseason appearance.

“We held Watertown to just two goals,” said Riley-Gove. “We need to capitalize on our scoring opportunities. We have a very strong forward line and I’m looking forward to finding the back of the net much more often.”

Top scorer **Fiona Black** returns as a junior captain after a 25-point (16 goals, nine assists) season. She is joined by senior captains **Olivia Madruga**, **Julia Palk**, and **Makayla Allen**. Both coaches and players were aligned with those choices.

“I was very happy to see that they were selected by their teammates,” said Riley-Gove. “It’s always nice when your choices align with the team.”

Gloucester won its traditional preseason scrimmage against Ipswich, and will practice against Austin Prep before opening the season Sept. 8 against Bishop Fenwick.

“They have been putting in a lot of work in the offseason, doing indoor league and summer league,” said Riley-Gove. “I think that their chemistry is something that’s really going to help us this season.”

■ It was a light year for coaching changes but a few stand out, especially north of Boston.

Former Peabody coach **Jillian Tobin** now leads Amesbury, while **Kimberly Frank** has taken helm of the Tanners. Also in the Northeastern Conference, **Stephen Strange** is the hire at Swampscott.

Another coach will try to follow in the footsteps of legend **Mary Ryan** at Rockport. New athletic director **Mia Muzio** hired **Liz Luster**, the Vikings’ girls’ lacrosse coach, to take on field hockey. Luster led the JV squad last fall, and played lacrosse at Nichols.

In Bedford, 2007 alumnus **Lisa Gocht** was hired in the spring. The Eastern University field hockey alumnus previously was the JV coach.

■ It may feel like a long way off, but key dates to keep in mind for field hockey: Nov. 1 (tournament cutoff), and Nov. 3 (bracket release). The tournament begins Nov. 5, with the state finals tentatively slated for Nov. 20 - 21.

Correspondent Kat Cornetta contributed. Inaaya Omer can be reached at inaaya.omer@globe.com.

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BLACKSTONE STOUGHTON, Rita H. (Petitto)	NEWBURYPORT CAESAR, Peter Menard
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BURLINGTON LAWRENCE, Marie Louise (McDonald)	UHLMANN, Melie Chrestienne
CANTON BROE, Mary J.	NORWOOD BROE, Mary J.
CHELMSFORD COSTA, Harold Stephen	COSTA, Harold Stephen
EAST BOSTON CURRY, Mary	FLYNN, Madeline B.
FRAMINGHAM DEVLIN, Susan J.(Murtagh)	PLYMOUTH WARNOCK, Charles R. Jr.
FRANKLIN STOUGHTON, Rita H. (Petitto)	ROSLINDALE FLYNN, Madeline B.
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	OUT OF STATE
	ARIZONA UHLMANN, Melie Chrestienne
	DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA DEVLIN, Susan J.(Murtagh)

BROE, Mary J.



On August 30, passed away peacefully, surrounded by the love of her family. Mary was predeceased by her beloved husband, John J. Broe, Jr.; her parents, Ellen (Mahon) and Thomas Cogavin; and her sister, Ellen (Fran) Cogavin. She was the devoted mother of Maureen (Victor) Dodig, Kerry Broe and Carole (Timothy) Hurley. Mary was the cherished grandmother of Matthew, Thomas, Erin, Julia, Mary Kate, Nicholas and Jack. She was the loving sister of Kathy (Mike) Hogan; and sister-in-law of Susan (David) Sullivan. She was also a beloved aunt to Michael, Melissa and Mark Hogan and Eric and Kevin Morreale and Jodi Callahan. Visitation will be held on Thursday, September 3, 2026, from 4:00 PM to 7:00 PM, in the Kraw-Kornack Funeral Home, 1248 Washington Street, NORWOOD. Mary's Funeral Mass will be celebrated on Friday, September 4, 2026, at 11:00 AM, in St. Catherine of Siena Parish, 547 Washington Street, Norwood. For full obituary or additional information, please visit www.kraw-kornackfuneralhome.com 781-762-0482.



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CAESAR, Peter Menard



Of Newburyport, MA, age 73, died on August 30, at home, surrounded by family. He faced cancer with endless optimism, humor, and gratitude. He is survived by his wife, Marge Kaczala; children, Adrienne and Sean; brothers, John Caesar and partner, Jane Burns and Mark Caesar and wife, Kathryn; and numerous nieces and nephews. He was predeceased by his parents, John Philip and Eileen (Menard) Caesar.

Born on April 8, 1953, he cherished his upbringing on a small farm in East Dracut, MA. His family moved to Salem, NH in 1970, where he was elected captain of the football team as a new senior. He graduated from University of New Hampshire in 1974 and Boston College in 1982, where he completed his Master's Degree in Social Work. Peter was proud of his 35-year career as a senior clinician, clinical supervisor, and director of training for social work graduate students, at both Danvers and Tewksbury State Hospitals. He received a Commonwealth Citation for his dedicated service to the Department of Mental Health.

Peter enjoyed 16 years of retirement, in which he and Marge visited many museums, gardens and concert halls. His love of gardening extended from their home to the local rail trail and Newburyport Public Library. He was a fervent collector and listener of music, attending live performances from jazz clubs to folk festivals. But one of his favorite formats were free concerts at the New England Conservatory.

In lieu of flowers, donations in his memory may be made to the NEC Fund. Peter would encourage you to attend a concert too! A Celebration of Life will be held in October. To be notified when event details are finalized, please visit Peter's page on Legacy.com and click "Follow".

COSTA, Harold Stephen



Age 82, passed away peacefully, on August 29, 2026, at Beth Israel Deaconess Medical Center, Boston. He was the beloved husband of Ellen (Nazzaro) Costa. He was born in Boston on November 21, 1943, and was the son of the late Harold and Norma (Pensa) Costa. In addition to his loving wife, Harold leaves his son, Jason Costa and wife, Michaela; his daughter, Amy Costa and her husband, Barry Hugo; his beloved grandchildren, Nolan, Lindsey and Tyler; his brothers, Richard (Janice) and Stephen (Molly) Costa; and their families along with many other relatives and dear friends. He was predeceased by his parents, Harold and Norma Costa; and his in-laws, Vincent and Marie Nazzaro. Visiting Hours will be held on Thursday, September 3, 2026, from 4pm - 7pm, at the Blake Chelmsford Funeral Home, 24 Worthen St., CHELMSFORD. His Mass of Christian Burial will be celebrated on Friday, September 4, 2026, at 11am, at St. Mary Parish, 25 North Rd., Chelmsford. Kindly gather at the church. Interment to follow in St. Joseph's Cemetery, Chelmsford. Funeral directors Paul A. Hardy, Jr. and Jennifer Lebaropoulos Hardy. For complete obituary, please visit chelmsfordfuneralhome.com.

CURRY, Mary



Mary passed on August 28, 2026, after a period of declining health, at the age of 89. Mary was born in the summer of 1937, as the first daughter of Irish immigrants, William and Elizabeth (O'Donnell) Sullivan. Mary was predeceased by her six siblings, William (Sully), Edward (Teddy), Phillip (Barney), Robert (Bobby), Gail O'Neill and Beverly Gibbons.

Mary, raised in Charlestown, was immensely proud of her "townie" heritage. Her experience of growing-up in a mid-century, immigrant family was not easy nor idyllic. However, Mary learned what better looked like. Together with her husband, Steve, they worked hard to ensure their two sons, Stephen and Mark, experienced better. They were successful.

Mary was devoted to and loved her family dearly. She loved God and was a devout Catholic. Mary was quite the fashionista, with perfectly curated hair, nails and make-up, plus a coordinated outfit for every occasion, and lots and lots of shoes.

Mary graduated from Charlestown High, then worked for New England Telephone Company before raising her family. Mary married Stephen A. Curry in 1960, moving to Melrose in 1968. Mary worked part-time in the Melrose Public Schools for several years. When her children were grown, Mary joined the emerging venture capital industry, for then start-up, Summit Partners. Mary enjoyed her work at Summit Partners and was proud of Summit Partner's success, retiring in 2006.

Mary loved to travel. She traveled to many continents and countries and enjoyed learning the culture of these countries, often with her best friend and neighbor of 50 years, Eleanor. These trips provided a wealth of stories that Mary shared (and shared again and again) for many years at family dinners. In the 1990s, Mary traced her heritage to Donegal, Ireland, eventually meeting and reuniting with her mother's family. This reunion resulted in countless visits to Ireland. During retirement, Mary enjoyed many vacations with her family, including trips to Disney World, cruises and our annual summer vacation in Chatham, Massachusetts.

Mary was the loving mother of her son, Steve, his wife, Karen and son, Mark, all of Melrose. Mary was grandmother to her cherished granddaughter, Catherine Mary, Ashley and Andrew.

Catholic services at the Incarnation Church and interment at Wyoming Cemetery, in Melrose, where she lies in rest next to her dear friend, Dee, were private. In lieu of flowers, donations in Mary's name may be made to the Melrose High School Permanent Scholarship Fund, at <https://www.mhsfund.org/ways-to-give/donate/#>

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DEVLIN, Susan J.(Murtagh)

Of Wayland, formerly of Framingham, died at her residence, on August 31, 2026, following a brief illness.

Beloved wife for 46 years of Ralph T. Devlin of Wayland. Devoted mother of Sean T. Devlin of Greenfield and Thomas L. Devlin and his wife, Stephanie P. Hales of Washington, D.C.

Visitations on Friday, September 4, 2026, from 5:00 to 8:00 pm, at the John C. Bryant Funeral Home, 56 Pemberton Rd. (off Rte. 30), WAYLAND. Family and friends are invited to go directly to Good Shepherd Parish at St. Ann Church, 134 Cochituate Rd. (Rte. 27), Wayland, on Saturday, September 5, 2026, at 9:00 o'clock, for her Mass of Christian Burial. Interment will follow in Lakeview Cemetery, Wayland.

In lieu of flowers, her family kindly suggests gifts in Susan's memory, may be sent to Southern Poverty Law Center, 400 Washington Ave., Montgomery, AL 36104 (splcenter.org); ACLU, 125 Broad Street, 18th Floor, New York, NY 10004 (ACLU.org); or to the Sisters of Saint Joseph of Boston Retirement Fund, 637 Cambridge Street, Boston, MA 02135 (csjboston.org).

For directions and complete notice, visit www.johncbryantfuneralhome.com

FEINLEIB, Mary Ella (Harman)



Mary Ella Feinleib passed away peacefully on August 27, 2026 at 88 years old. Raised in Brooklyn, NY, She attended Erasmus Hall High School where she was a Westinghouse Science Talent Search winner. At Cornell University, she graduated top of her class with awards for the highest grade point average and for her honors thesis. She earned her Ph.D. in Biology in 1966 from Harvard University. During this time, she began her long affiliation with Tufts University, first as an Instructor in biology, then Professor and Chair of the Biology Department. An expert in photobiology and phototactic behavior of unicellular algae, Mary Ella was a Fulbright Scholar in 1975-76 at Erlangen-Nuremberg University in Germany. She also served as an organizer of the "Frontiers of Science" Gordon Research Conferences in Photobiology. In 1982, Mary Ella joined the Tufts administration as an Associate Dean of the College of Liberal Arts, and in 1991 she became its Dean of Arts, Sciences & Technology, retiring from academia in 1996. Mary Ella loved travel, food, acting, dancing, opera and puzzles, among many other passions. She loved being with people. She was an inspiring role model in her teaching, diplomatic skills, zest for travel and love of the arts. She treasured her family, friends, and colleagues, and was treasured by them. She will be sorely missed. Mary Ella is survived by her cousin Mylène (Mura) Farrere, former husband Julius Feinleib, niece Andrea (Michael) Bellantone, nephew Ken (Rebecca) Fishkin, and grandnieces and nephew. Predeceased by her sister, Brenda Harman Fishkin. Graveside service at Mount Auburn Cemetery on Thursday, September 3 at 2:00 pm.



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FLYNN, Madeline B.



Of Norwood, formerly of West Roxbury, entered peacefully into rest on Saturday, August 29, 2026, surrounded in love by her children. Beloved wife of the late John C. Flynn; and wonderful mother of Donna J. Flynn of Norwood, Jeannine Bernazzani and her husband, John of West Roxbury, John M. Flynn and his wife, Ruth of Woodbridge, VA, Suzanne Sears and her husband, Anthony T. of West Roxbury, Christopher R. Flynn and his wife, Ellen of West Roxbury, and the late David J. Flynn. Madeline was blessed with 12 grandchildren and four great-grandchildren, each of whom brought her great joy. Madeline was born and raised in Hyde Park; and was predeceased by her parents, Joseph and Bambina (Campia) Lattanzio; and her sister and brother-in-law, Joan and William O'Hear. She is survived by many loving nephews, nieces, and devoted friends. Funeral from the Robert J. Lawler & Crosby Funeral Home, 1803 Centre St., WEST ROXBURY, MA, Friday, September 4, 2026, at 9 AM, followed by a Funeral Mass in St. Theresa of Avila Church, West Roxbury, at 10 o'clock. Visiting Hours: Thursday, 4-8 PM. Relatives and friends are kindly invited. Interment private. In lieu of flowers, donations may be made to St. Jude Children's Research Hospital, 501 St. Jude Place, Memphis, TN 38105, <https://www.stjude.org>

info@lawlerfuneralhome.com
617-323-5600

LAWRENCE, Marie Louise (McDonald)



Age 79, of Burlington, passed away August 29. She was born in Boston, the daughter of the late John J. McDonald, Jr. and Gertrude U. (Sweet) McDonald. She was employed as a nurse for many years prior to retiring from Mass Eye and Ear in Boston. She is survived by her husband, Peter Doane Lawrence of Burlington; two brothers, James F. McDonald and his wife, Sheila of North Reading and John J. McDonald III and his wife, Joan of Kamloops, British Columbia, Canada; as well as many nieces, nephews, great-nieces and nephews, and close friends. Relatives and friends are respectfully invited to attend her Visiting Hours on Friday, September 4, from 10am to 11:30am, at the Edward V. Sullivan Funeral Home, 43 Winn St., BURLINGTON, MA. Her Funeral Mass of Christian Burial will follow at St. Veronica's Parish, in Saint Margaret's Church, 111 Winn St., Burlington, at 12 noon. Burial will be private and at the convenience of her family. In lieu of flowers, contributions in her memory may be made to Beth Israel Lahey Health at Home at www.bilhathome.org/giving Arrangements are by the Edward V. Sullivan Funeral Home, Burlington, www.sullivanfuneralhome.net

LICHTMAN, Barbara



Of Brookline, on Monday, August 31, 2026. For 61 years the beloved wife of the late Abraham Murray Lichtman. Loving mother of Susan & Carl Blanchard, Michael Lichtman & Joyce Greenwald, Gene & Donna Lichtman. Cherished grandmother of Ariel, Sara, Oren, Aaron, Lauren, Eric, Taylor, Benjamin, Ilana, Jacob, Melanie, Eli & Alyssa. Great-grandmother to Emmy, Jordan, Theo & Nolan.

Graveside ceremony on Wednesday, September 2, 2026 at 10:00 am at Independent Pride of Boston Cemetery, 776 Baker Street, West Roxbury, MA. Shiva will be at the home of Susan & Carl Blanchard following the burial then daily from 2:00pm - 9:00pm through Sunday evening.

Remembrances may be made to the Brockton Library Foundation www.brocktonlibraryfoundation.org

Levine Chapels, Brookline
617-277-8300
www.levinechapels.com

MACONE, Gaetano J. "Gus"



 Longtime of Lynnfield, August 29, 2026, at age 88. Beloved husband of nearly 50 years to Rose M. (Colombo) Macone. Father of Nadine Desiderio and her husband Marco of Lynnfield. Grandfather of Graziana, Rocco, and Francesca Desiderio. Brother of the late Anthony and Raymond Macone. Funeral Mass at St. Maria Goretti Church, 112 Chestnut St., Lynnfield on Friday, Sept. 4 at 11am. In lieu of flowers, donations to Dept. of Veteran Services, 525 Salem St. Lynnfield, MA 01940, check payable to: Lynnfield American Legion Post 131. www.RobinsonFuneralHome.com

Robinson Funeral Home
Life Celebration

PIZZI, Richard N. "Dick"



Of Waltham, August 30, 2026, at age 89. Beloved husband of 62 years to Alba (Leone) Pizzi; and cherished father to Cheryl Pizzi and Richard "Rick" Pizzi, Jr. He was the devoted son of the late Domenico and Angela (D'Agastino) Pizzi. Dick carried with him a strong sense of family, work ethic, and community throughout his life. Together with his wife, Alba, they shared 62 years of marriage and built a life grounded in love, family, and a shared commitment to one another. After high school, he earned an associate's degree in business from Curry College and followed in his parents footsteps as owner of Pizzi Farm in Waltham, a family business that continues to serve the community for 93 years. In time, he and Alba, along with their children, expanded into retail, building a full-service Farm Stand with a Bakery, Deli, Garden Center and Ice Cream Shoppe. Dick remained involved in both his community and his profession. He belonged to several social and industry organizations, including the New England Vegetable Growers Association, Massachusetts Flower Growers Association, and served as a Past-President of the Waltham Lions Club of which he was honored as being a Life Member, and Past President of Opportunities for Inclusion (formally GWCAR), and Board Member for Waltham Chapter of the American Cancer Society. He was the recipient of the Robert and Thomas McNamara Community Service Award, and Melvin Jones Fellowship Award by the Lions Club International Foundation. Relatives and friends are respectfully invited to attend Funeral Services in Celebration of Dick's Life on Friday, September 4, at 1PM, in the Mary Catherine Chapel of Brasco Family Funeral Service, 773 Moody Street, WALTHAM. Visiting Hours will be prior to services from 11AM-1PM. Interment, Newton Cemetery. In lieu of flowers, expressions of sympathy may be made in Dick's memory to the Waltham Lions Club, 549 Lincoln St., Waltham, MA 02451.

SACK, Gerald "Jerry"



Of Newton, passed away on August 28, 2026. He was the beloved husband of Deborah K. (Lerner) Sack; devoted father of Terry Sack and Melissa Sack; dear brother of Ina Traister and Robert Sack; and stepbrother of Jeffrey Kosow and the late Marvin Kosow. Services will be held at Temple Beth Avodah, 45 Puddingstone Lane, Newton, MA, on Thursday, September 3, 2026, at 3:00 p.m. Memorial observance will follow at the temple until 9:00 p.m. and continue on Friday, September 4—Jerry's 84th birthday—at the Nahanton Woods Clubhouse in Newton, at the residence of Carol and Fred Lerner, from 2:00 to 6:00 p.m. In lieu of flowers, donations in Jerry's memory may be made to Temple Beth Avodah. Burial will be private.



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STOUGHTON, Rita H. (Petitto)



Age 91, of Franklin, and a former resident of Roslindale, passed away peacefully, Thursday, August 27, 2026. She was the beloved wife of the late Kenneth R. Stoughton. For service details and complete obituary, www.franklinfuneral.com

UHLMANN, Melie Chrestienne

Age 57, passed away on August 26, 2026. She was the beloved daughter of Donald Robert and the late Eulalie Therese; and the stepdaughter of Maru. Adored sister of Donald Jr. (Maria), Eugenie Jeffries (Jeff), Angelique, Aurelie Cunningham (Mark) and Elise McLamarrah (Justin). Loving aunt to Donald III (Carolina), Natatcha (Steven), Martin (Yunli), Jeff Jr., Juliette, Lillie, Quentin, Ryan, Valerie, Mary Jane, Ivy and Scarlett. Devoted great-aunt to Emma, Noah, and Agnes. She is forever loved. For funeral information, visit www.eatonandmackay.com

Eaton & Mackay Funeral Home
Newton Corner 617-244-2034

WARNOCK, Charles R. Jr. "Charlie"



Age 85, of Plymouth, passed away peacefully on August 25, 2026, surrounded by his loved ones at home. Born February 17, 1941, in Cambridge, he was the son of the late Charles R. and Letitia (Wait) Warnock.

Charlie graduated from Cambridge High and Latin School in 1959. In 1962, he married the love of his life, Marie A. (Sloane), with whom he shared 64 years of marriage and a loving family.

Charlie enjoyed a distinguished career with the Boston Fire Department, advancing from firefighter to Aid to the Captain, Aid to the Deputy Chief, and Aid to the Commissioner. He completed his career teaching at the Boston Fire Academy. He later worked for Cartmell-Davis Funeral Home well into retirement and generously coached youth sports.

Active in his community, Charlie belonged to the St. Vincent de Paul Society, Kiwanis, Knights of Columbus, the Liars Club, and St. Mary's Church. He was known for his humor, generosity, and willingness to help others.

He was the loving father of Ann-Marie Warnock, Joseph Warnock and his wife, Christine and the late Charles R. Warnock III and his wife, Julie. He was a beloved grandfather, great-grandfather, brother, and uncle.

In a heartbreaking turn, Marie passed away within 24 hours of Charlie. Their enduring love was the heart of their family.

A joint Visitation will be held September 3, from 4-7 p.m., at Cartmell-Davis Funeral Home, PLYMOUTH. A Funeral Mass will be celebrated September 4, at 10 a.m., at St. Mary's Church. Interment will be held at a later date.



Announcements

BOSTON FIREFIGHTERS LOCAL 718

We regret to announce the Death of Brother Charles R. Warnock, Jr. Late Aid to the Commissioner, Retired.

Funeral from Cartmell-Davis Funeral Home, 373 Court Street, Plymouth, Thursday, September 3. Visiting Hours are 4-7 PM, Funeral Mass at St. Mary's Church, 313 Court Street, Plymouth, Friday, at 10 AM.

Members Are Requested to Attend.

Samuel J. Dillon, President
Eric P. DesRoches, Treasurer,
D&W

By Robert D. McFadden

NEW YORK TIMES

Wendell Berry, a Kentucky farmer who plowed his fields behind Belgian draft horses and wrote lyrical poems, novels, and essays — mostly in pencil and without electric light — that explored his elegiac visions of the life and death of agrarian America, died Monday at his home in Port Royal, Ky. He was 92.

His daughter, Mary Berry, confirmed the death.

Lanky and rawboned in middle age, with melancholy eyes, a jutting chin, and a widow's peak reminiscent of Lincoln's, Wendell Berry wrote more than 50 volumes of poetry, fiction, and argument that championed small family farms, the environment, local foods, and interdependent communities, and railed against chemicals, most technologies, agribusiness, and distant government.

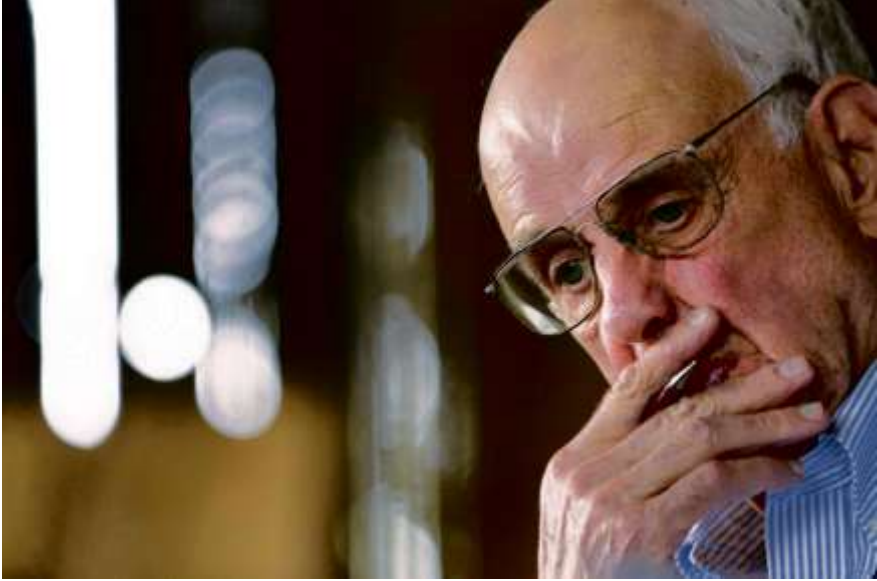
"The national economy that is really run for the benefit of a very few people is preying upon and slowly destroying local communities everywhere," he told *Sierra* magazine in 1990. "Everything we produce in rural America makes more money for other people than it does for those who produce it. We're destroying rural America."

Mr. Berry was once hailed by author and historian Page Smith as "a prophetic American voice of our day." He never became a household name but, as his oeuvre grew over a half-century, advocates of agrarian and ecological causes embraced his work as an eloquent, if sometimes didactic, expression of their own hopes. Some critics likened his landed exhortations to those of Henry David Thoreau or Thomas Jefferson.

Toward the end of his long fight for agrarian justice, waged from a cabin in the backwoods of Kentucky, Mr. Berry was showered with honors, including the National Humanities Medal, the nation's highest award for humanitarian services, presented by President Obama at the White House in 2011, "for his achievements as a poet, novelist, farmer, and conservationist."

Raised on a farm in north-central Kentucky, he studied English at the University of Kentucky and writing at Stanford with the environmentalist-novelist Wallace Stegner, traveled in Italy and landed in New York, intending to write and teach. He married, had two children, and taught for two years at New York University.

But at 30, he confronted in himself a deep need to return to his roots — specifically, to an old two-room cabin on the Kentucky River at Port Royal, in Henry County, where his ancestors had lived since 1803. The cabin had been built in the 1920s by a great-uncle. He had known the place all his life; indeed, had visited it often as a boy and spent a summer there with his wife, Tanya.



STEVE HEBERT/NEW YORK TIMES

"In the life we lived that summer, we represented to ourselves what we wanted — and it was not the headlong pilgrimage after money and comfort and prestige," he recalled in an essay titled for its inspirational setting, "The Long-Legged House."

In 1964, the couple resolved to stay and work the land. Nearby, they bought a 125-acre farm, called Lanes Landing, and started raising sheep, corn, and grain, and planted gardens for their own table. Mr. Berry also initiated a 20-year teaching association at the University of Kentucky, in Lexington.

Returning to his home as a place to write for the rest of his life was a way to insure, to himself, that he would always be bound by the truth, Mr. Berry said in a phone interview in 2018 for this obituary.

"It made a permanent connection between me and my native place, and with its landscape," he said. "The landscape was there to check me if I was wrong. I could never go away and make up stuff at cocktail parties about the backwoods of Kentucky. I worked with people here in all walks of life and learned from them. It's been a very rich experience."

He rebuilt the Long-Legged House and began writing there about sustainable agriculture and the culture of life on small farms and in farming towns — polemics about how such places were vital to individual liberties and why they were rapidly disappearing from a landscape increasingly afflicted with topsoil erosion, polluted water, and toxic chemicals.

Over the next half-century, he wrote with a pencil or pen on paper during daylight hours. His farmhouse had electricity, but he refused to use electric lights at the Long-Legged House, where he wrote, because, he said, the power was supplied by strip-mined coal. His wife critiqued his work and typed his manuscripts on an old Royal standard. He refused to have a television set, or a computer after they came along.

Mr. Berry first won national attention with "The Unsettling

of America: Culture & Agriculture" (1977), a manifesto to save small farms from big business and a government bent on agricultural efficiencies that, he said, were destroying the land and a way of life. The book launched the modern movement for sustainable farming and became a conservationist classic.

"The concentration of farmland into larger and larger holdings and fewer and fewer hands — with the consequent increase in overhead, debt, and dependence on machines — is a matter of complex significance, and its agricultural significance cannot be disentangled from its cultural significance," Mr. Berry wrote.

In a review for *The New York Times*, farmer-poet Donald Hall hailed its "worldview that derives its premises from the experience of working on the land." Its author, Hall added, "argues with careful logic for the recovery of lost land, for the return of the small farmer to the countryside, the small farmer expropriated by the army of agribusiness."

Mr. Berry elaborated on this theme in "The Gift of Good Land" (1981) and "Home Economics" (1987), essay collections that described organic farming techniques in America and abroad. They argued that "industrial values" were killing family farms and threatening American society as a whole.

Marshaling fiction to his cause, Mr. Berry wrote more than a dozen novels and volumes of short stories. He invented a town, Port William, Ky., as a setting for generations of lives interwoven in tales of murder, alcoholism, marital discord, and remembrance against subtexts of fading agrarian life. Some critics called his fiction moralistic and short on plot and character development.

Others found his novels moving. "The Memory of Old Jack" (1974), the recollections of a 92-year-old farmer on his last day of life, was "magnificent," *English* scholar Joan Joffe Hall wrote in *The New Republic*, saying it "makes us grieve that these rhythms of work and speech are lost to us."

Sliman Mansour, 79, artist who depicted Palestinian struggle



JOHN MACDOUGALL/APF VIA GETTY IMAGES

A visitor leafed through Mr. Mansour's book "The Complete Tales of a Deceased Nobody" in 2004.

yya. She also called him one of the best-known of all Palestinian artists, noting his role traveling back and forth through Palestinian villages after the 1967 Arab-Israeli War to connect artists and youth and to highlight the importance of art as a tool of liberation.

Mr. Mansour depicted the commitment of his own art to politics less as a matter of choice than of necessity.

"I reflect, in my art, my way of life; and my bad luck is that I am under occupation," he told Germany's *Deutsche Welle* radio in a 2018 interview. "I didn't

As a poet, Mr. Berry produced some 30 volumes of collected verses, starting with "The Broken Ground" (1964). His "Sparrow," in its entirety, was typically economical:

*A sparrow is
his hunger organized.
Filled, he flies
before he knows he's going to,
And he dies by the
same movement filled
with himself, he goes
by the eye-quick
reflex of his flesh
out of sight,
leaving his perfect
absence without a thought.*

"The quiet but sure and melodious voice of Wendell Berry makes 'The Broken Ground' an immediate pleasure," poet and critic Robert Pack wrote in a review for the *Times*. "He is essentially elegiac, ranging from praise to requiem; throughout his poems there broods a reverential hush."

Farmers caught in an economic squeeze regarded Mr. Berry's ideas as naive. So did Dr. Charles Barnhart, a dean at the University of Kentucky's college of agriculture.

"What Wendell is talking about is a primitive agriculture," Barnhart told the *Times* in 1988. "It's a nice way of life if you have a rich father and you're a tenured member of the faculty at a university. But I don't see a great proportion of the American public returning to farms. And I don't see it as an industry that would ever be capable of feeding 225 million people."

Still, Mr. Berry won a wide following. "It's a movement on the way up, and Wendell's influence in it is pervasive," Ron Krose, director of the Land Stewardship Project in Stillwater, Minnesota, told the *Times* in 1988. "Wendell Berry has been the contemporary conscience of American agriculture."

Wendell Erdman Berry was born in Louisville on Aug. 5, 1934, the first of four children of John Marshall Berry, a lawyer and tobacco farmer in Port Royal, and Virginia (Erdman) Berry. The families of both parents had farmed in the county for more than five generations.

Like his siblings — John Jr., Mary Jo, and Martha — Wendell Berry helped work the farm. He learned from a grandfather how to harness and drive a team of mules. He was a melancholy boy. But in childhood retreats to the Long-Legged House, he found peace and solitude and read "Walden," Thoreau's reflections on two years in a woodland cabin in Concord.

A rebellious teenager, Mr. Berry was sent to Millersburg Military Institute, a boarding school near Lexington. He hated it. "The highest aim," he recalled, "was to produce a perfectly obedient, militarist, puritanical moron who could play football."

At the University of Kentucky, he earned a bachelor's degree in 1956 and a master's in 1957.

Mr. Berry and Tanya Amyx were married in 1957. In addition to his wife and daughter and two sisters, he leaves a son, Pryor Berry, known as "Den"; five grandchildren; and four great-grandchildren.

In recent years, still living and writing in Port Royal, Mr. Berry also joined nonviolent protests against mountaintop-removal coal mining, coal-fired power plants, and the death penalty.

Besides the humanities medal, Mr. Berry received more than 30 awards, including The Sewanee Review's Allen Tate Poetry Prize in 2014 and the Ivan Sandrof Lifetime Achievement Award of the National Book Critics Circle in 2016. He was the subject of a 2016 documentary, "Look & See: A Portrait of Wendell Berry," directed by Laura Dunn and Jef Sewell.

"His writing has sometimes been called radical, but he thinks of himself as a conservative, conserving what is most human in our landscapes and ourselves," journalist and artist Paul Trachtman wrote in a 2005 Smithsonian magazine profile of Mr. Berry.

"You know," the story quoted Mr. Berry as saying, "if you subtracted the Gospels and the Constitution and the Declaration of Independence from my work, there wouldn't be very much left."

"stopped me and took my film."

A bag was slipped over his head, and he was handcuffed and beaten, he later told the art news website [Hyperallergic](http://Hyperallergic.com) in 2023.

Despite this, he refused to leave the land from which he drew inspiration.

"Everything is complicated here," he told *Deutsche Welle*. "They want to complicate our lives, and their end aim is for you to be fed up and leave. That's why I don't want to leave, no matter what happens."

Sliman Anis Mansour was born July 27, 1947, in the village of Birzeit, north of Jerusalem, in what was then the British Mandate of Palestine.

He was 4 when his father, Anis Mansour, a farmer, died, and Sliman and his five siblings were largely raised by their mother, Kamal (Shaheen) Mansour. She "spent all her time working, sewing clothes to make a living for us," he recalled to *Deutsche Welle*. "She didn't have time to talk to us."

In 1978, he married Hanan Kattoua. Besides his wife, he is survived by two sons, Fares and Bassel; two daughters, Sahar and Abeer; three sisters, Hilaneh, Adibeh, and Aniseh; two brothers, Adib and George; and five grandchildren.

LivingArts

By Sarah Rodman
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Rachel Reid is famous for being a devout hockey fan, but Monday night at Fenway Park, the best-selling author of the “Game Changers” book series got to savor her baseball fandom by appearing as part of the “Heated Rivalry” theme night with the Red Sox.

The event, held during a face off with the Seattle Mariners, was the most popular theme night in Red Sox history, with 12,000 fans descending on the ballyard to celebrate the popular Canadian drama series, which centers on the steamy romance between rival hockey players Shane Hollander (Hudson Williams) and Ilya Rozanov (Connor Storrie). (Rozanov plays for the Bruins-esque “Boston Raiders” on the show.)

“It’s wild,” said Reid, standing near the home dugout before the game in a personalized Red Sox jersey after greeting the fans. “When I was writing these books, this is not where I thought things would end up. It’s really touching and lovely and I’m really excited to be here. I grew up a Red Sox fan. I love this park so much. So being able to stand here on the field is such an honor, and having so many people here showing love for my characters is really nice.”

Fans reveled in the “Rivalry,” excitedly collecting and immediately donning their limited edition Hollander and Rozanov jerseys; VIP ticket holders also received hats sporting the famous phrase from the series “I’m coming to the cottage,” with “cottage” crossed out in favor of “Fenway.” They snapped photos at a makeshift “Club Hollanov” on the concourse and danced during a pregame set deejaed by the UK artist-producer Harrison, whose cover of t.a.T.u.’s early 2000s hit, “All the Things She Said,” scores a pivotal moment in the series. Wally and Tessie also got in on the act, with Wally sporting a Rozanov jersey and Tessie favoring Hollander.

It was not Reid’s first time at Fenway, having visited as an 11-year-old with her dad — a die-hard Sox fan — who attended the game with her and threw out the ceremonial first pitch. She’s come back over the years with her own kids. “In the Maritimes, there are a lot of Red Sox and Boston sports fans because it is the closest major league city to Halifax.”

Geography aside, does the author, who just finished penning “Unrivaled,” the final book in the Hollander-Rozanov story, worry that the lone Canadian MLB team might be jealous? “Definitely people are like, ‘Why not the Blue Jays?’” said Reid of why she opted to appear at Fenway instead of the Jays’ Rogers Centre in Toronto. “And I was like, ‘They didn’t ask.’ But I’m happy to be here.”



PHOTOS BY DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Wally the Green Monster danced during a “Heated Rivalry” VIP party before the Red Sox faced the Seattle Mariners at Fenway Park on Monday. “Heated Rivalry” author Rachel Reid (below) was on hand as well.

‘Heated Rivalry’ author Rachel Reid talks season 2 at Fenway’s theme night

The author said she recently visited the set of “Heated Rivalry,” now shooting its second season in Toronto. “I was very, very happy to see that the vibes felt the same,” she said, in the wake of the series’ explosively popular first season. “Everything was really positive and wonderful.” Season 2 is set to premiere in spring 2027 on Crave in Canada and HBO Max in the United States.

Reid did answer a question about actor Storrie’s recent buzzcut, which surfaced online, and had some fans reeling. (His curly locks in sea-

son 1 were a fan favorite.)

Reid said fans should keep the faith. “I’m fully on board with it, and I do know it’s a shock, and I get it. Bear with us. I don’t think you’ll hate it.”

A portion of sales from “Heated Rivalry” night raised money for OUT MetroWest. The Red Sox beat the Mariners 9-8 with a walk-off single by Roman Anthony in the 10th inning.

Sarah Rodman can be reached at srodman@globe.com.



Treasure in darkroom: Rediscovering the lost art of developing film

By Celine Hijazi
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Being 22, I’ve noticed there’s a particular subset of my age group that insists they were born in the wrong generation.

I’ll admit, there are certain things I see in old movies or documentaries that I’m jealous of: phones on planes, ashtrays in cars, or cute phone booths decorating city streets.

I would like to think that, for the most part, I am content with the time frame we are living in. But, as my film degree will make me argue, there is undoubtedly a thrill that comes with walking down memory lane and watching movies that encapsulate how life was years ago.

I wouldn’t say I am a full “film bro” (lots of cigarettes, fully thrifted outfits, and a bit of superiority that comes from being knowledgeable about “real” cinema), but I do have some diagnosable tendencies.

While I won’t argue about the difference between 35mm vs. 70mm ad nauseam, I do love to shoot and develop 35mm film. I did it all throughout college, and continue to do so.

For others infected with the film bro bug who also like to carry around their point and shoot film cameras, I would say you’re only getting about 10 percent of the fun by simply shooting your film. Instead of taking it to the local film lab, try developing it.

There is a serenity that comes with being in a darkroom.

When you enter, it’s completely pitch black. The goal is to take your roll of film — a few feet of celluloid containing all your memories — and wind it around a reel. After that, you put it into a developing tank and emerge into the light to begin your Walter White-esque chemical experiments.

The darkroom I use is in the BU basement, inside the College of Communication. It’s a cupboard-size room at the end of the photo lab.

Working in total darkness is not easy. Without sight, you have to wind your film onto the reel and then feel



PHOTOS BY CELINE HIJAZI

Clockwise from above: Celine Hijazi’s self-portrait on 35mm film in Warren Towers, 2022; first time in NYC, March 2024; Livia Davidson and Andrew Stemberger on film, Warren Towers, 2022.

around the table until you find your developing tank. It’s as though you are the original human hunting with a measly spear, poking and probing in the darkness until something hits.

When I first started, it would often take me 45 minutes just to figure out how to navigate the room. It was so grueling that I used to walk outside every 15 minutes to remind myself that colors do, in fact, exist.

The next part, however, is where the fun starts.

If you’re developing color film, you’re heating and mixing chemicals in your developing tank. If your parents also wished you were a woman in STEM, it’s fun to cosplay as someone throwing chemicals together like you actually understand science.

The end result is magical. You take out the film, unwind it from its reel, and hold the strip up to the light.

There, you can see your memories, cleanly preserved in a single roll: the photo you’re most proud of, the one



you can already tell is way too exposed, and the ones of your friends in a drunken haze that you can’t remember taking and no one else does either.

This is the magic of film: It forces choices. Like flash fiction — and unlike the camera on your phone — a film camera looks back at you with a discreet number of pictures. As a photographer, it’s your job to discern which compositions are worth using up on your film.

With this limited film real estate comes a new perspective. Unlike taking pictures with your phone, when you can snap photos infinitely, almost without thought, the film camera humbles you. It reminds you to look around and eternalize only the memories that matter. And in the roll are frozen tabloids of things you won’t find in your phone’s camera roll.

The result is something that feels older, almost timeless. The grain of a 35mm photograph is imperfect, but textured in a deeply human way.

In a world of Instagrams and quick selfies, the film camera is a reminder that a picture was never made to be beautiful. It was made to capture a moment — and, somehow, make it last.

(But always make sure you’re a vigilant photographer because even now going through my pictures, I realize that I wasted a shot on someone I’m not a fan of anymore.)

My favorite thing I’ve shot is simple: a self-portrait of myself in my BU freshman dorm, Warren Towers. Especially now, with Warren Towers being renovated, the photo feels like a snapshot of history. In it, I’m wearing my first thrifted item from the States, a Japanese Scream shirt that is now long gone. Everything in the picture now feels like ancient history, but one thing remains: my Minolta X-370.

Celine Hijazi can be reached at celine.hijazi@globe.com.

Anonymous donor gives Boston Ballet \$10 million

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

Boston Ballet announced Tuesday that it has received a \$10 million endowment gift, the largest such donation in its 63-year history.

The donation, made by an anonymous patron, is being given in honor of artistic director Mikko Nissinen and will endow his position in perpetuity.

Nissinen, who’s been with the company for a quarter century, said he was honored by the gift, calling it a “testament to the strength and impact of our beloved organization.”

“We strive to be a leader in innovative artistry and cultivate a roster of exceptionally talented Company of dancers, musicians, faculty, and staff,” he said in a statement. “Sustaining this level of artistic excellence depends on the philanthropic support of our community. This generous gift will have a meaningful and lasting impact on our ability to continue performing and operating at the highest standards.”

The Ballet said the donation is part of a broader strategy it launched in 2024 to bolster the organization’s finances. The company aims to expand its endowment to \$100 million by 2032, which it said would quadruple its annual draw and offer greater long-term financial stability and safeguard artistic excellence.

The Ballet has seen its audiences grow since the pandemic, but ticket sales only fund a third of its operations. The company said it still needs significant philanthropic investment to help fund performances and the company’s various initiatives, including its robust dance education program, community partnerships that offer free or discounted tickets, and sensory friendly performances of “The Nutcracker.”

“As performing arts organizations face increasingly challenging circumstances, a larger endowment gives Boston Ballet more breathing room and relieves pressure on the annual operating budget,” said Nissinen. “The arts live on a knife’s edge, and we are committed to evolving our business model to safeguard this deeply human art form.”

Food

THE BOSTON GLOBE WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 | BOSTON.GLOBE.COM/FOOD



By Lindsay Crudele
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

As tomatoes exit stage left, it's time for the next season's agricultural star: apples, one of New England's most iconic and historic crops. Pick-your-own season offers the fruit at its best possible moment all year, and venturing out into the countryside is a chance to transition into autumn amid some of the region's most picturesque settings.

Most local orchards open for pick-your-own the first or second week of September, and growers report this

Whether you want to sample really old — or really new — varieties, take a tractor ride to an orchard, or just load up on cider doughnuts, here's our curated guide to this season's best picking

year should be a strong season.

"Right now, the apple crop looks pretty outstanding for most growers," said Jon Clements, Extension Tree Fruit Specialist at the University of Massachusetts. An early spring freeze worried some growers, and Clements said that while it's not a bumper year, the bounty will be sufficient for most.

"We always panic," he said, "and then by the time August rolls around, it's like, wow, where'd all those apples come from?"

APPLE PICKING, Page G4

PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY LUIS G. RENDON/
GLOBE STAFF; ADOBE

Where warm pita . . . meets warm hospitality

The next generation, raised in the business, is running an expanded Halva

By Sheryl Julian
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

WATERTOWN — The Dagdelen family who owns Halva Mediterranean Grill has just made the move from a small former diner near Watertown Square, which they opened three years ago, into a space three times the size, only a few streets away.

On opening night two weeks ago, when you'd expect a bit of chaos, espe-

WHAT SHE'S HAVING

cially with a jump from 45 seats to 130, the large room was packed with diners, with an hour's wait for a table (no reservations are taken). Things were going so smoothly in the dining room it looked like it might have been the set of a ballet. Waiters crisscrossed the room effortlessly. Servers we'd never seen popped up at our table to refill water glasses and ask if we needed anything.

HALVA, Page G2



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Halva serves Turkish dishes meant for sharing, including the Halva mix family platter with beef, chicken, liver, kebabs, kofte, veggies, and rice.

Moona gets a bigger space in a new neighborhood. The results remain reliable.

DEVRA FIRST

RESTAURANT REVIEW ★★★



At Moona, you'll want to start with the hummus. This is not the gritty spackle purchased in tubs at the grocery store, in flavors like roasted garlic, red pepper, or — unholyest of unholies — *chocolate*. That is not hummus. That is not hummus! And if that is all you know of hummus, Moona is here to stage an intervention.

Opened at the start of 2026, the
MOONA, Page G3



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Baboussa dessert with labneh mousse, almond tuile, and plum rosemary sorbet at Moona.

Inside

RECIPES

BACK TO SCHOOL BITES

Whole grain blueberry pancakes, crispy chicken cutlets, and an unfussy broccoli and rice casserole.

G5

GETTING SALTY

TWICE THE FUN

Cape Cod Winery's Erika Orlandella on hosting marriage proposals, annual Christmas-tree lighting

G3

Beloved Rockport restaurant releases fund-raiser cookbook

At the very tip of Bearskin Neck, where the land reaches out into Rockport Harbor, sits My Place by the Sea. For 30 years, the restaurant has drawn a loyal following — not only for its sweeping water views, local seafood, thoughtful wine list, and secret herb bread, but also for its genuinely warm, welcoming spirit.

Late last year, owners Kathy Milbury (chef) and Barbara Stavropoulos (front of house) captured it all in their cookbook, “My Place by the Sea: A Slice of Heaven,” with help from Nick Hafey and food and arts writer Amy Allen.

Writing the cookbook took on even more meaning after Milbury’s young niece was diagnosed with Diamond-Blackfan anemia, a rare blood disorder. That diagnosis turned the book project into a fund-raiser, with 100 percent of proceeds going to Dana-Farber Cancer Institute and the Jimmy Fund.

In addition to the recipes and photography, the cookbook incorporates the owners’ personal memories from their tight-knit community. There’s the birthday party thrown for a young employee who had no plans to

celebrate. Another about Milbury’s brother, who spent 12 seasons with the Boston Bruins as a player, GM, and head coach. A retelling of the night Ellen DeGeneres

and Anne Heche stopped in for dinner, and of when Stavropoulos spotted a sailboat in trouble and helped launch a water rescue. Milbury and Stavropoulos also share how they played a part in ending Rockport’s long run as a dry town.

“The book is meant to uplift people with warm stories, good food, beautiful art and photos as a celebration,” Milbury says.

Even the cover art has a story: It’s based on the painting “Rockport Harbor at Sunrise” by Judi Rotenberg, a well-known Boston artist and longtime summer resident of Rockport.

The recipes are approachable, too: warm zucchini salad with grilled shrimp, clam chowder, mussels in white wine, strawberry shortcake — and, yes, that once-secret herb bread, finally out in the open.

The cookbook is available for \$40 at myplacebythesea.org/cookbook.

ANN TRIEGER KURLAND



MY PLACE BY THE SEA

A pair of hot sauces from acclaimed local chef

Fernanda Tapia has already made her mark twice over — as co-owner of the former Comedor restaurant in Newton and as a Food Network champion who won “Chopped” twice.

Now working as a personal chef, she’s bottled up her talents with Tapi Papi hot sauces, which she makes in small batches at Hope & Main, Rhode Island’s food business incubator.

Tangy, smoky, honey-sweetened Honey Chili Sauce gets its vibrant heat from Fresno chiles, with a pinch of merken — a smoky pepper spice blend from Chile — that builds slowly and delivers subtle kick. Tapia considers it her all-purpose “daddy of hot sauces,” one to reach for again and again when seasoning anything from chicken wings, eggs, rice bowls, or cocktails. (Tapia’s website includes a handful of suggested recipes.)

“I didn’t want to make a hot sauce that would sit in the fridge for years,” Tapia says.

Tapia’s second sauce, Oomami, cranks



TAPI PAPI

up the heat and savor with a blend of pineapple, soy, black garlic, and habaneros. Spice mixes are among several other projects in the works.

Honey Chili Sauce and Oomami Sauce are \$12 for a 5-ounce bottle, available at Formaggio Kitchen, 268 Shawmut Ave., Boston, 617-350-6996; Sofra, 210 Harvard St., Allston, 617-870-7915, and 18 Belmont St., Cambridge, 617-661-3161; The Cork and Board, Centre St., Newton, 413-272-6796; Lucille Wine Shop, 776 Washington St., Lynn, 781-584-4695; and other retailers, or at tapipapi.com, which also has a store locator.

ANN TRIEGER KURLAND

Boston Public Market’s sweetest new addition

Snacking at Boston Public Market got even sweeter this summer, thanks to Gustavo Reis. The Parisian-trained pastry chef behind Reis Bakery fills his case with treats and sandwiches that merge classic French traditions with those of his native Brazil: handsomely flaky croissants and pain Suisse, petite tarts brimming with citrus curd and toasted meringue, choux au craquelin, pecan financiers dolloped with salted caramel, croque monsieur, and sandwiches built on pão de queijo, Brazil’s iconic cheese bread (prices range from \$3 to \$10).

Armed with a degree in chemistry followed by pastry training at École Ducasse in Paris, he opened his shop at the BPM in July after impressing the market’s managers with entremets (small, layered French desserts) he made for the market’s chocolate shop.

“It’s a nice community here,” says Reis. “They really helped me to open fast.”

Whenever he can, Reis incorporates other vendors’ products, such as spices from Curio Spice Co., apple juice from Red Apple Farm, and espresso from George Howell Coffee.

In the next month, he’s moving to a larger stall in the market, which will provide more counter and baking space. Once settled, Reis will add French macarons to his menu, and also start incorporating Brazilian flavors like guava, dulce de leche, passion fruit, and Canastra cheese to some of his French pastries.

Reis Bakery, Boston Public Market, 100 Hanover St., Boston, www.instagram.com/reisbakery

LISA ZWIRN



RIANY HAFEEY

Summer Shack’s free birthday lobster returns

By Janira Skrbkova

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Back by popular demand, New England seafood staple Summer Shack is offering free birthday lobster with the presentation of a valid ID. In previous years, the restaurant chain only ran the deal during September or October, but now guests can cash in any month of the year.

The offer is available starting Sept. 1 at the flagship Cambridge location. It includes a complimentary one-pound



Summer Shack’s birthday lobster makes a permanent return.

lobster, redeemable for dine-in service during lunch or dinner the day of your birthday, with no purchase necessary. Gratuity is not included. Guests are encouraged to make a reservation for their special day ahead of time to ensure that they don’t miss out.

After piloting the deal in October 2024, Summer Shack brought it back for September 2025 to commemorate the restaurant’s 25th anniversary.

In regards to offering the birthday deal year-round, Lyons Group marketing manager Tyler Hall said: “This year, we want to go larger and just really open it up. People have really loved it the past couple of years, and the energy it brings to the restaurant is a lot of fun.”

Summer Shack, 149 Alewife Brook Parkway, Cambridge, 617-520-9500, summershackrestaurant.com

Janira Skrbkova can be reached at janira.skrbkova@globe.com.

Savor Turkish dishes and hospitality at Halva

►HALVA

Continued from Page G1

I wasn’t the only one getting three-star treatment (I wrote about their former tiny spot, originally called Halva Kebab, and then became a regular there). This was happening all around us. Dagdelen family members cruised the big room, checking in on everyone.

It’s the kind of hospitality that has nothing to do with getting to know the wait staff (no introductions with names, no robotic “have you dined with us before?”). It’s professional but friendly and genial. You feel like you’re in good hands.

“We want to have customers leaving here happily,” says Ozen Dagdelen, 25, who is married to Joseph, 24, the oldest of five Dagdelen sons. They run the new place with his two brothers, Sam, 23, and Ali, 19.

“It’s true Turkish hospitality,” says restaurateur Ana Sortun of Oleana, Sarma, and Sofra Bakery, whose menus reflect 30 years traveling to Turkey and the Middle East. She also dined regularly at Halva Kebab. “They’ve been in the business all their lives,” says Sortun. “This is the new generation and I’m excited for them.”

At one time, dad Ali Dagdelen, 61, owned 15 establishments in Istanbul. Some had seating for 200 to 300, says Joseph, who worked from an early age in one or another of his father’s places.

Dad Ali, who is advising his sons, is stepping back and leaving them in charge. Son Ali is in the kitchen. Sam will eventually turn the original Halva Kebab into a breakfast place.

The large space, formerly a Not Your Average Joe’s location, has an open kitchen at one end. You can watch a cook shaping and baking pita bread, lahmacun (the Turkish spelling of lamejun), thin rounds spread with spiced ground beef, which are also made in a vegan version, and boat-shaped cheese or beef pide, a kind of folded-up flatbread.

The competence shows everywhere. When a basket of small, puffy, warm pita is empty, more appear. Entrees come with a trio of mezze: ezme, finely diced tomatoes and peppers with pomegranate sauce; red onions



Ali Dagdelen (center) with his sons (from left) Sam, Ali, Joseph, and Joseph’s wife, Ozen, serve Turkish dishes like a muhammara appetizer with warm pita (left) and pistachio halva served with Turkish ice cream.



PHOTOS BY DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

marinated in sumac; crisp small letuces mixed with whole fresh herbs. These go onto the table right after you order. “People come in hungry,” says Joseph.

Kebabs are served on lavash, a very thin flatbread, which is soaked with meat juices. A family platter comes on a big board with five kinds of meat. “We are a culture of sharing,” says Joseph. Arranged in rows are kebabs made with beef, chicken, liver, Adana (ground beef and lamb), along with kofte, ground beef patties. There’s a bowl of rice and grilled vegetables. It’s beautiful and superbly made. The menu says it serves two to three, but with mezze, it’s really enough for four.

The Dagdelens call their bar menu “zero proof,” which offers freshly made drinks and cocktails, most with fruit juices and syrups, but all without alcohol. “The decision was based on catch-

ing a trend,” says Ozen, “and providing something interesting.” A tall drink called Istanbul Sunset is made with pomegranate juice, blood orange, and rose syrup, garnished with a crunchy, paper-thin dried orange slice.

Among the array of desserts are pistachio baklava and a halva cake. In Turkey halva is made into a confection using sesame paste, and it’s also baked into a cake with semolina flour. This semolina cake with pistachios is accompanied by goat’s milk ice cream.

Dad Ali Dagdelen was raised in Gaziantep, Turkey, a city celebrated for its distinctive, historic cuisine, especially its pistachios and baklava. UNESCO named it a Creative City of Gastronomy for its culinary excellence.

After 20 years in the import-export business, Ali, who had studied agricultural engineering, became a restaurateur in Istanbul. The family came to

the United States in 2019 through the Diversity Immigrant Visa Program (also known as the Green Card Lottery). He opened Halva in Paterson, N.J., a city with a large Turkish population.

For three days they had lines out the door, then were forced to close during the pandemic lockdown. They put themselves on all the delivery apps and when the city allowed it, tented an area in the back of the restaurant, where customers could sit socially distanced. Somehow they made it through. They recently sold the business.

The Watertown restaurant came about because Ali wanted his sons to go to college in Boston. Joseph started courses, but left to work on opening, then running, Halva Kebab.

He and Ozen have a meet-cute story. Dad Ali had run into her when she was working in Brighton and he heard her speaking Turkish. She was studying to become a certified translator. The dad told his future daughter-in-law that his son was opening a restaurant in Watertown. She didn’t think anything of it until she needed a job and walked by the first Halva. She went in to inquire about waitressing.

Ozen, along with Joseph’s mother, Fatma, designed the new space, refining and updating some of Not Your Average Joe’s furniture, adding antique vases and pitchers on shelving above the bar, and artwork such as a print of the ancient Zeugma mosaic Gypsy Girl. A wall of plates greets customers at the entrance, an idea they saw at Sortun’s restaurant, Sarma.

“They’re a very inspiring family and they definitely know what they’re doing,” says Sortun. “They work so hard.”

The family chose the name Halva, says Joseph, not for the confection, but for an old adage used in Gaziantep and some regions around it, but not well known in the city.

“When food is made to perfection,” he explains, “we say, ‘it’s just like halva.’” This place is just like halva.

Halva Mediterranean Grill, 55 Main St., Watertown Square, 617-990-7899, www.halvamedigrill.com

Sheryl Julian can be reached at sheryl.julian@globe.com.

GETTING SALTY

Marriage proposals, Christmas-tree lightings, and a mermaid kitchen at this Falmouth winery



CAPE CODE WINERY

Erika Orlandella of Cape Cod Winery.

By Kara Baskin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Falmouth's Erika Orlandella, 42, quit her beer distribution job in Greater Boston to open a winery with her husband, Pete. They started slow, back in 2013: tastings from their on-property farmhouse; wine at their kitchen island. In 2021, Pete quit his software job to join the business full time.

"Neither of us come from a background of winemaking. We jumped in feet first, not really knowing what we were doing. It's been an adventure," she says.

Now, Cape Cod Winery is a local staple, complete with a pergola, a tent, and a food truck called Mermaid Kitchen. (Their rosé is also called "Mermaid Water.") Before Christmas, they host a massive tree-lighting ceremony; in the warmer months, they host proposals — but not weddings. She explains why, while also sharing her favorite hangover cure and local restaurant.

Why wine? How does someone come to make this life choice?

I question that a lot, especially this time of year.

We were living in Waltham, we both had corporate jobs, and we were just kind of like: "OK. There's got to be more to life than this." And we really loved coming to the Cape. Pete grew up coming to Hyannisport with his family and still has a lot of ties there. When we got together, I started coming down here a lot with him, fell in love with it, and this opportunity came up.

A couple had owned the winery, but it was more of a hobby for them. She's a scientist. He's a doctor and a professor. They were looking for someone to take it over, and they really took a chance on us, because they got a lot of offers. We talked to them for close to two years, off and on. They were angels on earth who just really changed our lives.

In the middle of all of this, we actually opened a deli [Falmouth's now-closed Orlandelli] while we were getting this ready, and that was just a crazy time. We did it for one summer, and we were like, "We're going crazy. Stop." We bit off a little more than we could chew.

What advice would you give to other aspiring entrepreneurs?

There were some really high highs and some really low lows. Fortunately, Pete was still at his job full time, which allowed us to slowly build this into what we wanted it to be. Patience was key. This was not an overnight success story.

Not to be blunt — but, really, to be blunt — how did you afford it?

It was an adventure. I cashed in my 401k and kind of put all of my chips in, and Pete kind of did the same. He left his job in 2021.

When we first started the winery, we started it in our kitchen, so it was really small. People were just coming in and doing tastings. I would put little cheese plates with crackers on the island. It was very intimate. We were able to talk to the customers who were coming in, get intel on what they were looking for, and that's what we built the business upon.

It just became word of mouth, and it was a lot of locals coming in and checking us out. We slowly built things outdoors as the weather got nicer, and that turned into purchasing a large tent, which is our staple. You pull in, and that's what you see. When the tent goes up for the season, it's

very exciting.

We still have a lot of people who come in and say, "I remember when I did my tasting in your kitchen," and now they're sitting in the back pergola, eight years later.

What's the Cape like in the off-season?

I love it. [Falmouth has] a huge year-round population, one of the largest. We call September "locals' summer." Everything calms down a little bit. We're able to enjoy everything that the tourists get to enjoy all summer. We cannot go to Main Street in the middle of summer. It's just crazy.

We can give everyone a break. Our staff — we have an awesome team — a lot of them are teachers, so they're all starting to go back to school, and really, the weekends will pick up. It's a nice balance, because right now, we're in a burnout state.

What do you love about being on the Cape, and what's challenging about running a business there?

You come over the bridge, you take that breath, and you just relax a little bit. A bit of weight is lifted off of your shoulders. I would say the toughest part is the spring season. We don't really get a spring. It's an extension of winter, and it's very dark and gray and windy.

The tourism swing of summer to fall to winter to spring is huge, so we have to budget for the winter and spring months when we have minimal income coming in. I would say that's the biggest challenge for any Cape business.

Which local restaurants do you love?

There's one in Falmouth on Main Street that's our all-time favorite: Osteria La Civetta.

I love it so much. You step in, and you feel like you're stepping into Italy.

Give me some colorful stories about things that have happened at the winery. Any memorable moments?

We just had a proposal this past weekend.

Does someone tell you ahead of time, or does it take you by surprise?

It's 50-50. Sometimes, they'll call and want to plan something really special, so we'll do something in the bottom of the vines. It's a little bit more private there.

My favorite is when it's not so super planned. There are lots of little nooks and crannies that you can find here that make a really nice backdrop, and you can have a moment.

My favorite event is our Christmas tree-lighting, and that's every Thanksgiving weekend. Tickets sell out within 30 seconds every year. We make a little Hallmark Channel Christmas enchantment village within the winery. Summer staff come to help decorate, and it's become kind of a community event, too.

We've partnered with Tommy's Place in Falmouth, a vacation home for children who are battling cancer. It's a week-long, all-expenses-paid vacation for the family, and it gives them a break from the stress of their everyday life. There's a home in Falmouth, and then they actually just opened up a second home in Centerville, and we've sponsored the kitchen in the Centerville home. We use a 75-foot cedar tree on our property, and every year, we just make it a little bigger and bigger. It's fun; a feel-good event.

On a different note: biggest disaster that you've ever had at the winery? Has anything ever gone awry?

Oh, yes. So the tents that I was

mentioning earlier? One of the first years that we had it, there was a crazy storm coming in, but it was kind of underplayed. It's the middle of the night. We go outside and find the tent completely torn and out of the ground, plastered to the hedgerow. We were like: "Are we in the Wizard of Oz right now?" The tent was going everywhere, and we're standing there, not knowing what to do. That was a disastrous, fun moment. But we fixed it. Everything worked out to be fine.

We no longer do weddings. We just do rehearsal dinners. The pressure! I don't care how relaxed a bride says that she is. It's: "Hey, I want you to pull this tree out right here. It's really going to ruin my photos," or, "Can you gut out your barn and put in central air-conditioning so that we can get ready here?"

The property is very rustic. It's an 1800s property. That's not our vibe. We basically want people to come in and feel like they're hanging out in their own backyard with their friends or family.

Tell me a little bit about your wine.

Our vineyard is still very young. We make all of our wines but are sourcing our grapes right now from the East and West Coast. Eventually, we will use our grapes along with our cranberry and blueberry wines, which we already sell. The grapes growing here will be more acidic than what you're used to from, say, a California Sauvignon Blanc. So we're going to blend them with our fruit wines. The acidic wines will balance them out a little bit.

[In the meantime], we get all of our resources from local vineyards who use the same ones. A lot of us use the same vineyards; everyone helps each other out. It's not so competitive, especially [wineries] on the Cape. We're hoping our vineyards will be ready next year. This year, weather-wise, they did really well. The rain was good. If we have another season like that next summer, we should be able to harvest in the fall 2027.

Maybe this is a silly question, but: Did you already know how to make wine? Not everybody could just buy a winery.

Pete and I tried to be the winemakers, and it was horrible. We failed so badly. We did a full season with the previous owners, and they taught us a lot. Then we tried to do it on our own, and that was a failure. Now, we have winemakers who come in and do everything, which is amazing, because that is not our forte. Our forte is running the other side of the business — the wine bar, shop, and food truck.

Tell me about this truck.

It's called Mermaid Kitchen. It doesn't move. It's a way to allow people to stay and have another glass of wine. It's a lot of shareables: charcuterie, flatbreads, scratch-made dips — hummus, a cheese spread, a whipped feta dip. The flatbreads are a big seller, and our chicken tenders and French fries are our number-one-selling item.

What's your favorite wine?

My favorite wine varies. It's between rosé and Sauvignon Blanc.

Do you have a favorite hangover cure?

In the summer, it's jumping in the ocean. It totally works. Then, a little hair of the dog.

Interview was edited for clarity.

Kara Baskin can be reached at kara.baskin@globe.com. Follow her @kcbaskin.

New location, same lovely hospitality and flavors at Moona

►MOONA

Continued from Page G1

Central Square restaurant serves a menu built around Middle Eastern flavors and New England seasons. (It is a successor to the original Moona in Inman Square, set to close when its lease ends next year.) Most of the offerings are mezze, the kind of small plates servers like to tell you are "perfect for sharing" but often aren't at all. Here, in fact, they are — piquant bites like olives and pickles, spreads served with fresh-baked pita, salads and skewers easily divvied, and a few large plates to showcase the likes of lamb shanks and whole fish.

Order the hummus bil fitr, with tender brown mushrooms in a pool of olive oil. It may look a bit like store-bought hummus, but one taste reveals this is the real deal: a puree that is delicate, silky, and smooth, the kind of dish that lasts out centuries and inspires heated debates over which culture it truly belongs to. That answer is complicated, divisive, impossible to reach. We might argue over it forever. Hummus belongs to the people, all of whom deserve to eat it in peace.

This you can certainly do at Moona, where the hospitality is as warm as the pita, the cocktails are always good, and the menu is filled with dishes that sound so delicious it's hard to choose.

One midsummer Monday night, there are plenty of reservation time slots available. I pick one and head over. But when I walk into the room, with its deep turquoise paint and modern art from around the Arabic world illuminated by lantern-like pendant lights, the tables are full.

It's the mark of an appreciated neighborhood restaurant. Diners plan to come here for a Saturday night out. But the people who live and work in the area also just drop by — for an after-work drink, a spontaneous dinner, a reliably good time.

My calendar currently has three separate alerts set, reminding me when to try for reservations at various restaurants around town. I miss just dropping by. And I love a reliably good time.

A promising lead-in: one of Moona's cocktails, some of which are made without alcohol. At least half the tables order a Fezcal, a magenta-hued smoke show of mezcal, pomegranate, and Aperol, inflected with cardamom and lime. It's the restaurant's most popular drink, our server tells us, and it's a beauty. (There's a nonalcoholic version, too, called the Fez.) On another visit, I try the Lebanese 75, Moona's riff on the French gin-and-Champagne drink, made with pisco, sparkling chenin blanc, and arak, its strong anise flavor dominating. I like it even better than the Fezcal. The wine list includes many selections from Moona owner Mohamad El Zein's native Lebanon.

It's a delight to visit the restaurant with vegetarians, ordering a



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Shish tawook, served with baharat rubbed chicken thighs, pomegranate, toum, and saffron rice.

meatless meal everyone can enjoy. Pickled vegetables and olives. Pull-apart rolls dusted in za'atar. Stuffed grape leaves and loubia b'zeit, green beans cooked with saucy smoked tomatoes underscored with the smoky flavor of Urfa pepper, showered in crumbles of akkawi cheese, which looks a bit like feta but tastes milder. Very good falafel, the spheres crisp and not at all mushy in the middle the way too many versions are, with tahini, the garlic sauce toum, and green chile.

Every few months, the menu shifts with the seasons. Right now, it's all light and bright and end-of-summer-y: mafghoussa, a Palestinian dish of smashed vegetables, made with summer squash; bateekh w jebneh, a mix of watermelon, cantaloupe, honeydew, and slivered shallots, topped with akkawi and mint; fattoush salad with smashed cucumbers. Shish tawook, grilled chicken skewers, pairs well with the vegetable dishes. And then there is the whole fish! It's an almost meditative pleasure, picking the grilled dorade to the bone, savoring its moist, mild flesh against lemon and herbs.

For dessert, there's basboussa, labneh mousse and rosemary-plum sorbet offsetting the dryness of the cake they accompany. Even better is decadent chocolate ganache surrounded by fluffy Arabic coffee mousse, with sour cherry, nigella seed, Urfa pepper, and coarse salt. With its balanced counterpoint of flavors, it wins over this not-so-much-a-chocolate-dessert-person for the night.

Not every visit is equally satisfying. (A new chef, who will also introduce a long-awaited cafe program, is stepping in soon.) One night, fried potatoes with feta and red chile might be more soggy than crisp. Another, dishes are unexpectedly spicy, when there's nothing in the description to indicate this will be the case. A lamb shank is graced with a winning combination of date molasses, nutty freekeh, parsley, and almonds, but the meat might be dry. Vanilla muhallabieh, the pudding served with shortbread, berries, and Meyer lemon granita, can be just a little too vanilla. With more granita and berries, the dessert would be a standout.

But even on an off night, a meal here is pleasant. After all, we have Lebanese 75s, hummus bil fitr, and each other.

The Inman Square Moona is tiny and intimate. This new Moona is several times bigger, yet it still pulls off a feeling of intimacy. In part it's the layout, clustered tables and booths in a long, narrow space that turns a corner, leading to a bar all the way at the end. In part it's the warmth of the staff. In part it's the menu, genuinely satisfying to share. But mostly it's the whole experience, which adds up to a reliably good time even with a few bumps along the way.

MOONA ★★ ★

750 Main St., Central Square, Cambridge, 617-665-5915, www.moonarestaurant.com

Wheelchair accessible.

Prices Small plates \$7-\$25. Large plates \$36-\$48. Desserts \$3-\$14. Cocktails \$16-\$17.

Hours Sun 5-9:30 p.m., Mon-Thu 5-10:30 p.m., Fri-Sat 5-11 p.m.

Noise level Conversation easy, unless you're seated right beneath the speakers beside the bathroom.

★★★★★ Extraordinary | ★★★★ Excellent | ★★★ Very good | ★★ Good | ★ Fair | (No stars) Poor

Devra First can be reached at devra.first@globe.com. Follow her on Instagram @devra_first.

WHERE THE APPLE NERDS GO APPLE PICKING



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

WHERE TO FIND ART IN THE ORCHARD (AND RASPBERRIES)

"Apples [have] been intertwined with human beings forever, for hundreds and hundreds of years," said writer, sculptor, and orchard grower Linda Hoffman of **Old Frog Pond Farm & Studio** (above) in Harvard. "There's just something about apples."

Hoffman moved out to the abandoned orchard in 2001, and took on the hardy challenge of organic apple growing. But this past spring's frost snap damaged Hoffman's orchard, so she will not offer apple picking this year. Instead, she expects to sell apples and cider at her farm stand. Her Certified Organic raspberry

patch, however, had a banner year, and will pick until frost. During what Hoffman calls a "sabbatical" year for the apples, visitors may wander a 50-sculpture installation that winds through the woods and around the pond. This year's theme is "The Art of Noticing."

Hoffman said the work of tree pruning offers a symbolic symmetry.

"It's that removing of what no longer serves," she said. "When we prune, we always try to identify a central leader, so that everything else that comes out is oriented around what is most important."

Old Frog Pond Farm & Studio, 38 Eldridge Road, Harvard, www.oldfrogpond-farm.com



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

WHERE TO GET GREAT CIDER DOUGHNUTS

What makes an ideal cider doughnut? The ingredients are more than just batter and fry oil: it's also crisp fall air and the perfume of fermenting apples.

But it's also the batter.

Chelcie Martin, co-owner of **Honey Pot Hill Orchards** in Stow, said that the farm is one of the few that presses its own cider each week with their own apples, and includes that cider in the doughnut mix.

"They're fluffy and delicious, but I think one of the most special things about them is that they're real apple cider doughnuts with real apple cider in them that we press here on site, which I think is rad," she said.

This year, the farm celebrates its 100th year. Martin said this season, she's excited about a few newer apple varieties, including CrimsonCrisp and Pixie Crunch.

Honey Pot Hill Orchards, 138 Sudbury Road, Stow, 978-562-5666, www.honeypothill.com



BLUSHING GOLDEN



KANDIL SINAP



WHERE TO TASTE NEW VARIETIES

Commercial-focused apple breeders continue to race to create new apple color, texture, and flavor, nailing down trademarks and brands to match. The Honeycrisp transformed the field, as the high-grossing but challenging-to-grow apple thrilled eaters and flummoxed farmers. It continues to drive imitation and iteration.

David Bedford, who helped breed the Honeycrisp at the University of Minnesota, said that the team has been at work on a project called Superior Fruit Innovations, a model that will license apples direct to orchards. Next year, the program's first trees will be planted: Get ready for "Big Flirt" and "Super Snap."

"They come from some of our best genetic material," he said.

Here in Massachusetts, **Shelburne Farm** owner Ted Painter has continued to expand his Stow orchard's range, which includes both a deep bench of heirloom apples, but also some newcomers. This season will welcome his first fruiting of SnapDragon, a Honeycrisp offshoot bred at Cornell University.

"I think it's aptly named, and I think it has a very nice balance between sweet and tart," said Painter. "I've heard people say it has monster crunch."

Honeycrisp fans can also look for CrimsonCrisp, another similarly crunchy apple with less assertive sugar, as well as Autumn Crisp, and Red Rubens at Shelburne Farm.

Painter said that customer curiosity and interest has increased recently.

"The internet is many things, but I think it has done a lot to just expose people to new ideas, and then they get curious when they come here: 'Can I actually find this thing I read about?'" he said.

Among the trees, the answer is probably yes.

Shelburne Farm, 106 West Acton Road, Stow, 978-897-9287, www.shelburnefarm.com



WHERE TO BECOME AN APPLE EXPERT (AND TRY WILD APPLES)

If you want to learn about apples, you'd do well to talk to Matt Kaminsky, who goes by the moniker Gnarly Pippins. Right now, he's helping Joshua's Trust, a Mansfield, Conn.-based land trust, revitalize their antique orchard.

"Pippin" is slang for a wild apple tree, said Kaminsky, a resilient seedling deposited by wildlife.

"That describes what I do in a nutshell," he said.

"I really revere wild apples. I think that they make the finest hard cider in all the land, and they possess sort of the skeleton key of the future of orcharding in a climate-unstable future."

His advice, if you'd like to join a national gathering of pomology nerds, is to head to Franklin County **CiderDays**, a three-day symposium and celebration taking place Nov. 6-8 around Shelburne Falls.

"There are events, tastings, and sales, and just

A living museum of apples

By Lindsay Crudele
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Often, while striding between the fledgling limbs of the antique apple trees for which she cares, Leslie Duthie sings to herself.

"Give me spots on my apples, but leave me the birds and the bees," she sings, recalling the famous line from Joni Mitchell's song "Big Yellow Taxi."

Duthie, a retired horticultural

tourist, has become the prime steward of the New England Botanic Garden at Tower Hill's orchard, a living museum of rare and often local apples. A bout of blight took down 20 years of growth, and in her hands, a new one is now five years recovered. The trees originated with Worcester County Horticultural Society trustee Stearns Lothrop Davenport in the 1930s, charged with rooting out "rogue" apples amid

commercial varieties, until he realized that he might be cutting down the last of their kind. Instead, he assembled an orchard that would preserve them.

"I know every tree," she said. "They have been my children."

After 50 years designing and maintaining native gardens, Duthie felt her body and her schedule needed a break. Volunteering at Tower Hill

seemed like a way to stay in touch with her passion, and at first she just maintained a native meadow planting alongside the orchard. She planted a low grass meadow and flowers: black-eyed Susans, goldenrod, and coneflower. In spring, Duthie said golden groundsel, golden Alexander, and Penstemon dapple the landscape.

But then she began to study apples, and her role grew alongside the orchard.



LINDSAY CRUDELE FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Leslie Duthie reaches up to grab an apple at Tower Hill.



CALVILLE
BLANC



ASHMEAD'S
KERNEL

PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF



WHERE TO TASTE OLD (OR UNUSUAL) APPLES

About 60 of 80 varieties of apple grown at Bolton's **Nashoba Valley Winery** (a few shown here at left) are considered heirloom, according to Justin Pelletier, the farm's chief operating officer. To visit Nashoba's heirloom collection, Pelletier sends out weekly emails alerting subscribers to weekly picking tours. Each week in season, Pelletier will lead groups for picking visits through the collection.

"It's pretty cool to be able to see something that's not going to be found in the grocery store, and right off of the tree," said Pelletier.

Heirloom apples often lack the counter appeal of perfectly round, red commercially grown apples — and they can be harder to grow. A russet apple, for instance, with its mottled skin, can more resemble a potato than a *pomme*. But Pelletier thinks they taste better.

On Nashoba's antique trees, pickers will find baking-friendly Rhode Island Greenings, Roxbury Russets, and pink-fleshed Almatas.

At **Owl Rock Farm** in Harvard, small-scale apple farmer Nathan Aldrich has revitalized an orchard once used for Veryfine apple juice production. Through the process of "top-working," Aldrich transforms old McIntosh and Cortland trees by grafting unusual varieties to them. Aldrich now counts 54 varieties of apple across 12 acres, historic New England types unlikely to be found elsewhere.

In an orchard-heavy part of the state, Aldrich said the niche for hayrides and petting zoos is covered. Instead, a visit to Owl Rock Farm is for those curious to discover forgotten varieties.

"I'm still growing great big old trees that you can get lost in, that feels like a forest as you walk around," he said. "Each variety is its own sort of special event."

Nashoba Valley Winery, 100 Wataquodock Hill Road, Bolton, 978-779-5521, www.nashobawinery.com

Owl Rock Farm, 168 Bolton Road, Harvard, 351-209-0017, www.owlrock-farm.com

WHERE TO MAKE A DAY OF IT

A trip to the farm is a bushel of fun when you combine apple picking with hayrides, animal encounters, and corn mazes. And in Massachusetts, the "agritourism" tradition has been boosted by **Smolak Farms** manager Michael Smolak Jr., whose advisory work includes a seat on the state's Special Commission on Agriculture.

Agritourism can make pick-your-own season even more fruitful for farm businesses during their short and vital harvest season, and it's the stuff of cherished family memories for guests. At Smolak's own family farm in North Andover, now in its 99th year, this season looks like a model for the format.

"You get out in the country, you breathe the fresh air, it is the quintessential house with the rolling fields and the rolling orchards and the pond in the front and all that kind of stuff," he said. It's a beautiful place to be."

The 125-acre farm includes 20 acres of apples, alongside prolific blueberry and cut flower areas this year. Smolak's ideas this year for fun on the farm have included comedy night, speed dating, oysters, and Mahjong. Events run until Christmas, when the New England Saint Bernard Club brings their pack of canines to the farm for pats, photos, and help delivering trees to cars.

Smolak Farms, 315 S. Bradford St., North Andover, 978-682-6332, www.smolakfarms.com



like a big kind of hullabaloo at basically every orchard in Franklin County," explained Kaminsky. The weekend is packed with free apple tastings and lectures, including a Saturday keynote by noted apple historian Daniel Bussey. Kaminsky kicks off the weekend with his own Wild and Seedling Pomological Exhibition, where you can taste upward of 200 wild apple types from across the continent.

It matters, he said, because we've grown apart from understanding how plants work — and how food reaches the table — through the consolidation of industrialized agriculture.

"Apples were one of the first things to lose this rich biodiversity, which allows us to associate crop variety with a place and a name and a story," he said. Relearning those stories helps heal that fracture.

"[It was] no trademarks, no gimmicks, all open source, and just people saying, 'Oh yeah, my neighbor's tree is pretty good. You want to take a few twigs? Here you go,' he said. 'I wish to reignite that tradition.'"

CiderDays 2026 runs Nov. 6-8. Visit www.ciderdays.org for event schedules and more information.

Now, Duthie grafts, nurtures, weeds, and prunes the trees, as well as works on a DNA indexing project to help identify the often esoteric fruit.

"Most of our trees are varieties that no one's ever heard of," said Duthie.

Duthie points out Benoni, a crisp, tart dappled apple first found in Dedham. There's also Crow Egg, Geeveston Fanny, and Rambo.

Duthie calls herself a "seed-aholic," and she wears a tattoo on her arm of a fern she once hybridized via spore. But cultivated apples are grafted, not

grown from seed (and cannot be continued via traditional seed banks). Working in the orchard was a chance to branch out.

In order to make fruit that resembles its parent, pieces of the tree called "scions" are grafted to sturdy rootstock; the tree will grow fruit possessing characteristics of the grafted portion. Tracking down scions is sometimes part of Duthie's fun.

While Duthie said she does not manage the orchard for large-scale fruit production, the antique varieties, some dat-

ing back to 1598, represent an uncommon example of agricultural diversity — something often lost in modern industrial farming.

"This is certainly our early agricultural heritage here," said Duthie, "and as a botanic garden, there is nothing more important that we can do than save these apples."

New England Botanic Garden at Tower Hill, 11 French Drive, Boylston, 508-869-6111, www.nebg.org. Visitors are welcome to wander the gardens; see the website for more information.

BACK TO SCHOOL RECIPES

WHAT TO COOK THIS WEEK

Whole-Grain Blueberry Pancakes

Makes about 14 pancakes or enough to serve 4-6

If you want to provide a nourishing breakfast for your kids or need a dependable, healthful pancake batter for lazy weekends, make a batch of these rounds with whole-wheat flour, oats, and yogurt. An electric griddle on the counter will come in handy, but you really only need a large stovetop griddle or nonstick skillet, preferably cast iron or carbon steel. After you ladle the batter into the pan, sprinkle them with fresh or frozen blueberries (on another day, try other chopped fruits such as strawberries, mangoes, or apples). With the various current produce recalls, be choosy about your blueberries; buy fresh local berries or frozen wild Maine blueberries. If you want to do some prep the night before, don't make the whole batter. Instead, assemble the dry ingredients in a bowl and leave on the counter; whisk liquid ingredients in another bowl and refrigerate. Serve the pancakes right away as they come off the pan or keep them warm in a low oven until they're all done. They go with pure maple syrup, of course.

- 1 cups whole-wheat flour
- 1/2 cup old-fashioned rolled oats (not quick-cooking)
- 1 teaspoons baking powder
- 1/2 teaspoon baking soda
- 1/4 teaspoon salt
- 1 tablespoon sugar



SALLY PASLEY VARGAS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

- 2 eggs
- 1 cup plain Greek yogurt
- 3/4 cup low-fat or whole milk
- 3 tablespoons canola oil or melted butter
- Canola oil or butter (for the pan)
- 1 cups fresh or frozen blueberries
- 1/2 Pure maple syrup (for serving)

1. In a bowl large enough to hold all the ingredients, whisk the flour, oats, baking powder, baking soda, salt, and sugar until thoroughly blended.
2. In another bowl, whisk the eggs. Whisk in the yogurt, milk, and oil or butter.
3. Pour the egg mixture into the flour mixture. Stir just to blend the ingredients so no clumps of flour remain. Do not overmix. Let the batter rest at room temperature for about 10 minutes.
4. If you're planning to keep the pancakes warm after cooking

each batch, set the oven at 250 degrees and place a large rimmed baking sheet in the oven.

5. Heat a large griddle or nonstick skillet over medium heat. Brush with a little oil or butter, as needed.

6. Stir the batter once or twice. If it seems too thick, add 1 or 2 tablespoons more milk. Using a 1/4-cup measure or a ladle, spoon about 1/4 cup of batter onto the griddle or skillet, fitting about 4 pancakes in the pan. Sprinkle with blueberries. Cook for 3 to 5 minutes, or until there are bubbles on the surface of the rounds and the undersides are golden. Use a wide metal spatula to turn the pancakes. Cook for 1 to 2 minutes, or until light golden on the undersides. (Total cooking time is 4 to 7 minutes.) If keeping warm, transfer the pancakes to the baking sheet in the oven. Repeat with the remaining batter.

7. Serve with maple syrup.

Lisa Zwirn

Broccoli Rice Casserole

Serves 4

When my children were small, my husband made this broccoli rice casserole on repeat for a long period. It's popular in the Midwest and South. It was all my kids wanted to eat every night for years, and it might suit your kids, too. There's nothing fancy or fussy about the meal — think of it as an alternative to mac and cheese. Combine a creamy cheese sauce, a starchy carb, and just enough vegetables to create the illusion of winning at parenthood. We like to add leftover chicken if there is any, but the dish is just fine as is. Mix long-grain white rice (you don't need to cook it before you bake the dish), a white cheddar sauce, and fresh or frozen broccoli, and bake until golden. Parents and adventurous littles may want a generous dash of hot sauce. My kids smile when we offer this dish now. Nostalgia for their childhood.

- 3 tablespoons butter
- 1 small onion, finely chopped



KAROLINE BOEHM GOODNICK FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

- 1 rib celery, finely chopped
- 3 tablespoons flour
- 1 cup half and half
- 1 1/4 cups water
- 8 ounces (2 cups) shredded white cheddar cheese
- Salt and pepper, to taste
- 3 cups fresh or frozen broccoli florets, cut into bite-sized pieces
- 3/4 cup uncooked long-grain white rice

1. Set the oven at 375 degrees. Have on hand an 8-inch square baking dish or another dish with

a 2-quart capacity.

2. In a large skillet over medium heat, melt the butter. Add the onion and celery. Cook, stirring often, for 5 to 7 minutes, or until they soften. Add the flour and cook, stirring constantly, for 3 to 5 minutes, or until light golden brown.

3. Add the half and half and water to the skillet. Cook, stirring and scraping the bottom of the pan, until the mixture comes to a boil. Lower the heat and simmer, stirring often, for 5 to 7 minutes, or until the mixture thickens.

4. Add 1 1/2 cups of the cheese and a pinch each of salt and pepper. Stir until the cheese melts. Remove from the heat. Add the broccoli and uncooked rice. Stir well.

5. Transfer to the baking dish. Smooth the top with a rubber spatula. Cover tightly with foil.

6. Bake for 35 minutes. Remove the foil. Sprinkle the remaining 1/2 cup cheese on top. Return to the oven and continue baking for 10 minutes, or until golden brown and bubbling at the edges. (Total baking time is 45 minutes.) Spoon onto plates.

Karoline Boehm Goodnick

Chicken Cutlets with Crispy Parmesan Crumbs

Serves 4

Who doesn't love a dish that promises to be crispy and crunchy? That's enough of a reason to make this baked chicken. To save time, buy thinly cut chicken cutlets. A package that weighs slightly under 1 1/2 pounds should give you four to six cutlets, enough for four people. Mix two kinds of breadcrumbs with an egg yolk, mustard, and paprika for a flavorful coating. Press the crumbs onto both sides of the chicken and bake on a rimmed sheet for about 15 minutes. Turn, sprinkle with Parmesan, and bake again, just long enough for the cheese to melt and the cutlets to turn golden brown. This one will go into your repertoire as a weeknight dinner for kids of all ages.

COATING

- 1 egg yolk
- 1 tablespoon Dijon mustard
- 3 tablespoons olive oil
- 1/2 teaspoon sweet paprika
- 1/4 teaspoon salt
- 1 1/2 teaspoons black pepper
- 1 cup panko breadcrumbs
- 1 cup fine dry breadcrumbs

1. In a medium bowl, whisk the egg yolk, mustard, olive oil, paprika, salt, and pepper until smooth.
2. Add the panko and fine breadcrumbs. Stir until the crumbs are coated with the seasoning.



SALLY PASLEY VARGAS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

CUTLETS

- 1 1/2 pounds (4 to 6) thin-sliced boneless, skinless chicken breasts (cutlets)
- 4 tablespoons olive oil (2 for brushing chicken, 2 for the baking sheet)
- 6 tablespoons finely grated fresh Parmesan cheese
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley
- 1 lemon, cut into wedges (for serving)

1. Adjust an oven rack to the top third of the oven. Set the oven at 425 degrees. Place a rimmed baking sheet on the top third of the oven. Line a second rimmed baking sheet with parchment paper. Have on hand an extra sheet of parchment.
2. Place the chicken cutlets on the parchment-lined sheet. Brush the tops with olive oil, using about 1 tablespoon. Spread about 3 tablespoons of the crumbs over each cutlet. Lay a piece of parchment

on top and press firmly. (The parchment keeps the crumbs from sticking to your hands.) Use tongs to carefully turn the cutlets over. Brush again with the remaining 1 tablespoon oil. Sprinkle with crumbs; cover with parchment and press again. Remove the parchment.

3. Remove the hot baking sheet from the oven. Sprinkle the remaining 2 tablespoons olive oil on the hot baking sheet. Carefully tilt the pan to coat the bottom with oil. Place the chicken cutlets on the sheet. Bake for 12 to 15 minutes, or until lightly browned.

4. Remove the pan from the oven. With a large spatula, turn the cutlets over and sprinkle each with 1 tablespoon Parmesan. Return to the oven for 6 to 8 minutes, or until the cheese melts and the cutlets are golden brown. (Total baking time is 18 to 23 minutes.)

5. Transfer the cutlets to a platter. Sprinkle with parsley and serve with lemon.

Sally Pasley Vargas



UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

LOSING TOUCH BY CJ TAN | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

ACROSS

1 Measured with a stopwatch

6 It still means "move smoothly" when its first letter is changed to "G"

11 Papa sheep

14 Love to pieces

15 Sanctuary

16 Mama sheep

17 *Bestie, for instance

19 Kiss

20 2023 role for Ryan, Simu, Ncuti and other men

21 Musical McCartney

22 Yawn inducer

23 *One with intense cravings for sweets

27 Dutch beer brand

31 Some noble Brits

32 Piece of beach headwear

33 *Unusual discovery

36 Archipelago part

37 Heat in the microwave

38 1998 Sarah McLachlan hit

39 *Indicator of danger in the ocean

42 Email again

44 "Watch and ____"

45 They're just in the background

46 *Airport or cafe amenity

49 Military force

50 Las Vegas WNBA team

51 Structure that forms a reservoir

DOWN

1 Bulletin board fastener

2 Inactive

3 What humans last visited in 1972

4 Med. drama settings

5 Unilluminated area of the ocean

6 (Dunno)

7 Boxing champion Ali

8 "Now ____ seen it all!"

9 Lion's lair

10 Conclusion

11 Think again

12 Breakthrough Prize in Mathematics, e.g.

13 6-7, for one

18 Crack in Earth's crust

22 Capital of Northern Ireland

24 ____ the rewards

25 A long way

26 Outrage

27 Thrift shop caveat

28 Baby food texture

29 Andy Samberg or Will Ferrell

30 As a result

54 Ran out of Uno cards first, say

55 *1925 Gershwin composition named for a key

59 Ostrich relative

60 Similar

61 Justice Kagan

62 Seis menos cuatro

63 Occasions for cakes, for short

64 Romantic outings

33 Jogged or sprinted

34 Singer and activist Simone

35 Some adoptive parents

37 Element I thought was alphabetically last for a while

40 ____-El (Superman's birth name)

41 It follows Thu.

42 Recommend for an open role

43 "I Forgot That You ____" (Taylor Swift song)

46 Short sell?

47 Outlandish

48 Slushy drinks

49 Blown away

51 Meal plan

52 Author Rice

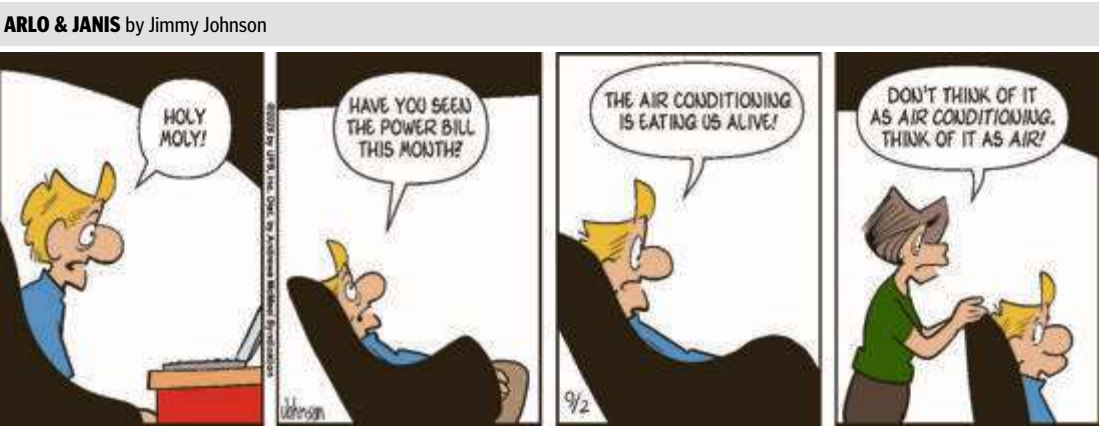
53 Degr. for playwrights

55 "Cash ____" (trivia game show set inside a taxi)

56 Antiquated

57 Director DaCosta

58 Greeting in Sao Paulo



JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt 9-2-26

CLUE

1. Make beloved

5. Propose

6. Once more

7. Beat

ANSWER

DAENRE

EFFRO

NIAGA

FDTAE

CLUE

1. Wed in secret

2. Let air out of

3. Land

4. Nest-building insect

ANSWER

OPELDE

EADLTE

REAGAE

NTRHEO

CLUE: The first regularly scheduled commercial airline flight took place in ____ in 1914.

BONUS

How to play

Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

ANSWERS: 1A-Defeat 2D-Average 3D-Defeat 4D-Hornet 5A-Again 6A-Defeat 7A-Defeat

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Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

TV CRITIC'S CORNER

BY MATT JUUL



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Paul Giamatti (pictured last month in Cambridge) was at Fenway Park Monday with his “Rhinoceros” costars.

Giamatti goes viral for exuberant reaction to play at Fenway Park

Like the rest of Red Sox Nation, Paul Giamatti was pretty pumped after Roman Anthony's game-tying slide at Fenway Park on Monday night.

The New England native and Oscar-nominated actor, who's appearing in the American Repertory Theater's production of “Rhinoceros,” was in attendance for the series-opening matchup between Boston and the Seattle Mariners. Joined by costars John Turturro, Tatiana Maslany, and Clay Singer, a Red Sox-hat-wearing Giamatti ended up making the NESN broadcast for his exuberant reaction to Anthony's slick slide at home plate to tie the game in the ninth inning following a sacrifice fly by Ced-danne Rafaela.

Giamatti got a shoutout from NESN play-by-play announcer Dave O'Brien during a replay of the actor's reaction to the slide shown during the 10th inning, with O'Brien noting how the star's late father, A. Bartlett Giamatti, was a former MLB commissioner.

The Sox ended up completing the comeback, winning the game 9-8 in extra innings thanks to a bases loaded single in the 10th inning by Trevor Story. And

while the game-winning hit was certainly a highlight from Monday's action, fans and commentators online couldn't get enough of the video clip showing Giamatti's reaction to Anthony's slide in the previous inning.

“Paul Giamatti should have this seat at Fenway reserved for him for the rest of the season after the comeback last night,” wrote sports journalist Joon Lee on X.

“Paul Giamatti next flag waver for Bruins playoffs pls,” another X user wrote.

Others online poked fun over the fact that Giamatti's viral moment occurred at the same game as “Heated Rivalry” night at Fenway Park.

“The fact that Paul Giamatti and John Turturro were both at Heated Rivalry Night with us is slaying me,” wrote one X user.

Giamatti and the “Rhinoceros” cast weren't the only stars in attendance, as Rachel Reid, the author behind the “Game Changers” books that inspired the steamy hockey show, also made an appearance at Fenway Park for “Heated Rivalry” night.

Matt Juul can be reached at matthew.juul@globe.com.

Q. My sister suffered a catastrophic medical event and was put on life support. When we arrived at the hospital, we were shocked to find that my 33-year-old nephew had the hospital put a “block” on my sister's chart that forbade us from seeing her unless he was there.

When he was 20 years old, he sent me an email telling me how he hated me and our entire family because we wouldn't help them financially.

My sister had filed bankruptcy two times and raised him with the help of the state welfare system. She told him that when my children were in college that she helped put them through college and I haven't lifted a finger to help. These were lies. There are so many more lies that she told him. I thought that I had proven to him that none of what she told him was the truth.

We finally convinced him to take the restriction off so we could see my sister, and we sat vigil with her. He was there maybe 10 percent of the time. After my sister was taken off of life support, we made the decision to return home the very next day.

Eight days after my sister's death, I found out he had not made any arrangements for her cremation and he had given instructions to the staff at the hospital that they were not allowed to speak to me regarding the disposition of my sister's body, and I had to speak to him directly.

What, if anything, am I supposed to do with all this? My family wants me to kick him to the curb for how he treated me during this tragic time. I am his only relative. Do I have any responsibility to him?

ANXIOUS AUNT

Recent sightings on Cape Cod (through Aug. 25) as reported to Mass Audubon.

After several years of presumed breeding activity by swallow-tailed kites on the Upper Cape, birders finally got proof in the form of two recently fledged juveniles being fed by two adults in Cotuit. A Mississippi kite was also seen in the same location.

Birds at Race Point in Provincetown included 4 black vultures, a Baird's sandpiper, a black tern, 250 roseate terns, 40 Wilson's

ASKING ERIC

Nephew says aunt can't see dying sister

A. I'm sorry for the loss of your sister and for all the trauma surrounding her death.

Your nephew is hurting. Some of that is new grief and some of that hurt is poisoned fruit from a tree rooted in lies he was told.

Although you've tried to correct the lies and to be there with him during this time of grief, he's either not ready or not willing to let you in and you can't make him.

It's not clear that you have a responsibility to him or that he's asking anything of you.

It may help you to write a letter to him. Settling old scores or correcting the record won't do you much good. Rather, in your letter you can say that you know he is hurting, that you're hurting, too, and if he ever wishes to have a relationship, you're open to a conversation.

You can leave it at that.

Q. My dad is in his mid-80s but based on family history and current health he could easily be around for another 10 years or so. Mom is still in good shape, too. They live within walking distance to us.

He's always been on the controlling side, still is with my mom, and even some instances with me when I was well into my 40s. There were instances of physical abuse.

My siblings, our friends, and I feared him when he got angry.

I have been recounting some of these childhood instances with my spouse and when it spills out, I get so angry at my dad, never directly to my dad. It just bubbles up and I get over it.

He was always a good grandfather to our kids and they love him.

Overall, we have a very cordial/friendly/loving relationship with him and my mom, but I worry that will change if my mom predeceases him and we find the roles reversed and I have power over him.

Not sure what to do.

LEFT WITH DAD

A. I'm sorry you experienced this abuse; it's not right and it shouldn't have happened. The anger is a message, and you should listen to it.

While neither you nor your father can undo what's been done, you have the opportunity to process it, first with yourself and then with him.

This may bring up strong, new emotions and that may be hard. But the alternative is that these feelings continue to sit inside you and cause you problems or cause you to act out of character.

A therapist can help you process what happened and create a safe space to bring these feelings up to your father.

Additionally, you might consider a support group for adults who have experienced childhood abuse. The National Domestic Violence Hotline (thehotline.org) is one resource that can point you toward local support providers.

You didn't have the relationship you wanted to have, nor the one you should have had. But it's not too late to address it and to begin to heal.

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at eric@askingeric.com.

BIRD SIGHTINGS

storm-petrels, a Leach's storm-petrel, and a dickcissel.

A survey of a remote part of Monomoy National Wildlife Refuge turned up 8 blue-winged teal, 12 gadwall, 45 American black ducks, 15 green-winged teal, 7 ruddy ducks, 4 American coots, 3 pied-billed grebes, an American golden-plover, 3 Hudsonian godwits, 22 white-rumped sandpipers, and 5 black-crowned night-herons.

Birds at Bell's Neck Conservation Area in West Harwich included a clapper rail, a tricolored heron, a little blue heron, 2 glossy

ibis, 100 snowy egrets, and 90 great egrets.

Other sightings around the Cape included a stilt sandpiper in Chatham, a little blue heron at Mud Pond in Harwich, a dickcissel at Harwich Community Gardens, and a summer tanager in Wellfleet.

If you have questions about these sightings, or want to report a sighting, call the Wellfleet Bay Wildlife Sanctuary at 508-349-2615 or send e-mail to cape.sightings@massaudubon.org.

Wednesday September 2, 2026

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS BBC News	R. Steves	Big Cats 24/7		NOVA "Egypt's Tombs of Amun"		Resolve to Solve (N)		Amanpour and Company (N)	
4	WBZ CBS Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	Big Brother "Episode 27" (N)		Survivor "Everyone Will Be Shooketh!"				News (N)	(:35) Comics
5	WCVB ABC News	Chronicle	Jeopardy! Masters (N)		Shark Tank		Shark Tank		NewsCenter 5 (N)	(:35) J. Kimmel
6	WLNE ABC Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live		Saturday Night Live	
7	WHDH Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud	Family Feud	7 News at 9PM (N)		7 News at 10PM (N)		7 News at 11PM (N)	(:35) Inside
9	WMUR ABC Chronicle	News (N)	Debate: 1st		Shark Tank		Shark Tank		News (N)	J.Kimmel
10	NBC Boston Boston News (N)	Hollywood (N)	America's Got Talent (N)		Chicago Fire "Speak of the Devil"		Chicago P.D. "The Lost Years"		Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon
10	WJAR NBC News (N)	Extra (N)	America's Got Talent (N)		Chicago Fire "Speak of the Devil"		Chicago P.D. "The Lost Years"		News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon
11	WENH PBS Christa	Windows	Big Cats 24/7		NOVA "Egypt's Tombs of Amun"		Resolve to Solve (N)		Amanpour and Company (N)	
12	WPRI CBS Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	Big Brother "Episode 27" (N)		Survivor "Everyone Will Be Shooketh!"				12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics
25	WFXT FOX ET (N)	TMZ (N)	MasterChef (N)		Nation's Dumbest "Not a Clue" (N)		Boston 25 News at 10PM (N)	(Live)	News (N)	(:35) News (N)
27	WUNI Vix música sessions		Tan cerca "Verdad a medias" (N)		Guardián de mi vida (N)		Corazón de oro (N)		Noticias Univisión	SaborDe (:35) Notl..
36	WSBE PBS Milk Street TV	Mexican	Tim Janis: Our Natural World -- Returning to Earth		Visions of Italy, Southern Style				PBS News Hour	
38	WSBK Big Bang	Big Bang	WBZ News 8p (N)		48 Hours		Perfect	Perfect	Flip Side	Flip Side
44	WGBX PBS Test Kitchen	Antiques	Sister Boniface Mysteries		Dalgliesh "A Certain Justice: Part 1"		The Seaside Hotel "To Come Home"		PBS News Hour (N)	
50	WWJE 48 Hours		Heartland Homicide		Killer Cases		Crime Stories		Unusual Suspects	
56	WLVI CW Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	Police 24/7 "Side Swiped"		Lindsay Clancy (N)		7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)		Modern Family	Mod Fam "iSpy"
64	WNAC FOX Family Feud	Family Feud	MasterChef (N)		Nation's Dumbest "Not a Clue" (N)		12 News on Fox Pr (N)		Seinfeld	Seinfeld "The Pie"
68	WBXP ION (:55) Blue Blood "Be Smart or Be Dead"		Blue Bloods "USA Today"		Blue Bloods "Reality Check"		Blue Bloods "Firewall"		Blue Bloods "Old Friends"	
PREMIUM CABLE										
Cinemax	(:15) ★★★ Bad Santa ('03) Tony Cox, Billy Bob Thornton.	(:50) ★★ Bad Santa 2 ('16) Billy Bob Thornton.			(:20) ★★ Our Kind of Traitor ('16) Stellan Skarsgård, Ewan McGregor.					
Flix	(6:20) ★ The Heart Specialist ('06)	★★★ The English Patient ('96) Juliette Binoche, Willem Dafoe, Ralph Fiennes.			(:45) ★★★ Restoration ('95) Sam Neill, Robert Downey Jr..					
HBO	(:15) Lanterns "Pilot"	(:10) Lanterns	(:05) Lanterns		★★★ Les Misérables ('12) Russell Crowe, Anne Hathaway, Hugh Jackman.					
HBO 2	(6:35) ★★ Mortal Kombat II		Monsters of God		(:25) ★★ Taken 2 ('12) Maggie Grace, Liam Neeson.		(:05) Lanterns			
Paramount-Sho	(6:25) You're Dating a Narcissist! ('25)	★★★ My Cousin Vinny ('92) Marisa Tomei, Ralph Macchio, Joe Pesci.			★★★★ Pulp Fiction ('94) Samuel L. Jackson, Uma Thurman, John Travolta.					
Showtime 2	(5:45) ★★ The Lovely Bones ('09)	★★ The Time Traveler's Wife ('09) Rachel McAdams.			(:50) ★★★ Red Eye ('05) Rachel McAdams.		(:15) ★★ Se7en ('95) Brad Pitt.			
Starz!	(5:45) Trouble Man ('25) Method Man, Michael Jai White.		(:05) ★★ Michael ('26) Colman Domingo, Nia Long, Jaafar Jackson.		(:15) Beast ('26) Daniel MacPherson.					
TMC	(6:05) ★★ The Foreigner ('17)	Kickback ('22)			(:40) Day of the Fight ('23) Joe Pesci, Ron Perlman, Michael Pitt.		★★★ The Doors			
SPORTS										
CBSSN	Watercross	USL League One Soccer Richmond Kickers at Fort Wayne FC (N) (Live)			UFC - The Walk		UFC - The Walk		UFC Main Oliveira vs. Chandler 2 (N)	
ESPN	2026 US Open Tennis Men's & Women's Second Round From the USTA Billie Jean King National Tennis Center in Flushing, N.Y. (N) (Live)								SportsCenter (N) (Live)	
ESPN2	Women's College Volleyball SEC/Big 10 Challenge: UCLA at Kentucky (N) (Live)		Women's College Volleyball USC at Texas (N) (Live)				NFL Live Marcus Spears			
Fox Sports 1	(6:00) Women's College Volleyball	Wm. Volleyball Big Ten / Sec Volleyball Challenge: Florida vs. Wisconsin (N)			Travis		College Football Memphis at UNLV (N)		Volleyball	
Golf	PGA	PGA TOUR	Big Break x Good Good Howdy		Big Break x		The Smylie Show		Vanity	
NBA	(5:00) Game of the Day									
NBC Sports	(6:30) Early (N)	Early Edition	Quick Snap		Tom Curran's		Quick Snap		Boston Sports (N) (Live)	Boston Sports
NESN	Extra (N)	Red Sox	To Be Announced		Fame		To Be Announced			
FAMILY										
Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers		FamilyGuy		FamilyGuy		HomeMo..	BrakShow
Disney	Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Phineas and Ferb		Phineas and Ferb		Phineas and Ferb		Kiff	H.Birdman
Encore Family	(6:25) A Dog & Pony ...	(:05) ★★ Instant Family ('18)			(:05) Summertime Dropouts					
Nickelodeon	★★★ Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone ('01) Daniel Radcliffe.				Big Bang		Big Bang		Big Bang	
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..

	News		Specials								
	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30	
BASIC CABLE											
A&E	Live PD: Police	Live PD: Police	Live PD: Police	Live PD: Police	Booked "Fast and Foolish" (N)		Booked "Expecting Lockup" (N)		(:05) Live PD	(:35) Live PD	
AMC	(5:00) Jack Reacher		★★★ Unstoppable ('10)			★★ White House Down ('13)					
Animal Planet	Naked and Afraid		Naked and Afraid "Night Stalkers"			Naked and Afraid "The Devil's Woods"					
BBC America	(5:30) ★★★ Tombstone ('93)			★★★ The Patriot Heath Ledger, Joely Richardson, Mel Gibson.							
BET	Celebrity Fam. Tommy Davidson		Celebrity Fam. Gus Kenworthy		Tyler Perry's The Oval (N)		Queen-Men "Back in the Game" (N)		Martin	Martin	
Bravo	Next Gen NYC "No EffsGiving"		Next Gen NYC		Next Gen NYC (N)		Housewives/OC		Next Gen NYC		
CMT	Mama's	Mama's	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	
CNN	OutFront (Live)		Cooper 360		The Source With (N)		CNN NewsNight		Laura	(Live)	
Comedy Central	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	
CSPAN	(6:00) U.S. House		C-SPAN Primetime			C-SPAN Primetime					
CSPAN2	(6:35) Public Affairs		(:20) Public Affairs Events			(:10) Public Affairs Events					
Dest. America	BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pit "Butt Out!"		BBQ Pit "Fowl Play"		
Discovery	Expedition X		Expedition X		Expedition X (N)		How to Catch (N)		How to Catch		
Discovery Life	(6:00) My 600-Lb		My 600-Lb. Life "Wess' Journey"			My 600-Lb. Life "Syreeta's Journey"					
E!	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	
Encore	(:05) ★★★ Scream ('96) Neve Campbell.		★★ The Housemaid ('25)			Strangers: Chapter 3					
Food	Grocery "Guy's Favorites"		Guy's Grocery Games		Grocery "Food Fanatic Teams" (N)		Guy's Grocery Games		Guy's Grocery Games		
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)		Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (Live)		Gutfeld!		Fox News (Live)		
Freeform	(6:00) ★★★ Beauty and the Beast ('17)		House of Stassi (N)			House of Stassi (N)		(SF)		The 700 Club	
FUSE	The Beatles: In the Life		Killing John Lennon			Cheaters		Cheaters		Cheaters	
FX	(6:30) ★★★ Speed ('94) Keanu Reeves.		The Shards			★★ The Day After Tomorrow ('04)					
FXM	(5:50) ★★★ 9 to 5		(:10) ★★ Whitney Houston: I Wanna Dance With Somebody			The Woman King					
Hallmark	(6:00) A Picture of Her		Much About Love ('26) Niall Matter.			Gold Girls		Gold Girls		Gold Girls	
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Family Histor...		Family Practice "Coming Home"			Murder, She Wrote		Murder, She Wrote			
HGTV	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	Totally '90s House (N)		Botched "Ruined Retreat" (N) (P)		House Hunters	House Hunters	
History	Alone "No Safe Haven"		Alone "Fire and Famine"		Alone "Subzero" (N)			(:35) Pawn Stars: Best Of (N)		(:35) Pawn Stars	
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	
HSN	Beauty Solutions		Chaco (N) (Live)		Beauty Report (N)		Beauty Report (N)		Isomers (N) (Live)		
ID	Body Cam "The Sting"		Body Cam "Race Against Time"		Body Cam "The Tipping Point" (N)		911 "Lying Consequences" (N)		See No Evil "Angel of Death"		
IFC	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	
Lifetime	Rizzoli & Isles		Rizzoli "All for One"		Rizzoli "Cold as Ice"		(:05) Rizzoli & Isles		(:05) Rizzoli & Isles		
LMN	(6:00) Woman With ...		The Twin Who Lived ('26)			My Mother Looked Just Like You ('25)					
MAGN	Maine		Maine		Maine		Maine		Maine		
MSNBC	The Weeknight		All in (Live)		Briefing (Live)		Last Word (Live)		The 11th (Live)		
MTV	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	
National Geographic	Smuggler "Saints and Sinners"		Catch Smuggler "A Special Package"		Catch a Smuggler "Cocaine Pyjamas"		Smuggler "Drug Cash Carriers"		To Catch "Caught With Cocaine"		
NatGeoWild	Secrets of the Zoo		Secrets of the Zoo		Secrets of the Zoo		Secrets of the Zoo		Secrets of the Zoo		
NECN	News	News	Dateline		Dateline		Rescue		OpenHou..	1st Look	
NewsNation	Vargas Report (N)		Cuomo		On Balance (N)		Katie Pavlich		Jesse Web		
Ovation	Hudson & Rex		Hudson & Rex		Blue Skies		Hudson & Rex		Hudson & Rex		
OWN	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	
Oxygen	Dateline: Secrets "Manner of Death"				Dateline "The Feud"		Dateline: Secrets		Dateline: Secrets		
Paramount	(6:00) ★★★ Gladiator		Russell Crowe.			★★★ Top Gun: Maverick ('22)		Tom Cruise.			
QVC	Griddle-Grill (N)		Kitchen (N) (Live)		Makeup (N) (Live)		Skechers (N) (Live)		Jewelry (N) (Live)		
Science	Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		
Sundance	Law & Order		Law & Order		Law & Order		Law & Order		Law & Order		
SyFy	★★ Alien: Covenant ('17) Michael Fassbender. (P)						The Ark (N)		Ghost Rider: Spirit o...		
TBS	Big Bang	Big Bang	All Elite Wrestling: Dynamite (N) (Live)			Jokers		Jokers			
TCM	(6:00) Bachelor in P...		★★★ Atlantic City '80) Burt Lancaster.			★★★ Bull Durham ('88) Kevin Costner.					
TLC	ER: Ca.		ER: Ca.		ER: Ca. (N)		Save My Skin (N)		Save My Skin		
TNT	(6:00) Jumanji: Welcome to the ...				★★ Practical Magic ('98) (P)		(:45) ★ Blended ('14)				
Travel	Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		
TruTV	★★★ Jerry Maguire ('96) Cuba Gooding Jr., Tom Cruise.						★★★ Jerry Maguire ('96) Tom Cruise.				
TV Land	Raymond		Raymond		Raymond		Raymond		King	King	
TV One	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	
USA	9-1-1 "Cursed"		9-1-1 "What's Your Fantasy?"		9-1-1 "Red Flag"		9-1-1 "In a Flash"		9-1-1 "In Another Life"		
VH-1	Chris	Chris	★★ 30 Minutes or Less ('11)				★★★ Panic Room ('02) Jodie Foster.				
WE	NCIS		NCIS "Cloak"		NCIS "Dagger"		NCIS "Road Kill"		NCIS "Silent Night"		